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NOVEMBER 2026

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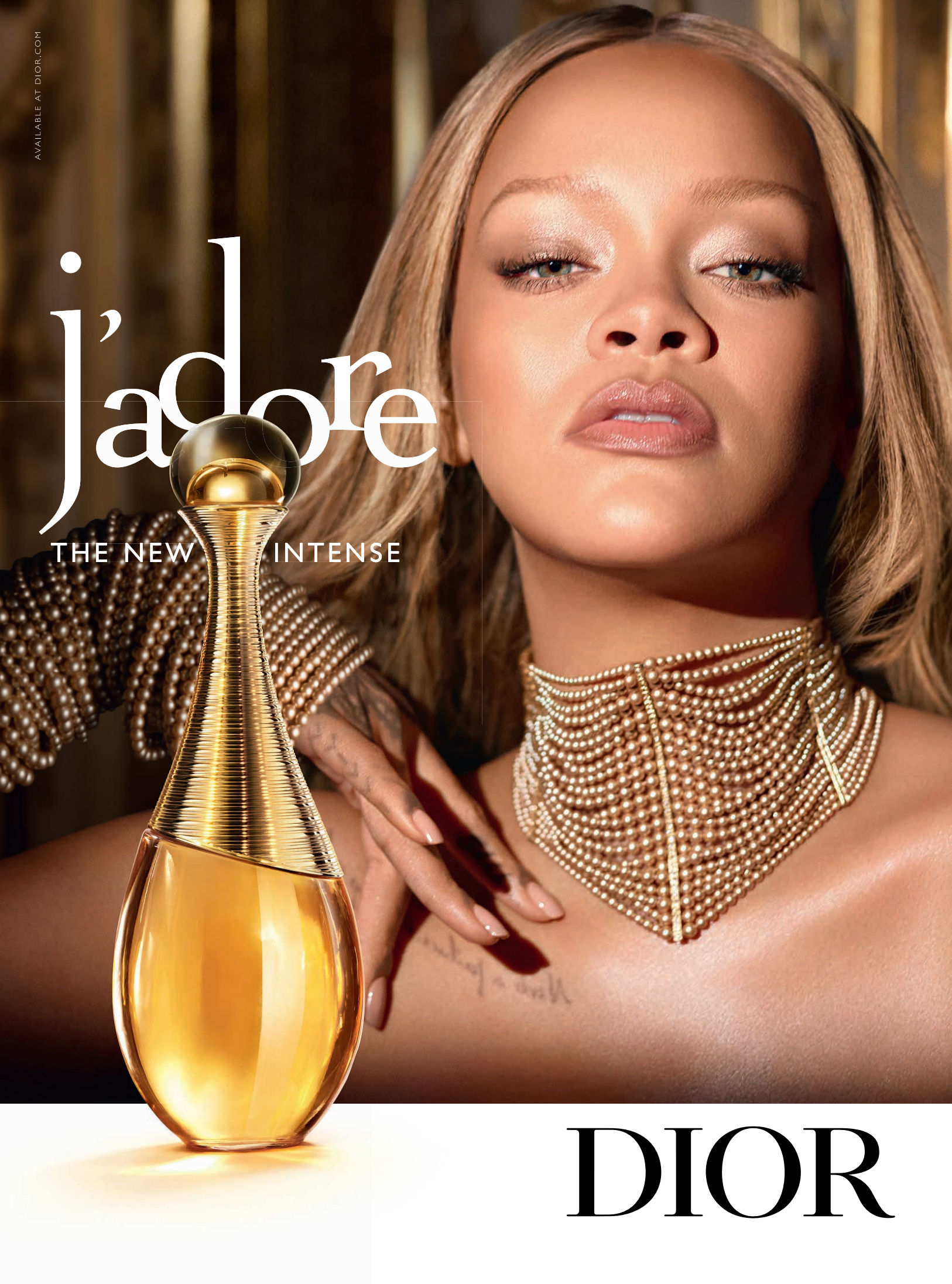
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PHOTOGRAPH: GLADYS TAN

COVER LOOKS Far left: Emma Corrin wears wool dress, £2,300; matching top, £1,470; poplin shirt, £1,180; leather heels, £870, all Miu Miu. White gold, platinum, yellow sapphire and diamond necklace, from a selection, Cartier High Jewellery. Styled by Lisa Jarvis. Hair by Pablo Küemin at R3-MGMT. Make-up by Gina Kane at Caren. Manicure by Chisato Yamamoto at Caren. Photographs and art direction by Szilveszter Makó. Centre left (limited-edition cover available exclusively at PAD London): *Métropole light-sculpture* (2026) by Pierre Lapeyronnie, courtesy of 88 Gallery and Pierre Lapeyronnie, photograph by the artist. Near left (*Bazaar Art* cover): *Suspended in Stone* (2026) by Sam Taylor-Johnson, copyright the artist. Near right (*Bazaar Art* cover): *Call Me* (2026) by Chila Kumari Burman, copyright the artist. Centre right (*Bazaar Art* cover): *Fabric Matrons* (2026) by Cindy Sherman, copyright the artist. Far right (*Bazaar Art* cover): *September* (2026) by Renée Levi, copyright the artist, photograph by Rachel Louise Brown

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Lisa Hageman wears Calvin Klein in 'Playing to the gallery'

PHOTOGRAPH: ANYA HOLDSTOCK

MARINA

Size doesn't matter

RINALDI

Alhambra, celebrating luck since 1968

Alhambra
Earrings

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Editor's letter

Emma Corrin wears Miu Miu and Cartier in this month's cover story (page 124)

It has been an art-filled week for me, starting at Pitzhanger Manor, Sir John Soane's beautiful Ealing residence, where Clare Woods' dazzling botanical works are on display. The following day, I queued up for the Bayeux Tapestry, which astonished me both with its emotional punch and its cartoonish modernity. I ended up in Trafalgar Square on a sunny morning to see the unveiling of the latest Fourth Plinth sculpture by Tschabalala Self. As the cloth slid away and *Lady in Blue* was revealed, striding out in her exuberant glory, there was an audible gasp from the crowd. Afterwards I reflected that, albeit so different in their medium, provenance and scale, all these works by women artists had left me feeling similarly exhilarated.

Our November art issue is equally full of colour, energy and inspiration – starting with our surreal cover featuring Emma Corrin, shot by Szilveszter Makó. Inside, the gender-fluid actor talks to Jessica Swale about stepping into the shoes of Lizzy Bennet and why they're birds of a feather.

Meanwhile, Max Mara's creative director Ian Griffiths takes me on a tour of the brand's extraordinary archive in Reggio Emilia; the fashion designer Rejina Pyo and the artist Es Devlin share cultural travel tips; and even the At Work pages offer a new perspective, as Frances Hedges explores the benefits of a curious mindset. Finally, don't miss the annual *Bazaar Art* supplement, which comes in a choice of four unique artist-designed covers, celebrating the women in art who make us all look at things afresh.

LYDIA SLATER
EDITOR-IN-CHIEF

£545, Sportmax

Earrings, £11,200, Tiffany & Co

£1,395, Roksanda

EDITOR'S CHOICES

I'll eschew my beloved monochrome this month in favour of chromatic gowns and sculptural accessories.

£12,750, Rolex

£845, Manolo Blahnik

THIS MONTH, I ENJOYED...
Total efficiency with a new note-taker (plaud.ai)
A silvery hair refresh (joshwoodcolour.com)
The return of *Slow Horses* (tv.apple.com/gb)

Harper's BAZAAR PRIVÉ

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PHOTOGRAPHS: SZILVESZTER MAKÓ, RICHARD PHIBBS

Contributors

EMMA CORRIN

An actor whose career has included prestige TV, critically acclaimed theatre and Marvel blockbusters, our cover star first achieved global recognition in 2020 for playing the young Princess Diana in *The Crown*. Now, they take on another national treasure: Elizabeth Bennet in Dolly Alderton's Netflix adaptation of *Pride and Prejudice*. Jessica Swale meets them in 'Portrait mode'.
Your go-to doodle 'Steps that become boxes, and then you shade them in. It's like Tetris.'
The gallery or museum you'd spend a day in 'Turner Contemporary or Carl Freedman Gallery in Margate.'
The first piece of art you fell in love with 'A painting by Sara Berman that I bought recently. All her characters are quite gender-fluid and have short hair, so they look a bit like me.'

LESLIE JACKSON CHIHULY

The philanthropist oversees her husband Dale Chihuly's art studio, his public-art display 'Chihuly: Venice 2026', and the Chihuly Foundation, which supports victims of trauma. She reflects on her professional trajectory in At Work.
The gallery or museum you'd spend a day in 'Fondation Louis Vuitton. I love Frank Gehry's architecture.'
The first piece of art you fell in love with '*Cadillac Ranch* in Amarillo, Texas. I loved the setting, the Cadillacs emerging from the ground…'
Who would you like to paint your portrait? 'David Hockney. He captured each individual's personality.'

IAN GRIFFITHS

Max Mara's creative director took on the role a decade ago, but has been with the brand since 1987. Lydia Slater meets him on a tour of the Max Mara archives in Italy and uncovers the man behind the enigma in 'Staying power'.
The gallery or museum you'd spend a day in 'Sir John Soane's Museum in London.'
The first piece of art you fell in love with 'Michelangelo's *David* – his quiet heroism…'
Who would you like to paint your portrait? 'Marlene Dumas prioritises identity over likeness. Would she see the teenage punk rebel under the Savile Row suits?'
What do you consider your personal masterpiece? 'The most successful to date is the Teddy coat, but I always think the best is yet to come; otherwise, it's time to stop.'

ANYA HOLDSTOCK

The London-based photographer is known for her slick style and storytelling – an approach she brings to her work for numerous international publications and global labels, from Dior and Burberry to De Beers and Valentino. She shoots this month's fashion story 'Playing to the gallery'.
The first piece of art you fell in love with 'My grandmother had a tiny print of Leonardo da Vinci's *Lady with an Ermine* hanging in her living-room. I remember being completely captivated by it.'
Who would you like to paint your portrait? 'Past: Valentin Serov. Present: Ishbel Myerscough.'
What do you consider your personal masterpiece? 'The images I'm most proud of are the ones where I thought my ideas were too experimental, but I pushed myself to create what my mind was imagining.'
A creative powerhouse you admire 'Do Ho Suh – his work is visually striking and really resonates with me.'

PHOTOGRAPHS: GETTY IMAGES, ANYA HOLDSTOCK STUDIO, STUDIO BLACK LOCUST

Alhambra, celebrating luck since 1968

Alhambra
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Haute Joaillerie, place Vendôme since 1906

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Contributors

ELIF SHAFAK

This author is behind some of the most talked-about books of recent years, including *The Island of Missing Trees* and *There Are Rivers In The Sky*. She discusses her latest novel – a radical reimagining of Flaubert's *Madame Bovary* – with Erica Wagner.

Your go-to doodle 'I draw circles within circles, spires, cupolas and domes. It helps me focus.'

The first piece of art you fell in love with 'When I was about 10, I saw Diego Velázquez's *Las Hilanderas* in Madrid. The spinners, the fable of Arachne… it's an incredible painting.'

Who would you like to paint your portrait? 'Artemisia Gentileschi. She was a wonderful artist.'

What do you consider your personal masterpiece? 'Each one of my novels came from my soul, my whole being.'

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REJINA PYO

The Korean designer and artist has had an indelible impact on the British fashion industry since launching her brand in 2014. Ahead of the British Museum's exhibition dedicated to Korea, Pyo goes back to her roots and explores her homeland's many rich cultural delights in 'Beyond the horizon'.

The gallery or museum you'd spend a day in 'Museum SAN in South Korea.'

The first piece of art you fell in love with 'A Matisse painting in my school art textbook when I was a young child.'

Who would you like to paint your portrait? 'Alice Neel.'

What do you consider your personal masterpiece? 'The life I have built.'

JESSICA SWALE

Since her debut play *Blue Stockings* premiered at the Globe in 2013, Swale has created a portfolio of work that includes the Olivier Award-winning *Nell Gwynn* and the barnstorming new musical *Paddington*. A lifelong Austen aficionado, she interviews our cover star – and new Lizzy Bennet – in 'Portrait mode'.

Your go-to doodle 'Kaleidoscope leaves that start as flower petals then spin and just keep on going. What that says about the jungle of my mind, I don't know!'

Who would you like to paint your portrait? 'Quentin Blake. Paint me like one of your Matildas, Quentin…'

What do you consider your personal masterpiece? 'I hope my best work is still to come. If I thought I'd already peaked, I'd just pour myself a glass and go sit in the garden.'

A creative powerhouse you admire 'Ava Pickett [who wrote *1536*]. Utterly original, her play stayed with me for days.'

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SARAH CREAL

This New Yorker is one of the beauty industry's secret weapons. Having created and launched products for Estée Lauder and Victoria Beckham Beauty, the entrepreneur launched her own line of products last year, specifically designed for women over 40. Katy Young meets her in 'Coming in hot'.

The first piece of art you fell in love with 'Helen Frankenthaler's *Beginnings*. It was a limited-edition print she did for the Lincoln Center.'

Who would you like to paint your portrait? 'Marilyn Minter. She's a photographer, but I love the raw and exciting way she captures beauty and colour.'

What do you consider your personal masterpiece? 'Face Flex Concealer and Complexion Enhancer.'

A creative powerhouse you admire 'Lorde. I find her really inspiring.'

COMPILED BY CHARLOTTE BROOK AND MARIE-CLAIRE CHAPPET. PHOTOGRAPHS: RACHEL LOUISE BROWN, OLIVER HOLMS, © MICHAEL WHARLEY 2019, SARAH BANNER

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EDITED BY
AVRIL MAIR

1

THE SOUPED-UP STAPLE

An everyday essential is elevated to new heights in the hands of Loro Piana; this featherlight turtleneck injects a fluid sense of ease into your look.

Wool and silk jumper, £2,870; matching skirt, £3,495; satin scarf, £675, all Loro Piana. Platinum and diamond earrings, from a selection, Boodles

10 things we love

Capture the free spirit of the season with sculptural silhouettes and rich textures

PHOTOGRAPHS BY GLADYS TAN STYLED BY HOLLY GORST

THE TROPHY PRINT

Celine's sumptuous cashmere dress leans into autumn's preoccupation with punchy patterns – a bold attitude is the only accessory you'll need.

Cashmere dress, £3,450, Celine

3

THE LEATHER COAT

From our newly launched Karen Millen x *Harper's Bazaar* collection, this chic take on a classic trench comes in a chocolate-brown shade that feels very of the moment.

Leather trench-coat, £699, Karen Millen x *Harper's Bazaar*

GLADYS TAN

4

THE GOTHIC DRESS

Ethereal lace is enjoying a darkly dramatic revival this season in inky-black tones; combine with flashes of silk for a modern sensuality.

Lace dress, £5,250; silk and lace top (worn underneath), £4,300, both Dolce & Gabbana

5

THE SHOW-STOPPER

Tradition and innovation collide in Erdem's woven, jacquard pannier gown. Defy expectations and pair with masculine footwear – either way, this is a ballgown for the ages.

Jacquard dress, from a selection, Erdem. Gold and diamond ring, £7,050, Tiffany & Co

THE 'WEAR EVERYWHERE' BOOTS

Sturdy leather gets a refined twist with gold hardware. Match these with anything from floor-sweeping skirts to A-line minis.

Leather boots, £349, Holland Cooper

THE RELAXED TAILORING

For a masterclass in casual chic, try layering Marina Rinaldi's tuxedo-inspired blazer over a simple roll-neck knit.

Cady blazer, £880; matching trousers, £385, both Marina Rinaldi. Wool roll-neck, £235, Polo Ralph Lauren

7

THE SILK SCARF

Bring personality to a monochrome outfit with a classic Hermès foulard – the only difficult decision is how to tie it.

Silk scarves, from £280, Hermès

GLADYS TAN

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THE BRAND-NEW BABYDOLL

Live the bohemian dream this autumn. Chloé's taffeta dress offers radical volume and a cascade of ruffles for a mood of whimsical romance.

Taffeta dress, £4,600, Chloé. Gold and diamond ring, £5,500, Kiki McDonough

10

THE HIGH-RISE FOOTWEAR

Embroidered with fanciful florals, Chloé's distinctive over-the-knee boots provide the perfect foil for the floatiest of dresses.

Calf-skin boots, £2,120, Chloé

WORDS BY HANNAH BANKS-WALKER. HAIR BY MAIKO KOMORI. MAKE-UP BY FAYE BLUFF. MODEL: IRIS O AT PRESENT MODEL MANAGEMENT. STYLIST'S ASSISTANT: GLORIA MADENGÉ

GLADYS TAN

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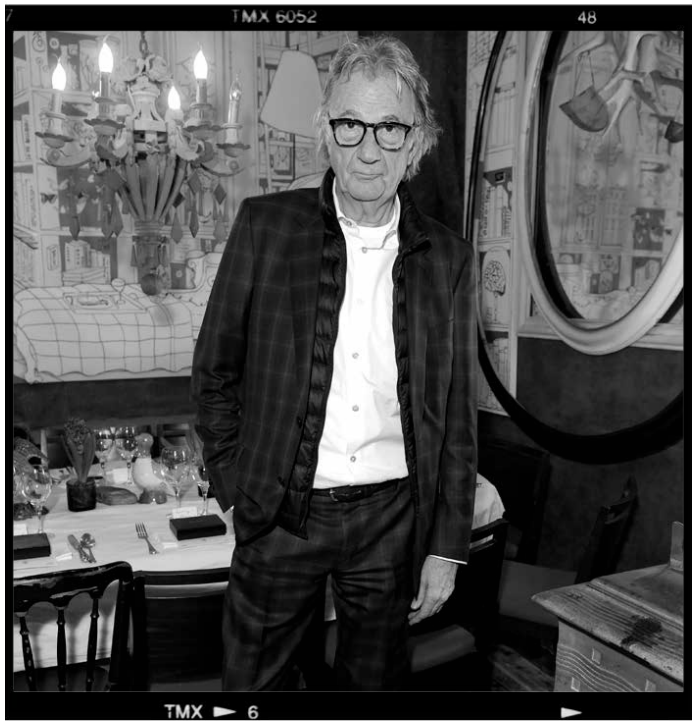
STYLE FILE

PAUL SMITH

The designer, who has been a trailblazing force in British fashion for more than half a century, loves Italian sculpture, statement socks and travelling with his wife



My style icon... is my wife Pauline. She and I were lucky enough to be at Yves Saint Laurent's show when Le Smoking jacket was first shown. Years later, when Yves was closing his couture atelier, I wanted her to have one. She chose the version from 1966 – the year we met – and it became the last Le Smoking he ever made. She still has it today.

The brands that best represent my style are... Paul Smith (naturally), Caran d'Ache and Mini. I use a Caran d'Ache pencil every morning; I'm very lucky to receive gifts and letters from people all over the world – I've even been sent a live pigeon! I try to write back to everyone I can. And I've driven a Mini since 1998 – I go all around London in it.

My style signature is... a suit. I wear a double-button single-breasted jacket in a navy-blue tailoring fabric. And always a bold sock – it's the punctuation of colour that I'm known for.

I have a collection of... almost everything! Art, stamps, cameras, vintage tins...

The things on my bedside table... are an alarm clock, as I'm always rushing somewhere, and a notepad. I'm constantly writing things down: ideas, observations, things I've seen or heard.

The last book I read... I'm dyslexic, so I struggled with reading when I was growing up, but I've found I really enjoy listening to Gertrude Stein's work. I love the way she plays with language and repetition; there is something very simple but clever about her writing. I think 'A rose is a rose is a rose' is such a wonderful line.

The rule I live by... is that every day is a new beginning.

My favourite work of art... It's almost impossible to choose, but I love Giacomo Cometti. He was an incredible Italian sculptor who also created the most beautifully made furniture. I admire his attention to detail.

The place that means most to me... is home. I travel a lot, so coming back to London and being in my own space is very special.

The indulgence I can't live without... is a camera; these days, an iPhone. I've taken photographs since I was 11 years old.

The greatest style advice I ever received... is to keep it simple and dress for your lifestyle.

My favourite memory with my family... is of holidays. When I was a teenager, we'd go to Dorset; being by the sea made me smile. Pauline and I have a house in Lucca, Italy. I get to cycle, eat great food and spend quality time with her there every summer.

'Threads' by Sir Paul Smith (£25, Macmillan) is out now.

PHOTOGRAPHS: GETTY IMAGES

MONTBLANC
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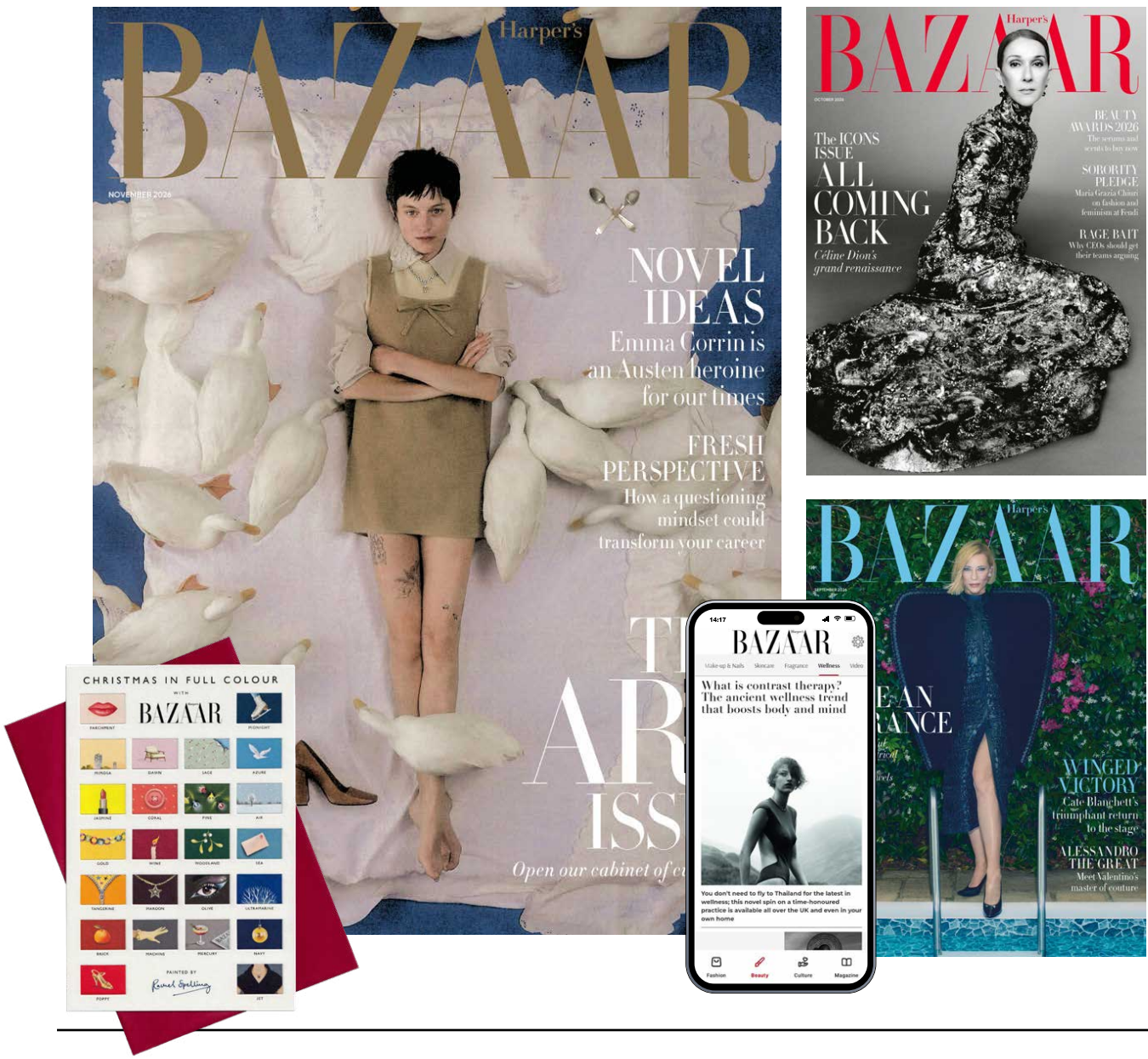
LYDIA SLATER EDITOR-IN-CHIEF



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reallywildclothing.com

Earrings, from a selection, Audemars Piguet Royal Oak Joaillerie collection

ICICLE WORKS

Audemars Piguet transforms its Royal Oak icon into a glittering jewellery collection

The Royal Oak's striking geometry revolutionised horology when it launched in 1972, bringing together the seemingly incompatible worlds of jewellery and sports watches. Today, Audemars Piguet builds on this legacy with its Royal Oak Joaillerie line, inspired by the maison's home in Switzerland's Vallée de Joux. The Dream of Joux earrings, seen here, evoke a winter wonderland with their cascading pear-shaped diamonds and blue titanium links set with sapphires. 'A gateway to the past and present, this collection embodies Audemars Piguet's free spirit,' says the CEO Ilaria Resta. **AVRIL MAIR**

PHOTOGRAPH: COURTESY OF AUDEMARS PIGUET

CLOUDY BAY
NEW ZEALAND
OPEN
WHAT COULD BE
CLOUDY BAY
NEW ZEALAND
SAUVIGNON BLANC
bedrinkaware.co.uk

Gold, onyx and diamond pendant, from a selection, Chopard Happy Diamonds collection

PHOTOGRAPH: COURTESY OF CHOPARD

CUTTING LOOSE

Celebrating half a century of Chopard's liberating fluidity

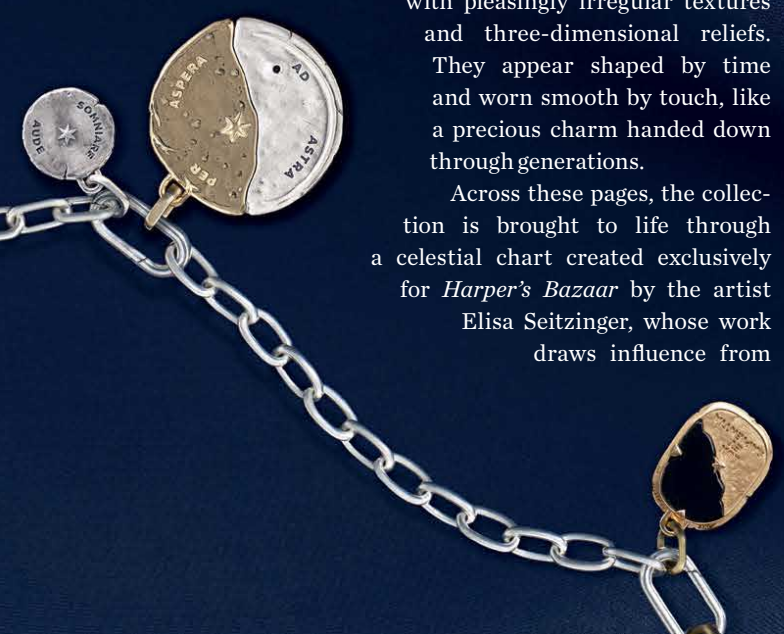
In 1976, Chopard transformed the codes of jewellery by imagining diamonds free from their traditional settings – an approach that has become the house signature. Now, to mark 50 years of beauty in motion, the brand has launched a new suite of pieces for its Happy Diamonds range: a signet ring, a brooch, a pendant and cufflinks, each reinterpreting the original design in its most graphic form. Set in 18-carat ethical yellow gold, they juxtapose the velvet opacity of black onyx with the kinetic brilliance of diamonds enclosed within sapphire crystals, and feel like very modern talismans. **AM**

Written in the stars

For many, the appeal of astrology lies in what it represents: a means by which to express one's identity while firmly embracing the power of symbols. This sentiment is at the heart of the second chapter of Pandora Talisman, a collection of zodiac-inspired jewellery which invites us to turn our gaze not only to the sky, but inward. Designed to be layered, stacked and collected, the new pieces expand Pandora's visual vocabulary with precious medallions dedicated to the constellations, ready to be added to bracelets and chain necklaces.

Each creation is conceived as a contemporary talisman through which the wearer can find strength and protection. One such example is the sun and moon charm: engraved with the Latin phrase *per aspera ad astra* (through hardships to the stars), it serves as a potent reminder of the heights that can be reached with resilience. The same design also appears on one of Pandora's new articulated flip rings – a novel way to add some personality to everyday dressing.

Crafted in sterling silver and 14-carat gold plating, pieces are embellished with man-made mother-of-pearl and scattered constellations of stones, as well as sculpted cameos and Latin inscriptions. Inspiration comes from archaeological artefacts. Surfaces are hand-finished with pleasingly irregular textures and three-dimensional reliefs. They appear shaped by time and worn smooth by touch, like a precious charm handed down through generations.



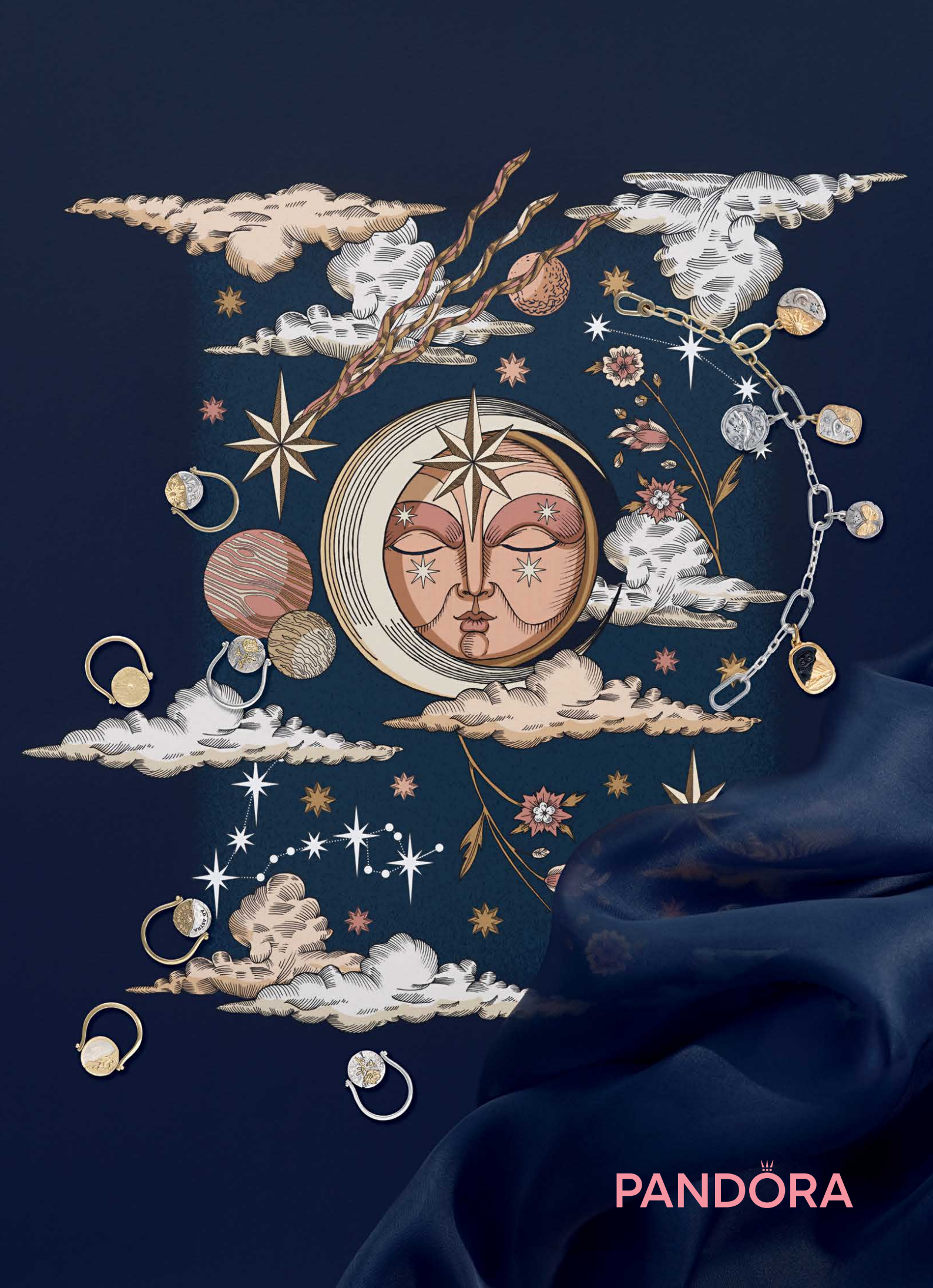
Across these pages, the collection is brought to life through a celestial chart created exclusively for *Harper's Bazaar* by the artist Elisa Seitzinger, whose work draws influence from the iconography of tarot reading and mediaeval art. Along with the 12 signs of the zodiac, the Talisman collection also contains other emblems rich in meaning, including the dolphin and the butterfly.

'We did not want to create a traditional zodiac collection,' explain Francesco Terzo and A Filippo Ficarelli, the creative directors of Pandora. 'Each medallion combines a figurative representation of the sign, its constellation and a composition reminiscent of a celestial map or the frescoes found in grand renaissance chambers. Astrology, chakras, energy and planetary alignment intertwine within a symbolic universe, transforming each jewel into a talisman that is open to your personal interpretation.'

As is always the case with Pandora, the charms are designed to be collected over time. A single oversize medallion might be worn on a chain necklace now, and later added to a bracelet that dances with emblems. With a mix of gold and silver used throughout the collection, clashing metals is firmly encouraged, and foundational necklaces and bracelets come in both of these tones.

Some may choose to start with their birth sign. Others may reach for those that represent the qualities, energies and inspirations they wish to carry with them. The fire signs – Aries, Leo and Sagittarius – embody energy, courage and initiative. The Earth signs – Taurus, Virgo and Capricorn – speak to practicality, stability and building for the long term after an eventful season. For the air signs – Gemini, Libra and Aquarius – creativity, dialogue and a desire for social connection are key, while the water signs – Cancer, Scorpio and Pisces – hold on to intuition, sensitivity and imagination. There is endless opportunity to mix and match the signs, to create a collection and meaning that is entirely personal.

When asked about their zodiac signs, the two creative directors smile and say: 'We are a creative duo made up of an Aquarius and a Libra. But people take on different roles and move through different phases of their lives. Likewise, we wanted to create jewellery that did not express a fixed identity, but a personal universe in constant evolution.' Which, in a time where self-expression is so cherished, feels truly fated.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BAZAAR
accessories

EDITED BY
AVRIL MAIR

£1,650, Celine

Abstract attractions

Echoing Rothko's colour fields, Pollock's dripwork and the collage art of Picasso and Matisse, this season's most vivid pieces blur the line between fashion and fine art

PHOTOGRAPHS BY PAUL ZAK STYLED BY HADYA TUOFIQ

£1,650, Celine

ACCESSORIES

£1,030, Roger Vivier

£4,800, Dior

£89, MK

Necklace, £980, Chloé

£1,120, Hermès

£750, Celine

£450, Jude

£75, Max Mara

£220, Lié Studio

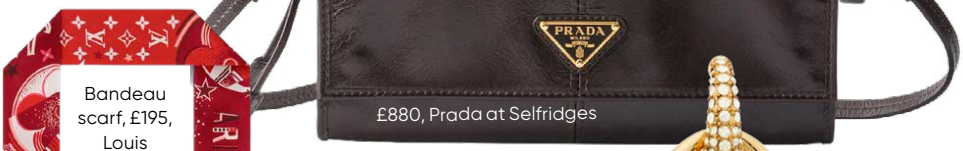
£1,045, Chanel

Belt, £700, Alaïa

£465, Polo Ralph Lauren

£980, Giorgio Armani

£580, Toteme



£880, Prada at Selfridges

£220, Tory Burch

Scarf, £295, Simone Rocha

Bandeau scarf, £195, Louis Vuitton

£145, Mulberry

£900, Tom Ford

£926, Brunello Cucinelli

£815, Christian Louboutin

HOLLAND COOPER

Statement piece

A bold outpouring of creativity, Dior's freeform clutch is poised to make its mark

From a selection, Dior Haute Couture in collaboration with Lynda Benglis

PAUL ZAK

Bracelet, £1,960, Chanel

£1,840, Hermès

£1,840, Rabanne

Necklace, £1,860, Khaite

Necklace, £558, Etro

£530, Prada

£330, Aeyde

£460, Dior

£2,800, Loewe at Net-a-Porter

Belt, £340, Emporio Armani

£1,120, Balenciaga

£440, Celine

£360, Acne Studios

Necklace, £475, Completedworks

£3,100, Fendi

£1,070, Louis Vuitton

Belt, £430, Ferragamo

£4,240, Gucci

Brooch, £75, Weekend Max Mara

From a selection, Maison Margiela

From a selection, Valentino Garavani

£470, Tory Burch

£350, Phoebe Philo

The full montage

When composing an outfit, always start with a shoe: step up, Prada's crystal-embellished slingbacks

Pink and yellow heels, £1,400 each, both Prada

PAUL ZAK

Necklace, £4,050, Fendi
£135, Vivienne Westwood
£440, Tory Burch
£550, Tod's
£425, Gucci
£85, Michael Kors
£265, Lizzie Fortunato
£2,370, Louis Vuitton
Scarf, £360, Jil Sander
£171, Etro
£820, Christian Louboutin
£465, Polo Ralph Lauren
Scarf, £590, Giorgio Armani
£450, Bottega Veneta
£445, Hermès
£430, Oscar de la Renta
£405, Loro Piana
£260, Déhanche
From a selection, Valentino
£1,600, Givenchy at Mytheresa
£235, Completedworks
£890, Chloé
£960, Dior
£159, Pandora

YVES SALOMON

Collection Hiver 2026/2027

BY AVRIL MAIR

THE CRUISE REPORT

From Biarritz to New York, Hollywood to Shanghai, the latest resort collections offer a passport to fashion's most evocative worlds, setting the stage for a season of grand entrances and exquisite contrasts

PHOTOGRAPHS: COURTESY OF CHANEL; COURTESY OF DIOR; COURTESY OF LOUIS VUITTON; COURTESY OF MAX MARA; COURTESY OF GUCCI

C IS FOR CHANEL

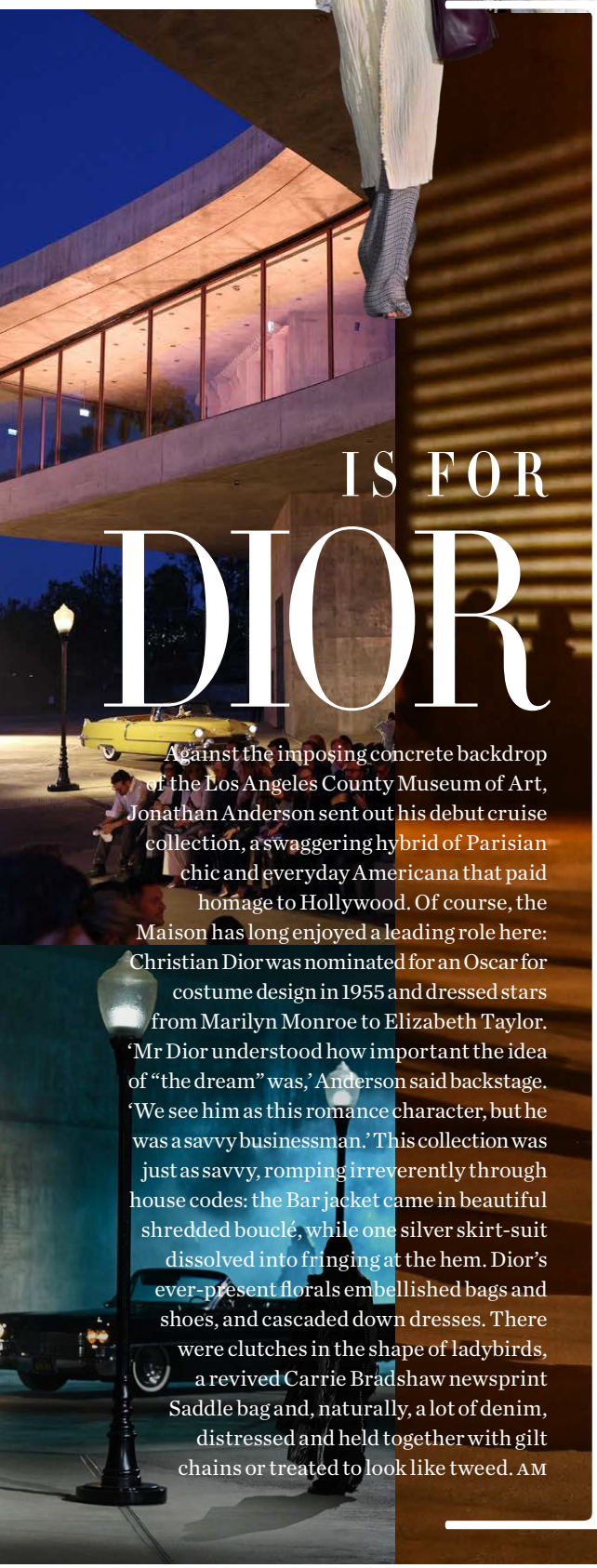
In 1915, Gabrielle 'Coco' Chanel opened her couture house in Biarritz, dressing aristocrats indulging in the new fashion for sea bathing. Over a century later, Matthieu Blazy chose the city's Casino as the site of his debut cruise collection. The show opened with a reimagining of Chanel's LBD, described by Blazy as 'the original' revenge dress and an inspired exercise in democratic dressing. 'Chanel found in Biarritz different ways of being and seeing, of movement and freedom,' he said. His presentation expanded on this idea, absorbing the codes of workwear into a vocabulary that resists hierarchy. Matelot T-shirts complemented dramatic skirts, their edges trimmed with raffia like beach parasols, while neat little dresses were paired with logo swimming caps and fisherman's waders. This was a collection as joyous, as fresh and as achingly nostalgic as a summer seaside holiday. LYDIA SLATER

PHOTOGRAPHS: COURTESY OF CHANEL, IMAXTREE, GETTY IMAGES

PHOTOGRAPHS: COURTESY OF GUCCI; GETTY IMAGES

G IS FOR GUCCI

If you have questions about Demna's 'new Gucci', his cruise-show debut should settle them. Staged as a takeover of Manhattan's Times Square, under the neon glare of NYC's frenzied tourist heart and before a star-studded audience that included Mariah Carey, this was the opposite of subtle. That's a compliment, by the way: the scale of ambition here was huge. Skyscraper-size billboards flashed up advertising for products that don't exist yet – Gucci longevity drugs, anyone? It's clear that Demna means business. As with his Milan debut, this show also had a cast of characters: Big Apple archetypes, from the pinstriped Wall Street banker with the double G backpack to the nouveau riche logo lover in a monogrammed pencil skirt. Titled GucciCore, the collection was *molto* sexy: the Nineties Tom Ford era is obviously Demna's favourite, from form-fitting dark double denim, faux-fur-textures and stiletto knee-high boots to abbreviated leather moto jackets (very David and Victoria Beckham), worn with low-slung snake-print jeans. AVRIL MAIR



D IS FOR DIOR

Against the imposing concrete backdrop of the Los Angeles County Museum of Art, Jonathan Anderson sent out his debut cruise collection, a swaggering hybrid of Parisian chic and everyday Americana that paid homage to Hollywood. Of course, the Maison has long enjoyed a leading role here: Christian Dior was nominated for an Oscar for costume design in 1955 and dressed stars from Marilyn Monroe to Elizabeth Taylor. 'Mr Dior understood how important the idea of "the dream" was,' Anderson said backstage. 'We see him as this romance character, but he was a savvy businessman.' This collection was just as savvy, romping irreverently through house codes: the Bar jacket came in beautiful shredded bouclé, while one silver skirt-suit dissolved into fringing at the hem. Dior's ever-present florals embellished bags and shoes, and cascaded down dresses. There were clutches in the shape of ladybirds, a revived Carrie Bradshaw newsprint Saddle bag and, naturally, a lot of denim, distressed and held together with gilt chains or treated to look like tweed. AM

PHOTOGRAPHS: COURTESY OF DIOR; GETTY IMAGES

PHOTOGRAPHS: COURTESY OF LOUIS VUITTON

L IS FOR LOUIS VUITTON

Louis Vuitton presented its cruise collection against the gorgeous Gilded Age setting of the Frick, the New York mansion turned art museum that opened to the public in 1935. It was the direct inspiration for many of the pieces, with handbags made to look like columns while clothes swirled with metres of fabric and frou-frou ruffles. 'A cameo come to life', as the designer Nicolas Ghesquière described it. 'The Frick starts to integrate with the textures and colours of the clothes.' But Louis Vuitton isn't only an uptown brand, so this became a tale of two cities, with the graffiti art of Keith Haring bringing downtown edge from a very different era. Witty nods to pop culture appeared in the accessories: a bag that looked like the lights on a taxi cab; a crystal-embellished minaudière in the shape of a takeaway box; and a leather record-cover evening clutch. AM

M IS FOR MAX MARA

The 75-year-old fashion house celebrated its anniversary with a spectacular presentation at Long Museum West Bund in Shanghai. This was no random location: Max Mara was the first European house to enter mainland China in 1993. Things may have changed since then, but the collection confirmed that clever, considered evolution, rather than radical reinvention, is just the thing fashion needs right now. 'It's a continuous arc of style,' says the creative director Ian Griffiths. 'We wanted to highlight [the concept of modernity] by presenting in this most metropolitan of environments.' Half the looks at the exhibition were designed during the 39-year tenure of Griffiths, whose great talent is making everything feel part of the same narrative – and his clothes just sing. Teddy-bear coats, sleek suits, striped rompers: it's all adding to a beautifully told story. AM

PHOTOGRAPHS: COURTESY OF MAX MARA, GETTY IMAGES

PHOTOGRAPHS CREDIT GO

RALPH LAUREN

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BAZAAR

at work

EDITED BY
FRANCES HEDGES

Creative thinking

Why asking better questions could be the key to a smarter working life. Plus: expert career advice from the CEO of the Folio Society; and vibrant accessories to bring cheer to your desk

Wool blazer; matching trousers, both from a selection, STELLA McCARTNEY.
Gold vermeil earrings, £215, OTIUMBERG. Crepe de chine and lace heels (just seen), £595, NEOUS

PHOTOGRAPH: SILVIA DRAZ. STYLED BY GRACE CLARKE. HAIR BY LEWIS STANFORD AT EIGHTEEN MANAGEMENT, USING L'ORÉAL PROFESSIONNEL TECNI.ART. MAKE-UP BY EOIN WHELAN, USING BY TERRY. MANICURE BY HAYLEY EVANS-SMITH, USING ESSIE. STYLIST'S ASSISTANT: OLIVIA SANDFORD-WILSON. MODEL: CHENGXIN AT ELITE MODEL MANAGEMENT. WITH THANKS TO: THE BEAUMONT MAYFAIR

OUTSIDE THE BOX

Solving a problem and feel like you've hit a ceiling? You might want to try asking a question instead – because, as *Frances Hedges* discovers, curiosity is a workplace superpower

WHEN DID YOU LAST ALLOW YOURSELF TO BE IGNORANT? Maybe you were at a pub quiz and you grappled with the temptation of sneaking out your phone to check Wikipedia. Or perhaps you were in the boardroom and someone challenged you on a complex issue: did you admit to any uncertainty, or did you feel pressured to respond with confidence?

If you've been hurtling towards solutions of late, you may have been missing out on the benefits of a state Socrates called aporia: coming to the realisation that you don't know what you thought you did, which in turn motivates you to find out more. For the philosopher Lani Watson, whose new book *Q* explores the benefits of developing a questioning mindset, we could all do with bringing a little more aporia to our working lives. 'The trouble is that our workplaces tend to evaluate us in terms of what we know and the solutions we present, not the questions we ask or the problems we're trying to solve,' she says. 'Take the medical profession – the more senior you get, the greater the risk of exposing any ignorance. But if you stop asking questions, you're never activating the neurochemistry that gives you the tools to become a more efficient learner.'

Watson's research shows we are biologically wired to be inquisitive ('Curiosity is rewarded in the brain by the dopaminergic system – it fires up our pleasure system'), but socially conditioned to repress that urge. Babies and toddlers develop through questioning: they will point at unknown objects to find out what they are; then, once they start using language, they'll go through a phase of asking 'why' about everything. Yet from school onwards, we find ourselves in a setting where knowing the right answer is held up as the gold standard. 'So it's frankly inevitable that when we spit those young people out into the world, they're not incentivised to ask questions,' says Watson, who nonetheless believes we can retrain ourselves to be curious. 'There are some simple exercises you can do, like taking a familiar walk and forcing yourself to notice something new in the scenery, or rereading a passage in a book you know well to find novelty in it.' She also recommends the 'five whys' technique, used by the British Army in tactical situations: whenever you find yourself faced with an unresolved issue, identify the root cause of the problem by asking 'why' at least five times in succession. (Why didn't your team member make their deadline? Because they found the task overwhelming. Why did they find it so hard? Because they hadn't been trained in the correct skills – etc...)

In the workplace, building a culture of curiosity should start at the point of recruitment, says Watson. 'When you're hiring, go beyond the basic "Do you have any questions?" at the end of the interview, and instead treat the entire session as a two-way conversation,' she advises. The same goes for annual reviews: rather than asking a team member to tell you 10 things they're going to achieve this year, give them the opportunity to ask 10 questions. And if you're doing a company-wide survey, encourage employees to suggest what they genuinely want to be asked, as opposed to crafting a questionnaire designed to give you a set of pre-determined outcomes.

Claire Hollands, who joined Saatchi & Saatchi as CEO last year, says that curiosity is the most important trait she looks for in a prospective candidate. 'At entry level, we hire for aptitude and train for skills – we want people who ask thoughtful questions or challenge assumptions,' she says. One of her priorities after taking the top job was to examine, as a group, what the company's founding principle of 'Nothing is impossible' means in the real world. 'We came up with the idea of "putting the problem in the middle" – it's about being brave enough to make the most difficult issue the topic of conversation.' In an age when AI can easily solve a problem in seconds, Hollands believes what sets someone apart is their ability to push beyond the obvious course of action. 'If AI is giving us the answer, our role becomes about taking it and making it better – and that's where emotional intelligence is key.'

Zehra Chatoo, a former Meta senior executive and the founder of Code For Good Now, admits that there is an inherent paradox in the relationship between AI and curiosity, which it can both shrink and expand. 'We tend to use the technology to close knowledge gaps and secure fast answers, but I think there's an opportunity to create the conditions for deeper, more critical thinking,' she says. If you generally feel very secure in your decisions, try asking ChatGPT to tell you what would have to happen to change your mind about something, or enquiring what a beginner might notice in a situation that you, as an expert, would not. 'AI is like a mirror – you get out what you put in, so if you come to it with the objective of fuelling curiosity, that's more likely to be the result.'

In a world where we are constantly bombarded with information, and computers not only answer our questions but also anticipate what we want to ask next, it's tempting to retreat into the comfort of assumed certainty. Watson says this is what's known as 'cognitive closure', and it's very dangerous indeed: correlated, among other things, with a belief in misinformation and the endorsement of autocratic leadership. 'When we're stressed, we'll take the easy answers, because it feels safer to have them than to risk the possibility that we just don't know,' she explains. Yet to exist in that state of uncertainty is precisely what separates humans from machines – not to mention what distinguishes a great philosopher from an average one. After all, Socrates never had access to ChatGPT.

'Q: The Hidden Power of Questions in a World That Wants Answers' by Lani Watson (£22, Vintage) is out now. □

WHAT KIND OF QUESTIONER ARE YOU?

KNOWLEDGE-SEEKER

You thrive on acquiring new information for its own sake and go out of your way to do so, whether that means reading the news voraciously or examining every caption in a museum. You're valued for being meticulous and clear-sighted, but your relentless focus on seeking the truth can mean you lack empathy.

PROBLEM-SOLVER

You see questions as a route to solving challenges, often taking innovative approaches some wouldn't consider. You're naturally entrepreneurial and likely to be a go-to source of practical advice, although you can often be too quick to jump to solutions without fully interrogating an issue.

ASSUMPTION-TESTER

You're the ultimate devil's advocate, with the courage to raise objections or proffer an alternative viewpoint that most would not dare to voice. People rightly respect you for your refusal to accept received wisdom. Just remember that a confrontational attitude may not help you achieve the change you want to see.

RELATIONSHIP-BUILDER

A strong communicator, you use questions to start conversations and foster connections with others, which makes you a strong asset to a team, as well as a persuasive salesperson. You're valued for being collaborative; however, you should be wary of overstepping professional boundaries.

PHOTOGRAPH: MISHA TAYLOR/TRUNK ARCHIVE

PROFILE

RISING FORCE

How Leslie Jackson Chihuly has channelled creativity and a commitment to community into a thriving art foundation

BY LYDIA SLATER

Dale Chihuly's 'Blue and Green Tower' (2025) in situ at Palazzo Balbi Valier

THE VIEW FROM VENICE'S ACCADEMIA BRIDGE IS ALWAYS awe-inspiring, but over the past six months, visitors have been treated to an even more dramatic panorama. As you cross the Grand Canal, three monumental Dale Chihuly glass sculptures come into view: the 30-foot glittering *Gold Tower* in the garden of Palazzo Franchetti, the *Blue and Green Tower* at Palazzo Balbi Valier, and the exuberant *End of the Day Chandelier* on the terrace of the Palazzo Querini alla Carità.

This extraordinary display of outdoor art is the brainchild of Leslie Jackson Chihuly, wife of the artist and president of his studio. Thirty years ago, she helped him stage his spectacular 'Chihuly Over Venice' guerilla-art installation, with huge glass sculptures popping up overnight in the city, to the astonishment of the locals. 'The fun thing was the spontaneity,' she recalls. 'Dale got in a boat and a few of us floated around the canals, throwing artworks into the water and gathering them back up.'

The current display, by contrast, has taken her years to organise, to find suitable sites and secure the necessary permissions with the help of a local team. 'But I just really wanted to see this happen,' she says. After all, the original 'Chihuly Over Venice' exhibition was not only a landmark in the artist's career, it also informed the start of their romantic partnership. It was on one of their first dates that Dale, whom she met via a mutual friend, told her about his plan to take glassblowers around the world to learn new techniques and display the results in Venice. Leslie volunteered to help. 'We really started working together and dating at the same time, which was a full-on immersion,' she says, laughing. 'I think that's what attracted me to him the most: that he could even think that way, that he could want to do something like that, let alone accomplish it. It was very energising.'

They have worked together ever since; now, as president and CEO, Leslie runs the 58-strong studio in Seattle and oversees her husband's legacy. 'The challenge, for me, is I need to be thinking 50 years out,' she says. 'I feel a great responsibility for setting up that roadmap for the future.'

Leslie Jackson Chihuly

Born on a farm in America's Great Plains, Leslie grew up passionate about the creative arts, learning the piano and the flute, dancing and attending poetry camps. 'I was always immersed in art, and I don't think there was ever another path for me.' She found the creative process particularly therapeutic when she was coping with issues such as her parents' divorce. 'The teachers I had were really my first therapists,' she says. 'Art and music helped me through periods of lows, periods of loneliness and periods of transition. They have always been my friends.'

Her commitment to mental-health advocacy is profound and personal: her mother, who had bipolar disorder, struggled throughout her life to access a diagnosis and treatment, and died by suicide in her seventies. 'I was sad she had to go through that alone,' says Leslie. She finances a mental-health programme at Vassar, the college she attended, and the Chihuly Foundation supports arts organisations working with victims of trauma, war and homelessness.

Expanding access to art, as with the Venice project, feels more urgent to her than ever. 'To stand for art, beauty, community and access I think is important,' she says. 'These can be very, very depressing times – but I have something to do every day that I feel good about.'

'Chihuly: Venice 2026' runs until 14 November; chihulyvenice2026.com. □

PHOTOGRAPHS: © 2025 CHIHULY STUDIO. ALL RIGHTS RESERVED. PHOTOGRAPH BY NATHANIEL WILLSON, STUDIO BLACK LOCUST, DUNJA OPALKO

HOW I GOT HERE

JOANNA REYNOLDS

The CEO of the Folio Society on her talent for turnarounds

As a child, I was... ambitious. I must have been about eight or nine when the bishop at my local church asked me what I wanted to be when I grew up, and I said: 'Anything I want.' I don't think he'd expected that.

My first proper job was... in sales for Procter & Gamble. At the interview, they told me they'd never offered a woman a job before – I was the first, and coming from York, I was also the only northern female graduate. Most of the people I was selling to were men, and I remember all my post getting addressed to a 'Mr Reynolds'.

My earliest lesson in success was... that when it comes to selling, all you need to do is get someone to smile or nod – the minute they've done that, they're with you. I've never lost that knowledge – you have to engage people to persuade them to be part of what you want to do.

The best advice I've ever been given was... from one of the senior women I worked with at *Which?*, where I became the marketing director aged 30. She said: 'Never treat consumers like idiots.' Your customers will always find out if you're not being honest with them.

The Folio Society's limited edition of 'Moby-Dick' by Herman Melville

Joanna Reynolds

My biggest professional milestone was... joining the board at *Reader's Digest* in the 1990s. At the time, it had one of the biggest databases in the world, but it was losing money when I went in, and I helped turn it around. I repeated that at Time Warner, where I restructured the business and built a London office that was truly multicultural.

In my current role, I'm responsible for... doing what the Folio Society does best: producing incredibly high-quality books. Those will always remain at the heart of our mission – what has changed since I joined is that we publish a more diverse selection for a wider range of people. When I started here in 2015, 60 per cent of our customers were 62 and over, compared with 14 per cent today; back then, only five per cent of our books were in copyright, versus 95 per cent this year.

I always tell budding leaders to... listen and be open to new ideas.

My key strengths are... lateral thinking – I see outside the box when most people choose to stay inside it – and a refusal to dwell on anything: if a difficult decision has to be made, I'll make it, then move on.

SPARK JOY

Unleash your artistic spirit with colourful desk accoutrements

Clockwise from above: Alec Issigonis, the designer of the Mini, in 1962. Ladybird heritage 'Bullet', 1956. Constructing Jacobsen's Egg Chair. A vintage R55 Caliber movement, 1956

A TIMELESS LEGACY

The Fifties proved to be a seminal period in the history of design, and the era's sleek and refined look feels as fresh today as it did 70 years ago

WHILE THE DECADE IS OFTEN OVERSHADOWED BY THE louder, brasher mood of the Sixties, the Fifties were a time of great experimentation and innovation, which in turn led to a new form of elegance. A collective optimism informed the visual language of the era – known as the Atomic Age – when science and technology combined with artistry to reinvent the defining aesthetics of society. Consider some of the most notable design accomplishments of the era: Alec Issigonis' Mini car, Arne Jacobsen's famous Egg Chair, Balenciaga's sack dress and Pierre Cardin's bubble-shaped skirts.

In 1956, Blancpain – the world's oldest watchmaking house – contributed its own game-changing design in the form of the Ladybird, a horological landmark that featured the smallest round movement ever created. Unlike most inventions of this epoch, however, this sophisticated watch was envisaged – and brought to life – by a woman.

Betty Fiechter was 16 years old when she embarked on an apprenticeship at Blancpain's workshop in Villeret, the Swiss village nestled in the Jura mountains, where Jean-Jacques Blancpain established his eponymous company in 1735. From 1912, she worked with Frédéric-Emile Blancpain, the seventh generation to run the family business. After his death in 1932, she became the CEO – a first for a major watchmaker, and quite an achievement in an era when Swiss women were unable to vote.

Fiechter's boldness, vision and business nous meant that she understood how under-served women were in the

PHOTOGRAPHS: GETTY IMAGES, COURTESY OF FRITZ HANSEN

Clockwise from above: a model wears Pierre Cardin's bubble skirt in 1958. The Blancpain Ladybird 'Perle Corail', 1965-75. CEO Betty Fiechter

male-dominated watchmaking industry. She knew that women's timepieces deserved the same ingenuity and mechanical integrity as any other watch. And this speciality became one of Blancpain's defining strengths.

Fiechter's talents were reinforced by those of her nephew, Jean-Jacques Fiechter, who joined her at the company in 1950. The Ladybird, a triumph of miniaturisation, became one of their most enduring creations. Its shrunken proportions were in keeping with the mood of the period.

As Europe started to recover from the devastation of war, each nation embarked on a programme of rebuilding. Of course, with depleted materials and rationing still very much in place, homes became smaller, which in turn led to the evolution of a new interiors style that prioritised function together with a streamlined sensibility.

This optimistic, minimalist design became known as mid-century modernism. And its influence – the clean lines and a focus on organic shapes – can clearly be seen in the Ladybird's own form. Technology also enabled complex mechanical structures to shrink; the microchip, after all, was developed in 1958, a year before the very first Mini was produced by the British Motor Corporation. Such breakthroughs allowed Blancpain to enter a new era of creativity, with the miniature form giving rise to watch jewels: gold bracelets and cuff watches, bangles set with glorious, ornamental stones and sparkling diamonds.

Seventy years later, the Mini is among the top 10 best-selling cars in the UK, microchips are powering our smartphones and Mid-Century Modern furniture continues to dominate interiors

Science and technology combined with artistry to reinvent the defining aesthetics of society

Clockwise from top left: Betty Fiechter. Meticulously placing the hands on a Blancpain watch face. The new Blancpain Lady B. A Pierre Cardin fashion show, 1958

trends. On catwalks this year, we've witnessed the return of the cocoon silhouette, as well as a resurgence in the 'ladylike' elegance so synonymous with the 1950s. Some celebrities – most notably the actress Elle Fanning and the singer Ariana Grande – have even plucked gowns directly from the archives, wearing glamorous Fifties creations for major red-carpet events.

The new Blancpain Lady B, then, arrives at the perfect time, remaining true to the spirit of the original Ladybird – that is, fine watchmaking that fits into an object the size of a single jewel – yet perfectly in step with the zeitgeist. This modern riff on the original design is a biomorphic wonder akin to wearable sculpture. Naturally, it is entirely mechanical; Blancpain has never produced a quartz watch, preferring instead to focus on the skilled craftsmanship needed to ensure its timepieces always beat. Comprising 180 components and 29 rubies, it is at once impeccably simple and meticulously complex.

The case alone is illustrative of this fact: this tiny, perfectly formed sphere measures just 2.9 cubic centimetres. The architecture is so precise that, when viewed from above, the back of the watch appears invisible, resulting in a shape of monolithic volume that seems to be carved from a single block. Similarly impressive, the Blancpain Lady B is without lugs to

From top: Givenchy's sculptural draped skirt, 1957. The Blancpain Lady B features a double-tour calf-leather strap and comes in stainless steel or 18ct red gold. Iconic chair designs from Verner Panton

secure the strap, with the supple leather instead passing directly through the case. Sharp edges are finished by hand with traditional cabron tools, while engravings are completed by mechanical cutters to achieve the depth, sharpness and finishing quality that makes Blancpain a bastion of luxury and impeccable design. The dial, meanwhile, is deliberately free of setting, dressed in a warm opaline hue that's achieved with gold inlay.

In our current age, when AI technology is raising many more questions than solutions when it comes to the matters of invention and creativity, more of us are returning to the concept of craft as a true signifier of quality. It is no coincidence that some of the most recognisable designs and trends of the Fifties are enjoying a renaissance now – they continue to have an impact on our everyday lives, imbuing them with a little more beauty and ingenuity.

Visit Blancpain at 11 New Bond Street, London W1, or discover more at blancpain.com.

PHOTOGRAPHS: ALAMY, GETTY IMAGES

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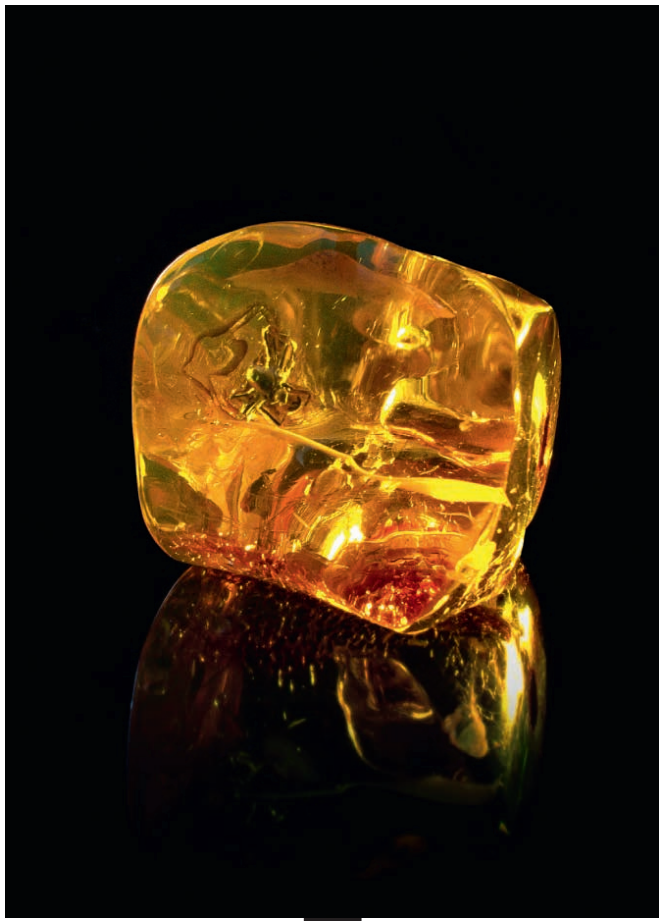

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BAZAAR

talking points

EDITED BY
CHARLOTTE BROOK

Panel show

Ptolemy Mann's handwoven artworks evoke the brilliant hues of a Mexican city. Plus: Elif Shafak takes on a titan of literature; Celia Birtwell revisits her creative partnership with Ossie Clark; Stephen Mangan talks Chekhov; and how to fall back in love with letter-writing

'Gilardi (Green)' (2026) by Ptolemy Mann

PHOTOGRAPH BY THE ARTIST, COURTESY OF TRISTIAN HOARE GALLERY AND PAD LONDON

Ptolemy Mann in her studio

DESIGN

COLOUR BLOCKS

Ptolemy Mann's vivid Mexico-inspired woven panels light up PAD London fair

BY CHLOË ASHBY

PTOLEMY MANN'S ADMIRATION FOR THE 20TH-CENTURY Mexican architect Luis Barragán began back when she was a student at the Royal College of Art in 1996, learning to weave and hand-dye textiles that she would stretch over frames to create her decorative pieces. 'The biggest thing I learnt from him is the idea of chromatic minimalism,' she says, explaining how she drew inspiration from his vast concrete walls painted hot pink, burnt orange and lime green. 'I love those sweeping planes of colour – they're simple, but incredibly bright and vivid.'

Thirty years on, she's exhibiting a new body of work inspired by Barragán at the art fair PAD London: finely threaded panels of gently undulating colour that evoke the feeling of standing inside Barragán's buildings. Last spring, Mann, who was born in New York and grew up on the south coast of England, finally made it to Mexico City for the first time and visited half a dozen of his modernist masterpieces. 'It's funny, when you've only ever seen photographs of spaces, and then you find yourself standing inside them,' she says, smiling. 'The trip was a bit of an epiphany for me.'

Her triptych of blue woven textiles streaked with orange and red references Barragán's final residential project, Casa Gilardi, with its famous indoor swimming pool, a geranium-pink pillar rising from the aqua-blue water. Another piece calls to mind Casa Pedregal, a pastel-coloured house on dry, rocky terrain dotted with succulents described by Mann as both 'lush and desert-like'. There are also nods to Donald Judd, Ellsworth Kelly and Barnett Newman – 'those New York minimalists'. From afar, you might mistake the designs for paintings, cousins of Mark Rothko's expansive glowing veils; come closer, though, and you'll notice the threads, which are dip-dyed using the ancient ikat technique.

Alongside a group presentation at PAD, Mann will be exhibiting at Frieze Masters, followed by a solo show at Tristan Hoare in November – an extension of this Barragán-infused body of work. Although she has recently experimented with painting, this autumn she's sticking with woven art in 'its purest form', rather than the 'thread paintings' she has been making since 2021. 'It's a triple whammy, with both fairs and the solo show,' says Mann. 'The journey has been long but the timing is good. A big moment indeed.'

Ptolemy Mann is exhibiting with Tristan Hoare at PAD London (padesignart.com) from 13 until 18 October. □

BEST IN SHOW

A trio of unmissable exhibits at PAD London

NOE KUREMOTO
AT PIK'D
Best known for her imaginative white vessels, the Japanese sculptor uses clay to explore ideas connected to motherhood and mythology.

KATE MALONE
AT ADRIAN SASSOON
A keen plantswoman, the ceramicist draws inspiration from the organic shapes she finds in her Kent garden.

CARLO BUGATTI
AT YVES SALOMON EDITIONS
Yves Salomon presents original pieces by the art nouveau pioneer as the fashion brand continues its foray into fine furniture.

Right: Chappell Roan (2025) photographed by Tim Walker

'BASKET CASE' BY DANIELLA PARETE CLARKE. PHOTOGRAPHS: GETTY IMAGES, TIM WALKER, KESTUTIS ZILIONIS. COURTESY OF PIK'D AND PAD LONDON, SYLVAIN DELEU, COURTESY OF ADRIAN SASSOON AND PAD LONDON, CIRCE HAMILTON, COURTESY OF TRISTAN HOARE GALLERY

FILM

BASKET CASE

In *Wicker*, the year's most audacious cinematic offering, Olivia Colman stars as a fisherwoman in mediaeval England who hires a basketweaver to make her a husband out of wicker. Colman's heroine is wholly awakened by the resulting Frankenstein-esque creature – played by Alexander Skarsgård – setting off a wave of envy through the village. The film is at once a fable about defying convention and an entertainingly steamy romp – just try not to think about splinters.

EXHIBITIONS

DREAM WORLD

Social workers, superstars and Stonewall founders rub shoulders in 'Tim Walker's Fairyland: Love and Legends' at the National Portrait Gallery (9 October until 7 February 2027; npg.org.uk). The joyous celebration of LGBTQ+ culture – which features shots of more than 250 individuals – lets us into the photographer's imaginative way of seeing life.

Tim Walker's works, from left: Maartje Convens and Marin Céleste (2022). Paul O'Grady, Julian Clary, Harry Browse, Rae and Liam Elias (2022)

Eilen Itzel do Espírito Santo. Below: the artist's work

ART

KINDRED SPIRITS

A meeting of creative minds brings fresh feeling to Frieze London

BY KATIE BAXTER

'I am endlessly impressed by her unwavering commitment to joy,' says Firelei Báez of Eilen Itzel do Espírito Santo. The painter has selected the rising star for this year's Artist-to-Artist at Frieze London – a programme that sees seven established figures spotlight an emerging creative. 'Her installations, paintings and drawings embody a rigorous, unapologetic freedom.'

That life-affirming energy pulses through the pieces Do Espírito Santo has chosen for her Frieze debut, which is structured around three pillars of creation: the making of an object, the making of a person and the making of one's destiny. Primal motifs – breasts, milk ducts, cells – appear throughout the exhibition. 'My work is bold, colourful and intuitive,' she says. 'I want people to feel happy and curious about making.' The theme of community, which is central to Do Espírito Santo's practice, also emerges. 'There's the idea of passing the torch; a generational shift; a consciousness entering and contributing to the group.'

This spirit of exchange lies at the heart of the initiative itself, which is designed to encourage creative dialogue across generations. 'This is such a vital programme, precisely for its capacity to foreground artists like Eilen,' says Báez. 'Her art carries the kind of freshness that the contemporary-art world so badly needs.'

The link between Do Espírito Santo and Báez is cultural and creative. Both have Afro-Dominican heritage and engage with questions of diasporic identity in their work. 'We share that context,' says Do Espírito Santo. 'It feels good for my Frieze debut to happen through a connection to an artist I deeply admire.' *Artist-to-Artist supported by Tiffany & Co is at Frieze London (frieze.com) from 14 to 18 October.*

THEATRE

SEEN AND HEARD

The resonant theme of surveillance culture is brilliantly explored in *The Lives of Others*, a play that marks Keira Knightley's West End return (thelivesofothersplay.com; from 14 October to 9 January). Adapted for the stage by Robert Icke from the Oscar-winning thriller set in 1984, it follows a couple in East Germany whose attic is infiltrated by an agent listening for signs of subversion.

'SEEN AND HEARD' BY DANIELLA PARETE CLARKE. PHOTOGRAPHS: RACHEL LOUISE BROWN, OLIVER ROSSER, FEAST CREATIVE, COURTESY OF TIFFANY & CO

BOOKS

UNSHELVED

Elif Shafak's new female-centric novel threatens to knock a literary great off his pedestal

BY ERICA WAGNER

ELIF SHAFAK IS ONE OF OUR MOST ADMIRED AND WIDELY READ novelists. Her books have been translated into nearly 60 languages and are international bestsellers, winning her nominations for almost every major award. She has a style that is both clear and poetic, distinguished not only by compassion for her human characters but also by a powerful sense of the natural world and her refusal to accept miscarriages of justice as inevitable.

Shafak – who is now based in London – has experienced injustice at a deep level: in 2006, she was charged with 'insulting Turkishness' in her native country. This was following the release of her novel *The Bastard of Istanbul*, which addresses the Armenian genocide; photographs of her were burnt in the street and she was called a traitor. Then, in 2019, she was investigated by Turkish prosecutors because she writes about child abuse and sexual violence. So, when I ask her what it's like to be so idolised in the literary sphere, she answers with a wry smile: 'When you're a writer from a country as complicated as Turkey, your experience will always be mixed. I liken this to being kissed on one cheek and slapped on the other. I have been sued, prosecuted, investigated, but in the midst of all that madness, I always felt so much love from readers – it's what has kept me sane.'

Elif Shafak

Her courage as a writer has led her to take on issues including the plight of Turkish sex workers and the suffering of the Yazidis, to name two recent examples. With her latest novel *In One Brief Moment All Eternity*, she demonstrates another kind of literary bravery by upending our perspective on one of the most scandalous books ever written, *Madame Bovary*. It might seem like a departure from her earlier work, but it is a story she has always loved, and its portrait of a woman pushing against the constraints of her time and place resonates with her own themes.

A daring examination of the writer Gustave Flaubert, her narrative is told by a series of women – real and fictional – who, for the first time, are granted the power to give their side of the story. Leading the charge is Emma Bovary herself, who questions her creator's decision to kill her off with arsenic. 'Why would I trust a man who has gone to such lengths to persuade me to take my own life?' muses the character. 'If Flaubert's intention was to make a bad example of me, as I cannot help but suspect, may I remind him that he himself is far from being a paragon of virtue.'

Adding to the reinterpretation of Flaubert are the voices of historical women who knew and observed him, from a devoted nursemaid to an abandoned lover. Most notable is that of Kuchuk Hanem – a famed belly dancer Flaubert encountered on a trip to Egypt from 1849 to 1850. As Shafak writes, she inspired him by making him consider 'in earnest the dangers facing women who, in one way or another, flout the expectations of society'.

When I ask Shafak if writing about such a famous author and his best-known book was intimidating, she laughs. 'It frightened me so much!' she says. 'The balance between research and artistic freedom is not an easy one to strike. How do you take on a subject that is so thoroughly examined and documented, and then fly with it wherever your imagination takes you?'

For Shafak, the answer is that there is always more to say about a book that continues to be read, and to resonate, 170 years after it was published. Emma Bovary, married and stuck in the sticks, yearns for more. Her desire, in the end, destroys her. 'Emma is not a very likeable character,' Shafak says, 'which is a huge risk on the part of any author. But Flaubert taps into something timeless: the gap between what we have and what we want to have – what we cannot have. I think that's fundamental, existential, and it doesn't change.'

If you haven't read *Madame Bovary*, don't fret: *In One Brief Moment All Eternity* works even if you've never heard of Gustave Flaubert. 'I hope readers with different levels of knowledge or experience will enjoy it,' says Shafak. 'That's the beauty of literature.'

'In One Brief Moment All Eternity' by Elif Shafak (£20, Viking) is out on 15 October. □

EXHIBITIONS

WOVEN TOGETHER

As an exhibition celebrating their collaboration opens, *Celia Birtwell* shares the stand-out looks she co-created with her late husband Ossie Clark

OPHELIA DRESS, 1969

The dress I married Ossie in, Ophelia, is soft and beautiful. 'Floating Daisy' was one of the simplest prints I've done, and it hit the note. Ossie was a one-of-a kind cutter whose clothes had a hard edge to them, whereas my contribution was to create softer prints that people seemed to like.

PINK VELVET SUIT, EARLY 1970S

I made this pink velvet skirt suit featuring the 'Lily Marlene' print in the Seventies. It was done at Ivo Prints in Southall, where I printed all my fabrics. The shape is rather Edwardian – it felt very nice to wear.

HEAVENLY TWINS DRESS, 1970

Heavenly Twins is the dress I wore in David Hockney's painting *Mr and Mrs Clark and Percy*. The postcard of that artwork is one of the most widely sold in the UK. Everyone seems to know about it...

DICK TURPIN COAT, 1969

I adore this. It's a powder-blue gabardine coat made with such style – well done, Mr Clark. Ossie could make, sew, cut and draw. Partly why I'm doing this exhibition is so that he is not forgotten.

FLORAL CREPE DRESS, 1971

The wool embroidery on this trellis-pattern dress was done by a marvellous badge-maker I found. I love that it hasn't dated – it gives me great pleasure to see my daughters and granddaughters wearing these clothes.

'Ossie Clark + Celia Birtwell' is at the Fashion and Textile Museum (fashiontextilemuseum.org) until 11 April 2027.

BOOKS

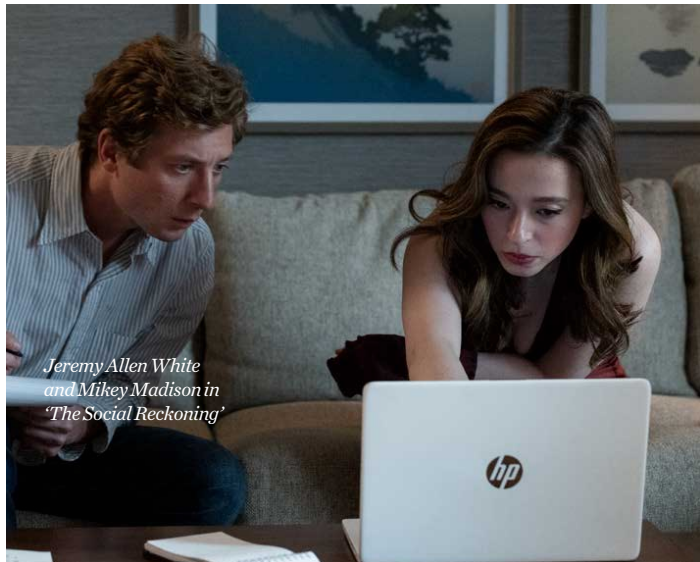
RED-LETTER DAY

For anyone who eagerly awaits the postman's arrival or would like to put pen to paper more often, Martina Calvi's new book *The Art of Snail Mail* (£16.99, Quadrille) will get the stamp of approval. Learn how to make a wax seal and stickers for essential envelope elevation, craft a perfect love letter or simply spruce up a standard postcard.

FILM

INTO THE METAVERSE

'We're post-government around here.' This is just one of the horrifying but amusing lines delivered by a fully indoctrinated employee in *The Social Reckoning*, the sequel to 2010's *The Social Network*, which comes to cinemas this month. We join Mark Zuckerberg (originally played by Jesse Eisenberg; now, 15 years on, by Jeremy Strong) as the man in charge not only of Facebook but also Meta, as the *WSJ* reporter (Jeremy Allen White) realises Zuckerberg and his company have chosen money over morals.



Jeremy Allen White and Mikey Madison in 'The Social Reckoning'

'WOVEN TOGETHER' AS TOLD TO DANIELLA PARETE CLARKE. 'INTO THE METAVERSE' BY CHARLOTTE BROOK. PHOTOGRAPHS: © 2026 CTMG, INC. ALL RIGHTS RESERVED, LEAH GALLO, TATE, © ESTATE OF DAVID HOCKNEY, JONATHAN RICHARDS PICTURE STUDIO, © FASHION AND TEXTILE MUSEUM

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ART

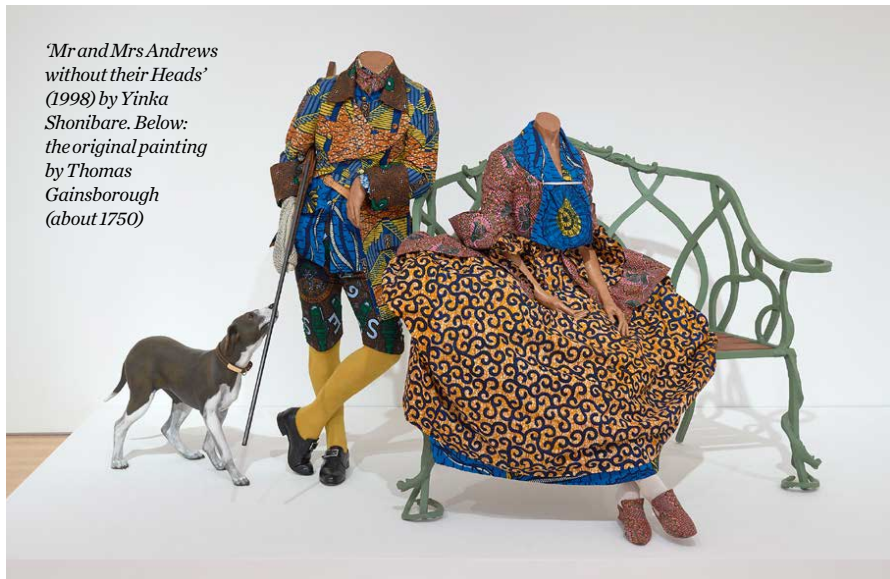
WELL EXECUTED

See a classical masterpiece in dialogue with its maverick reinterpretation at the National Gallery

In 1998, the British artist Yinka Shonibare reimagined Thomas Gainsborough's famous 1750 painting *Mr and Mrs Andrews* as a sculpture, cloaking its subjects in West African textiles to address the threads of colonialism that ran through 18th-century Britain. Shonibare made the couple as rich and fashionable as before, but he took off one key detail: their heads.

Now, the decapitated pair – whose fate mirrors that of many aristocrats during the French Revolution – are on show alongside the original artwork, inciting a debate between art-world icons, in the 300th-anniversary year of Gainsborough's birth. DANIELLA PARETE CLARKE

'Yinka Shonibare and Thomas Gainsborough: a Conversation' is at the National Gallery (nationalgallery.org.uk) until 7 February 2027.



'Mr and Mrs Andrews without their Heads' (1998) by Yinka Shonibare. Below: the original painting by Thomas Gainsborough (about 1750)

'INTO THE WOODS' BY DANIELLA PARETE CLARKE. PHOTOGRAPHS: ©THE NATIONAL GALLERY, LONDON. @COURTESY THE ARTIST, STEPHEN FRIEDMAN GALLERY, LONDON. IMAGE COURTESY NATIONAL GALLERY OF CANADA, OTTAWA. PHOTO: STEPHEN WHITE, ©ITV. FLORIE BERGER

Tadashi Kawamata at work. Above left: the artist in his studio. Above right: one of his pieces for Ruinart

ART

INTO THE WOODS

The Japanese artist Tadashi Kawamata is celebrated for his large-scale installations that interrogate the push and pull between creation and destruction. Intricate and intriguing, his latest structures will take over the Ruinart Champagne & Art Bar at this year's Frieze London in an exhibition titled 'Conversations with Nature'. A celebration of reclaimed wood's natural beauty, it will feature timber objects and models of miniature tree huts built from planks that resemble popsicle sticks.

TELEVISION

UNHAPPY RETURNS

Class envy, unrequited feelings and long-held secrets destabilise a birthday celebration in this gripping new show

Everyone's invited to the five-part ITV dramatisation of *The Party*, Elizabeth Day's biting thriller that chronicles the life, loneliness and obsessive love of its protagonist Martin (Luke Evans), who develops a quasi-homoerotic attachment to his school classmate, the wealthy, confident Ben. We follow the pair through Cambridge University and find them at the 40th-birthday bash of Ben, now a politician, where a dreadful event has occurred and Martin is in the frame. Adapted by Sarah Solemani – who also plays Martin's wife, while Joanna Scanlan is his mother – the series has the best of British screen talent on board, and is set to showcase some of the country's worst characters and class issues. Save the date!

CHARLOTTE BROOK

'The Party' is on ITVX from 11 October.

Luke Evans and Sarah Solemani in 'The Party'

ART

FRAME OF MIND

The National Portrait Gallery director Victoria Siddall shares her bigger picture

BY CHARLOTTE BROOK

Victoria Siddall. Below: Nieves González's portrait of Lily Allen. Below left: 'Lady Margaret Beaufort, Countess of Richmond and Derby' (about 1510) by Meynart Weywyck

VICTORIA SIDDALL NEVER EXPECTED TO BE RUNNING ONE OF London's most eminent art institutions. 'I'd not lived in the city and I knew nothing about "the art world" growing up. It wasn't my area. I studied English and philosophy in Bristol!' says the National Portrait Gallery's director. 'But I knew that I wanted to work in a creative field.' Now, two years into the role, having orchestrated a record-breaking fundraiser (this year's gala made £1 million – the most in its history) and a few blockbuster exhibitions, she has big plans.

> 'We're looking for figures shaping our world and culture, and contributing to society'

While working as a writer at Christie's auctioneers, 'when contemporary art was exploding' – Siddall swung by the first Frieze Art Fair in 2003: she applied for a job with the organisation and stayed there for 18 years. 'Bringing together different art, artists, galvanising the city – it was exciting,' says Siddall, who also introduced Frieze Masters because she found the juxtaposition of new and old 'interesting – and fresh'.

Honouring history alongside chronicling the present has been central to the NPG's vision since its doors opened 170 years ago. Siddall, who prizes the story behind the picture as much as its aesthetic appeal, is building on this legacy. This is a place where one can hang out with Shakespeare, Lily Allen and Malala Yousafzai for free – as well as Elton John and David Furnish, whose photograph with their sons was taken by Catherine Opie and unveiled last spring. Next year, you can step inside the world of the American Impressionist Mary Cassatt in a solo retrospective.

Other items at the top of Siddall's to-do list include programmes that educate children – the Princess of Wales, a patron, is involved in one that brings art to under-fives. These are chosen to reflect the state of the nation. 'The collection begins with Henry VIII. We are by no means suggesting everybody represented in the gallery only did good. It's more nuanced than that,' Siddall says. 'We're looking for figures shaping our world and culture, and contributing to society. We've just hung portraits of Marcus Rashford, as well as a surgeon, a civil-rights activist and Jane Goodall. It's about different faces, and people doing extraordinary things.' □

PHOTOGRAPHS: ALAMY, GARETH GARDNER, GETTY IMAGES, RACHEL LOUISE BROWN, NIEVES GONZÁLEZ/ NATIONAL PORTRAIT GALLERY LONDON. ILLUSTRATION BY LILY PICHON FLANNERY

THEATRE

DEEP ROOTS

For Stephen Mangan, tragedy and comedy are the fruits of the same thespian tree

BY FRANCES HEDGES

STEPHEN MANGAN HASN'T HAD much sleep when I speak to him. By night, he's performing in the West End; by day, he's rehearsing for the upcoming production of Chekhov's *The Cherry Orchard* at the Harold Pinter Theatre, where he'll appear opposite Kristin Scott Thomas. He may have three decades of acting experience under his belt, but Mangan says this stage of putting together a play still terrifies him. 'We're at the point in rehearsals when you don't know how to walk, or talk... Even though, in the evenings, I'm doing a fully fledged performance, during the day, I feel like I've forgotten how to act,' he says. 'Because you're trying to discover what's in those scenes, who the characters are and how they're interacting. You just trust the clouds will part and something comes through – it always does.'

For Mangan, the power of *The Cherry Orchard* – which follows the diminishing fortunes of a Russian aristocratic family in the early 20th century as they come to terms with the prospect of losing their beloved ancestral estate – lies in the universality of its themes. 'It's about how people can't connect with each other, how they don't listen to each other – how we all have our own longings that blind us to what others are going through,' he explains. 'Chekhov wrote about very specific people with very specific problems, yet because he was such an astute observer of human beings, his work is timeless.'

Mangan plays Lopakhin, who has acquired significant wealth but, as the son of peasants, grapples with a sense of inherited shame – a sentiment with which the actor says he can empathise. 'As someone who comes from an Irish working-class family but also benefited from a classic, upper-end English education – boarding school and Cambridge – I understand that question of how you honour your past when you've moved into a new social sphere.'

Mangan himself appears to shift seamlessly between worlds and genres. The theatre has been a constant in his career – if it weren't for wanting to spend time with his family, he says he'd 'do nothing else' – but his back catalogue is varied: there have been comic turns in crowd-pleasing comedies such as *Green Wing* and *Episodes*, and a quietly devastating portrayal of a bitter divorce in *The Split* (he co-starred with Nicola Walker, whom he has known since adolescence – a connection that made for crucial on-screen chemistry). 'I don't see a difference between comedy and serious roles,' he says. 'The hard work we're doing now in rehearsal is to make either look effortless – that's the job and it never gets any easier, but it's always fascinating.'

'The Cherry Orchard' is at the Harold Pinter Theatre until 9 January 2027 (thecherryorchardplay.co.uk). □

BOOKS

TIME TRAVELLER

Russell T Davies is publishing a memoir about his life in television, *The Queerest of Folk* (£25, Bantam). Written with all the wit and warmth you'd expect from the mastermind behind *It's a Sin*, *Years and Years* and a seminal era of *Dr Who*, it is a personal tribute to the uniting power of our other national sport: telly.

Clockwise from right: *Dr Who*'s Tardis. A Dalek. A moment from *It's a Sin*. Russell T Davies' memoir

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BAZAAR

living

EDITED BY
FRANCES HEDGES

Free spirit

Marisa Berenson welcomes us into her Marrakesh home, a rich reflection of her bohemian life and kaleidoscopic style. Plus: fabulous fireplaces; the art of framing; and we unveil our debut furniture collaboration

Marisa Berenson in the courtyard of her Marrakesh home

PHOTOGRAPHY KAREL BALAS. STYLED BY MATHIEU BERTORELLO. HAIR BY CIGI SVAHN. MAKE-UP BY TONI SAHN. PRODUCTION LEWIS OLIVIER AND MARIE COURTIN. THE MOROCCAN CREW

Pictured at home in Marrakesh, Marisa Berenson wears clothes from her collection for Zara throughout. Opposite, from left: the courtyard, with a bed that once belonged to Elsa Schiaparelli. A corner of Berenson's bedroom, featuring a fireplace with religious icons on the mantelpiece

Pillar of society

The model, actress and enduring style icon Marisa Berenson invites us into her artistically imagined Moroccan home

BY CÉDRIC SAINT ANDRÉ PERRIN PHOTOGRAPHS BY KAREL BALAS STYLED BY MATTHIEU BERTORELLO

IT WAS ABOUT 10 YEARS AGO THAT MARISA BERENSON, WHO FOR many years divided her time between New York and Paris, decided to set up home amid the palm groves of Marrakesh, in a villa of her own design. 'I fell in love with the peaceful lifestyle here,' she explains. 'I'd rented a few places when I heard on the grapevine that this had come up for sale. It was totally dilapidated – like a haunted house – but it just gave out this energy. In another life, I'd have been an interior designer. Everything here is my vision: it has taken me three years to make the place feel like mine. It's a perfect representation of my style – that is, a complete mishmash! A bit like me – I'm American, but with French and Italian roots.'

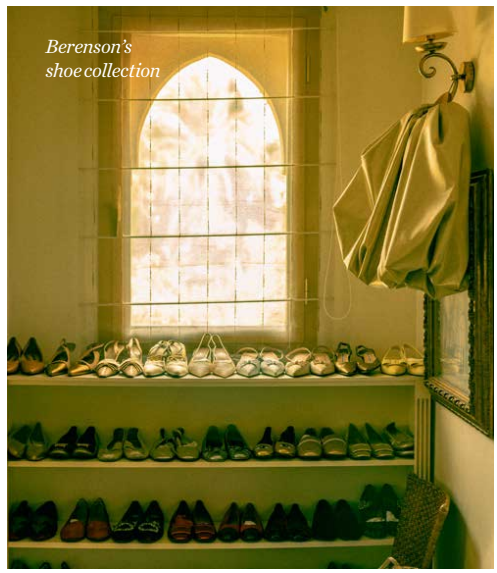
The property is designed in the style of a riad, with rooms set around a central courtyard with a fountain, but Berenson hasn't stuck too rigidly to Moroccan traditions: she has also introduced blue and white azulejo tiles from Seville and a fresco decorated with angels that looks as if it belongs in a Spanish church. 'It's a whole kaleidoscope of images, with Arab-Andalusian references, of course, but also Venetian motifs, like those in the living-room. I've inherited a lot of French furniture and objects, including an Empire-style sofa that belonged to my grandmother, Elsa Schiaparelli. A lot of things have been with me my whole life and have followed me from home to home, between London and New York.' In the dressing-room are several line drawings that Jean Cocteau dedicated to Schiaparelli, while, here and there, metal butterflies painted by the artist Joy de Rohan Chabot – a friend of Berenson – flutter across the walls.

Every object tells its own story or marks a moment in the life of the homeowner – a life that, since childhood, has been chronicled on the pages of countless glossy magazines. Berenson's christening portrait was published in American *Vogue*; indeed, it was the magazine's then editor-in-chief, Diana Vreeland – a friend of the family who was like a godmother to her – who launched her modelling career, putting her on the cover when she was just 16. She went on to appear in the 1971 film *Death in Venice*, having been introduced to its director Luchino Visconti by one of her lovers, the Austrian actor Helmut Berger. Roles in Bob Fosse's *Cabaret* (1972) and Stanley Kubrick's *Barry Lyndon* (1975) followed; for the latter, she made the cover of *Time*, dressed as the tragic beauty Lady Lyndon.

Berenson went to all the great parties of the 1970s, and was often seen at Studio 54 and Flipper's Roller Boogie Palace. Her social circle included Yves Saint Laurent, Halston, Valentino... no designer could resist her chic, bohemian allure. She travelled through India, crossing paths with the Beatles and Mia Farrow,

and discovered yoga and meditation along the way. In 1976, she married the American millionaire James Randall, with Liza Minnelli, George Hamilton, Lee Radziwill and Andy Warhol at the wedding; the following year, the couple had a daughter, Starlite.

Berenson's own star has never faded: she has continued to appear in cult films – among them Luca Guadagnino's *I Am Love* (2009) – and only last year, she returned to modelling for a Valentino campaign. A front-row fixture, she never misses a Schiaparelli show, and stands out in a crowd with her magnetic presence, intense gaze and strong, aristocratic bearing. Her signature look – loose, wavy hair, floaty dresses, folk jewellery and handcrafted accessories – gives her a certain free-spirited elegance. 'I'm quite eclectic in my style,' she says. 'I'll pair caftans and beachwear with high jewellery, and mix casual daywear with evening dress. I'm pretty spontaneous, to be honest – I'll go into my closet, which is full of outfits I've been wearing since the Eighties, and slip on a gown as easily as I pull on a pair of jeans. It's not about the occasion or how fashionable something might be; it depends on my mood. I might add rhinestone bracelets, coral necklaces, a turban... I wear a lot of accessories. You couldn't call me a minimalist!'



Berenson's shoe collection

Earlier this year, Berenson unveiled a capsule collection for Zara, the House of Marisa Berenson, for which she drew direct inspiration from her own wardrobe. There were fluid Sixties-style dresses; a cropped puffball cape in gold lamé that feels like it could have come straight out of an Eighties couture show; and a metallic bomber jacket with a disco vibe. 'I wanted it to feel like a collision of different eras – something a bit glamorous that gets people dreaming. And I liked the idea of injecting a bit of fantasy into my homeware designs, too. I find people's houses are so monochrome these days – I wanted to create things that were colourful, fairy-tale, symbolic; pieces that dress a room – like fringed cushions or a coral-inspired candelabra – in the same way that accessories make an outfit pop. And I designed the tableware to be used in everyday life, not just for hosting.'

Is Berenson herself constantly entertaining or going to parties? 'My day-to-day life revolves around my home and garden in Marrakesh,' she tells me. 'I have a vegetable garden, hens, ducks, even a turkey. Every morning, I go swimming, meditate... I'm not out at the fashionable hot spots any more.

'Nowadays, I'm mostly focused on my work. I've been in a couple of films lately: one called *Ma Famille Chérie*, about a chaotic family holiday, and Arielle Dombasle's Charles Baudelaire biopic. Then there's fashion, which has always been one of my biggest passions – I have it in my blood, even if we never talked about it as a family – and jewellery: I design pieces for the Royal Mansour in Marrakesh and for Donna Karan in the US.'

Berenson is constantly juggling multiple projects. 'I never plan anything, but when an opportunity comes along, I seize it,' she says. 'More than anything else, I like being surrounded by creatives, film lovers, photographers, designers – talented individuals who have a vision and conjure up a universe. I'm sensitive to the vibes that come from people, places, special moments. I take on the energy from all those and use it to create characters, books, now even clothing and homeware – a first for me.' A first venture, perhaps, but surely not her last. □

HAIR BY CICCI SVAHN. MAKE-UP BY TOM SAPIN. PRODUCTION BY EMMA OLIVIER AND MARIE COURTIN/THE MOROCCAN CREW. TRANSLATION BY FRANCES HEDGES

The Kensington home of Romanos Brihi, co-founder of Studio Vero

DECORATING

PICTURE THIS

How to frame your art collection for maximum impact

BY DINA NAGAPETYANTS

EARLIER THIS YEAR, BUCKINGHAM PALACE UNVEILED A 'salon-style' rehang of its collection, delighting visitors by taking the number of masterpieces on public view from 63 to 120. While floor-to-ceiling gold-rimmed Caravaggios probably isn't the look most homeowners are going for, the reimagined space offers a reminder that both the frames you choose and the way you hang them can make all the difference.

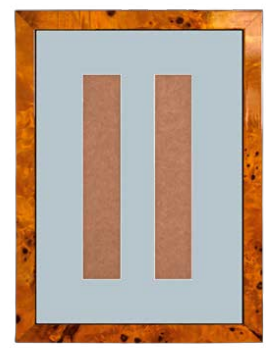
'Framing shouldn't be an afterthought,' says the interior designer Venetia Rudebeck of Studio Vero. 'Art is integral to a scheme, and the frame is an extension of that.' The breadth of options may seem overwhelming but, as a starting point, she recommends picking out a non-dominant colour from the artwork and selecting a suitable corresponding shade. Canvases, textile art and three-dimensional pieces look especially striking in shadowbox frames that provide a sense of depth and a beguiling interplay of light and shadow. Experiment with coloured window mounts (a bright hue can be the perfect foil for a monochrome print), or create more breathing room with a floating mount, which is particularly effective for showing off works on heavy paper. And don't feel constrained by a single historical style: 'If you want a more layered look in the home, try a mix of antique, new and colourful frames,' says Rudebeck. 'The great thing about a "salon hang" is that you can mix things that are less strong with more serious pieces, and it will create a balance.'

The location of an artwork is crucial, says Nathalie Martin, who owns the conservation-framing studio Gloucester Room. 'Don't hang anything in front of a direct source of light, even if it has superb glazing on,' she advises (in a darker space, overhead picture lights are a safer option); other risk factors include humidity and open fireplaces, not to mention boisterous children and pets. If the piece is of significant value, protecting it appropriately will come at greater expense – Gloucester Room recommends museum-grade glass or acrylic glazing – but less costly pictures also deserve a treatment that corresponds to their sentimental value. Even if your personal gallery is rather humbler than Buckingham Palace's, what's inside it is just as precious.

Studio Vero (studio-vero.com); Gloucester Room (gloucesterroom.com). □

MORA THE MERRIER

Founded by Shauna Moran in 2025, Mora Interiors makes the framing process easy and fun: simply select your preferred material (from glossy lacquer to burl wood), mount colour and aperture. The hardest part? Choosing from the nearly 90 options on offer. *morainteriors.com*



FOOD & DRINK

CULINARY ARTS

Where to dine if you're capitalising on the cultural scene this autumn

FOR FRIEZE: ORRERY BY PIERRE MINOTTI

Enjoy elevated French classics – from galette Bretonne to bouillabaisse – at a Marylebone institution. *orrery-restaurant.co.uk*

FOR PAD: MOUNT ST RESTAURANT

Pheasant pâté en croûte and 'lethal negronis' feature on the Mayfair dining-room's new art-inspired menu. *mountstrestaurant.com*

FOR 1–54 CONTEMPORARY ART FAIR: LUNETTE

Florence Knight's highly anticipated rooftop restaurant at St Clement hotel serves daily-changing tasting menus. *lunette.london*

FOR DECOREX: IDALIA AT PILLAR HALL

Follow your visit to the Olympia design fair with lobster linguine and rum baba inside a Grade II-listed building. *pillarhall.co.uk*

From left: Solenne de la Fouchardière, Joanna Bibby and Harriet Maxwell Macdonald

DESIGNER SPOTLIGHT

THE POWER OF THREE

Meet the trio behind Ochre, a Pimlico institution for three decades

BY FRANCES HEDGES

From top: a table from Ochre's Kinoko series. The brand's Whippet table, pictured beneath its Moonlight Murmuration chandelier

When Joanna Bibby and Harriet Maxwell Macdonald – two graduates of City & Guilds of London Art School – started making lamps together around a kitchen table back in 1996, they could hardly have foreseen that, 30 years on, they would be running a revered interiors brand with a presence in London and New York. The duo, who became a trio after the designer Solenne de la Fouchardière joined as a partner in 2000, founded Ochre with a simple ambition to make high-quality objects for the home, drawing on techniques learnt on their decorative-arts course: water gilding, egg-tempera painting, Japanese lacquerwork.

'We share the same aesthetic – an appreciation for beautifully made pieces – and we all design together,' says Bibby of their working practice. 'Three makes for a fantastic dynamic: we never have a logjam because there's always a majority.'

They are marking three decades of the brand with an exhibition at their Pimlico Road store that will bring together past bestsellers – among them the Arctic Pear chandelier, made from clear glass drops suspended from a patinated-bronze frame – with new pieces that deepen their fascination with materials. There are sculptural Jesmonite tables, a sinuous armchair with a saddle-leather frame and vegetable-dyed cushions, and a handblown Murano-glass pendant light – all produced with the help of a network of dedicated craftspeople from around the world, many of whom have worked for Ochre for years.

The trio wouldn't rule out any categories from their plans: even jewellery or bags could be in the pipeline, as long as the designs connect to their philosophy of sustainable, timeless beauty. As Maxwell Macdonald says: 'It's about pushing the boundaries – we always want to be moving forwards.'

'A Form, a View, a Hue: Thirty Years of Handmade Design' is at Ochre from 5 November until 18 December (ochre.net).

PHOTOGRAPHS: MARK ANTHONY FOX/COURTESY OF STUDIO VERO, JUSTIN DE SOUZA, HELEN CATHCART, OLIVER TOMLINSON, THOMAS ALEXANDER, COURTESY OF OCHRE

MEET THE MAKER

SPIN A YARN

Kate Jenkins reimagines the trattoria in woollen form

BY HANNAH BANKS-WALKER

There are dozens of Italian restaurants in London's Soho, but none has ever resembled 'Kate's Knitalian'. An immersive exhibition conceived by the British textile artist Kate Jenkins, it sees Air Contemporary Gallery transformed into a pseudo-restaurant and delicatessen. Tables will be laid with a glorious feast: strings of salami, plump pasta, perfect Calabrian onions – only here, they're all crafted from wool.

'I've always worked on projects that relate to food, but with a sense of humour,' says Jenkins, who has been making art for more than two decades. With the help of a six-strong team – and encouraged by her Milanese partner – she has knitted thousands of pieces for the display. Many of these will be for sale, along with some of the vintage tables, chairs and bespoke tiles that furnish the space as part of Jenkins' collaboration with fellow independent artists and makers.

The show is the latest in a series of high-profile commissions Jenkins has taken on for clients including Marc Jacobs, Missoni and, most recently, Hermès, for which she designed the windows of the new flagship store on New Bond Street. Offering an irreverent take on the house's equestrian ties, the artist concocted a playful 'hooficure' bar (a spa for horses) featuring a chandelier embellished with hundreds of carrots – knitted, of course.

For Jenkins, any project is an opportunity to create the most joyful pieces possible: 'I want to elevate British crafts and make them more appreciated.'

'Kate's Knitalian' will run from 1 November until 5 December at the Air Contemporary Gallery (air-contemporary.com).

Kate Jenkins in her studio

Designs for 'Kate's Knitalian'

From top: serving set, £250; bowl, £765; champagne cooler, £700, all L'Objet x Jessica McCormack

HOMEWARE

HIDDEN DEPTHS

Set your table with a trove of sparkling treasures

The ocean's fluid forms have long inspired the jeweller Jessica McCormack, whose past collections have featured a diamond-encrusted starfish and conch-shell bangles. Now, she has collaborated with L'Objet (uk.l-objet.com) to bring marine motifs into the home with a whimsical yet refined selection of sculptural serveware: champagne and ice buckets, a caviar dish and a shell-shaped platter made from fine bisque porcelain. 'I found that jewellery and homeware are connected through the way we experience and interact with each as objects,' McCormack explains, 'whether that's how a ring sits on the finger or how a bowl feels in your hands.'

'HIDDEN DEPTHS' BY KATIE BAXTER. PHOTOGRAPHS: ALUN CALLENDER, COURTESY OF HERMÈS, COURTESY OF JESSICA McCORMACK, SIMON WATSON

DECORATING

LET IT BURN

How to choose a fireplace, from patinated antiques to beautiful reproductions

A marble reproduction fireplace from Jamb

AS THE TEMPERATURE FALLS AND THE DAYS SHORTEN, THE prospect of a cosy evening spent beside a roaring fire becomes ever more appealing – and when it comes to designing a room, there are few more effective ways to create a focal point than with an elegantly moulded fireplace.

If you're fortunate enough to own a period property with space to accommodate an original design, it's always worth the investment. 'Antiques have an inherent magic to them – years of provenance, patina and care bring an energy that transcends their form,' says Laura Dadswell, the director of Westland London, which specialises in fireplaces, chimneypieces, mantels and grates from across the centuries. She highlights two main eras to consider, depending on your home's age: 'The Georgian period is the moment in history when fireplace design reached its height, with wonderfully carved central tablets and fine marbles as inlay, while the Victorians approached it with a degree of whimsy, taking inspiration from the Gothic architecture of the Middle Ages and the grandeur of the Renaissance.'

There are two principal barriers to choosing an antique fireplace: cost, which can be prohibitive, and size, as it can be difficult to source the right dimensions for a specific room. This is where commissioning a reproduction can be a good option – especially if you go best-in-class and visit Jamb in Pimlico, where originals and copies sit comfortably (and often imperceptibly) side by side. 'It can be hand-carved to fit seamlessly, then distressed to recreate the original patina,' explains Will Fisher, who is one half of the husband-and-wife duo behind the brand. His co-founder Charlotte Freemantle is passionate about the materials they use in their reproductions. 'We have marbles ranging from Italian breccia found in Pietrasanta to soft English stones quarried from Bath, Portland and Ancaster,' she says. Do bear in mind the hierarchy of materials within your home; marble would traditionally have been reserved for the principal rooms, with simpler surrounds in pine or cast iron used for secondary spaces. In the end, though, the best fireplace is the one that makes you want to pull up a chair and settle down with the latest issue of *Harper's Bazaar*. FH

Westland London (westlandlondon.com); Jamb (jamb.co.uk). □

Clockwise from right: a swan-inspired Dornbracht Atelier creation. Taps from the Vaia Design Series, with eggshell and chessboard finishes

INTERIORS

FLOW STATE

Whether sculpted into an intricate knot, inlaid with colourful gemstones, embellished with swan-like wings or hand-painted with floral motifs, Dornbracht Atelier's (dornbracht.com) bespoke tap designs are all masterpieces, crafted in the material, colour and style of your choice.

Far left and above: a collaboration with the Argentinian design studio Konqrit on Dornbracht's Coya collection

Above: the January 1952 issue of Harper's Bazaar, the inspiration for Harper's Bazaar Stripe (far right). Below: Harper's Bazaar Rhythm makes reference to the January 1959 cover (right)

DESIGN

SITTING PRETTY

Bazaar's inaugural interiors venture sees archival fashion inspire new fabrics

BY CHARLOTTE BROOK

'WHAT ON EARTH COULD BE MORE LUXURIOUS THAN A SOFA, A book, and a cup of coffee? Was ever anything so civil?' wrote the author Anthony Trollope in 1855. Here at *Harper's Bazaar*, we couldn't agree more – which is why we're delighted to be collaborating with Sofas & Stuff to launch our first ever fabric collection.

Inspired by the boldness and beauty of the magazine's fashion imagery, it features six striking patterns referencing colours and silhouettes found in our archive. The fuchsia, blue, terracotta and mustard-yellow lines of *Harper's Bazaar* Stripe are taken from the multicoloured striped trousers seen in a 1952 fashion shoot by Richard Dormer that portrays a model against the backdrop of an ancient ruin. *Harper's Bazaar* Houndstooth brings the elegance of traditional tailoring to the home, echoing a chic 1959 cover featuring a model wearing a jacket, skirt and hat in the graphic weave. Other joyous prints drawn from past editions include motifs of outsize tropical palm leaves originally seen in a 1959 shoot titled 'Flight of Fashion', and springy overlapping circles that took their cue from a 1930s pearl necklace's glossy spheres.

The fabrics are available by the metre or can be used to upholster any of Sofas & Stuff's made-to-order furniture designs, including pieces from its newly launched Frame collection. So, pick a paperback, put the percolator on, select your favourite style and winter afternoons are yours for the taking.

The Harper's Bazaar x Sofas & Stuff collection is on sale now (sofasandstuff.com). □

PHOTOGRAPHS: SIMON BROWN, RICHARD DORMER

INTERIORS

GO POP!

Celebrate art season with playful pieces in vibrant hues

COMPILED BY GRACE CLARKE

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Walpole

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thewalpole.co.uk

Kathryn Sargent, bespoke tailoring, London. Shot by Sam Walton

NOVEMBER 2026

For our art issue this month, creativity springs to the fore, as our cover star Emma Corrin plays a painterly Austen heroine with a coterie of fine feathered friends; and Ian Griffiths reveals how he continues to sketch his elegant lines and sweeping silhouettes on the canvas of Max Mara. Meanwhile, in fashion, we curate a playful presentation celebrating the season's most avant-garde sartorial pieces

Photographs and art direction by *SZILVESZTER MAKÓ* Styled by *LISA JARVIS*

Emma Corrin wears linen dress, £1,930; matching skirt, £1,180, both MIU MIU. Corset, stylist's own

PORTRAIT MODE

Emma Corrin slips effortlessly from one role to the next, inhabiting each new character with wit and grace. As the actor dons a corset to play Lizzy Bennet in the new *Pride and Prejudice*, they talk to Jessica Swale about reframing a classic heroine and why Austen's quiet radicalism still resonates today

Linen dress, £1,930, MIU MIU. Gold and diamond earrings, from a selection, CARTIER. Shirt, stylist's own

Poplin skirt, £1,180; leather bag, £3,050; matching heels, £870, all MIU MIU. Gold, platinum, sapphire and diamond necklace, from a selection, CARTIER. Jacket, socks and lace on bag, all stylist's own

SZILVESZTER MAKÓ

Emma Corrin must be the very definition of a shapeshifter. Whether transforming into a real-life icon (Princess Diana in *The Crown*), a literary legend (Virginia Woolf's gender-fluid *Orlando*) or a Marvel villain (*Deadpool & Wolverine*'s Cassandra Nova), the actor seems to have no fear of taking on a cult figure. Which is a relief, as we're about to witness their bold new interpretation of everyone's favourite literary heroine Elizabeth Bennet in a new six-part Netflix adaptation of *Pride and Prejudice,* with an original screenplay by Dolly Alderton.

I first met Corrin in 2021, when I was directing them in an episode of *Ten Percent,* the UK remake of the French comic series *Call My Agent!,* in which I'd cast them as... Emma Corrin. I remember us laughing that our usual geeky in-depth research for a project wasn't going to cut it here – after all, there's only so much an actor can do when playing themselves. It's interesting that the Corrin I meet today is wondering whether they really knew themselves then at all. 'I think you're figuring out who you are in your twenties; you're charging through and making mistakes, but you're up for the chaos and the ride of it,' they muse. 'Now I've landed in my thirties, I feel much more certain about who I want to be, who I am. Well, not that it's done... I think it's lovely to be always questioning.'

Sitting down for breakfast with me in a pavement café in north London is one of those fascinating stars who is at once casual and familiar, and mesmerically glamorous. The face of Miu Miu, they recently caused a sensation at Paris' couture week in a show-stopping feathered Schiaparelli creation, yet they retain the uncanny ability to blend in with the morning-espresso crowd here in London. They're wearing a grey T-shirt and a shaggy crop cut, and they dart, deer-like, between topics with abundant enthusiasm, kicking off with the delights of Iceland – they've just returned from a trip there with their partner, the British actor Zachary Hart, chasing the sun's disappearance into

Linen and faux-fur jacket, £8,200; poplin skirt, £1,180; leather heels, £870, all MIU MIU. Gold, platinum and diamond brooch, from a selection, CARTIER

SZILVESZTER MAKÓ

Cotton dress, £8,100; silk dress (worn underneath), £2,750; poplin shirt, £1,180; leather heels, £870, all MIU MIU

SZILVESZTER MAKÓ

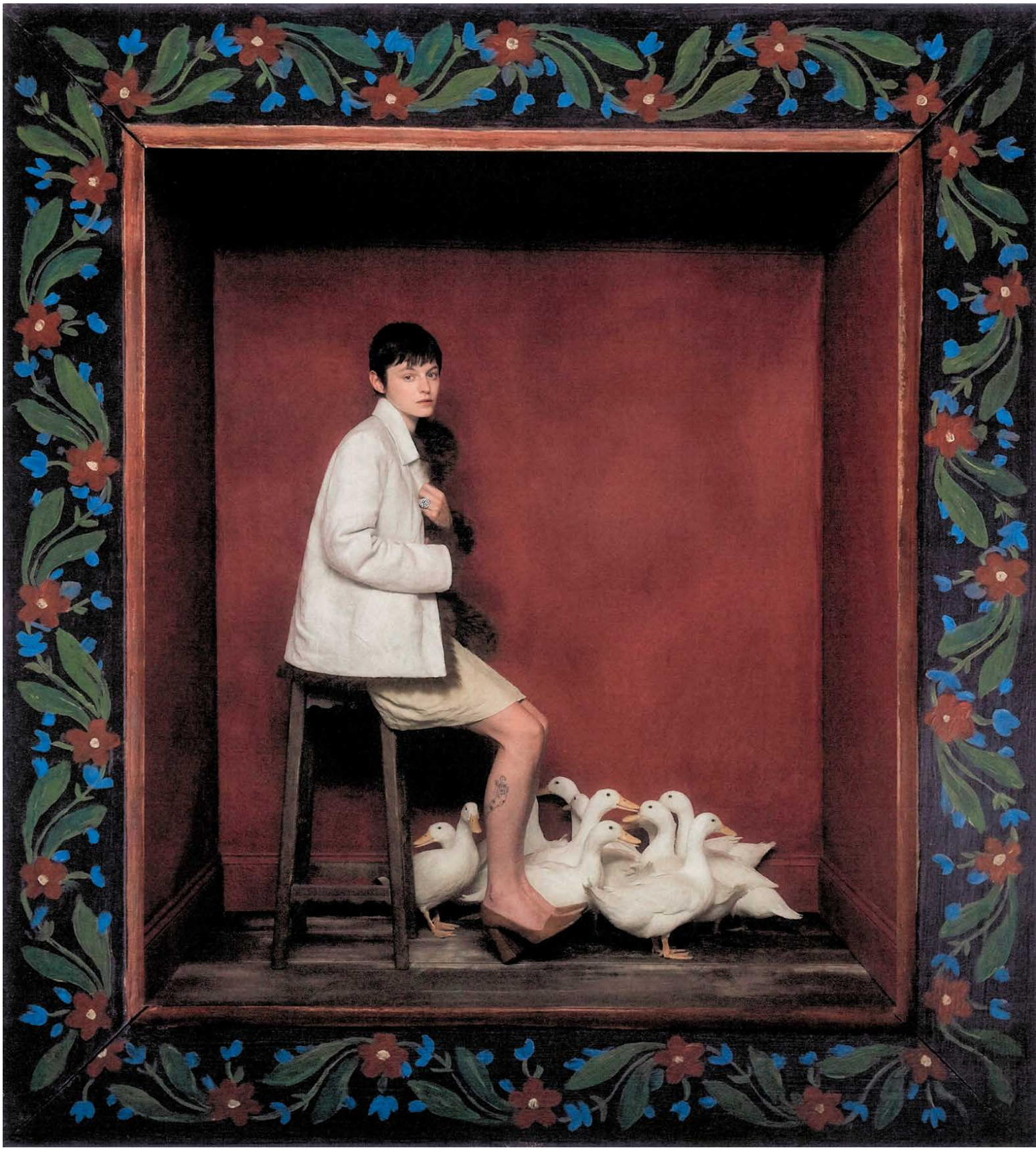
‘NOW I’VE LANDED IN MY THIRTIES, I FEEL MUCH MORE CERTAIN ABOUT WHO I AM. NOT THAT IT’S DONE... IT’S LOVELY TO BE ALWAYS QUESTIONING’

darkness during the solar eclipse. ‘One hundred per cent totality,’ Corrin says. ‘It was insane! And the vastness of the place...’

It’s not surprising that the wild terrain appeals to Corrin, who looks as if they might have emerged from an Icelandic folk tale themselves. Such a grounding experience is clearly an antidote to life in the spotlight: ‘You feel so small in the landscape – it reminds you that you’re just one tiny part of nature.’ Would they be tempted to invest in a little place there, a retreat from the whirl of celebrity? ‘Honestly, it has a really tough quarantine for dogs!’ Corrin has a cockapoo named Spencer, a sweet nod to their time playing Princess Diana. ‘But if that wasn’t a thing, I’d live there.’

Corrin’s journey of self-discovery has been well documented: since 2021, they have spoken publicly about being non-binary, adopted ‘they/them’ pronouns and shared intimate portraits of their experiments with chest binding on Instagram, captioned: ‘Very intimate, very new, very cool. It’s all a journey, right. Lots of twists and turns and change and that’s OK! Embrace it.’

And although it’s disguised as a love story, the project that we’re here to talk about today, *Pride and Prejudice*, is itself an exploration of identity and how quick people are to make assumptions. Jane Austen originally titled the book *First Impressions*, which prompts me to ask how much Corrin truly reveals of themselves to the public. ‘I think I’m more guarded as I’ve got older – I’ve become more introverted,’ they acknowledge. Perhaps this isn’t surprising, given that Corrin has been subjected to a vitriolic backlash about their gender identity. ‘I think people always want answers because they feel there is security in certainty,’ they add. ‘So they want to put you in a box. But I think we all do that to some extent.’ Which is, of course, the foundation of *Pride and Prejudice*’s plot.



SZILVESZTER MAKÓ

Linen and faux-fur jacket, £12,500; linen skirt, £1,180; leather heels, £870, all MIU MIU.
White gold and diamond ring, from a selection, CARTIER

Leather and shearling jacket, £4,800; leather heels, £870, both MIU MIU. Skirt; lace on jacket, both stylist's own

SZILVESZTER MAKÓ

‘I THINK PEOPLE ALWAYS WANT ANSWERS BECAUSE THEY FEEL THERE IS SECURITY IN CERTAINTY, SO THEY WANT TO PUT YOU IN A BOX’

Corrin says they endeavoured not to be daunted by the prospect of playing Lizzy Bennet. Instead, they chose to put their trust in the director, *Heartstopper*’s Euros Lyn. ‘I try to put blinkers on and just be in the scene with the person, listen to them, tell the truth.’ As for the critical response, they’ll keep themselves at one remove from it. ‘I avoid reviews. It’s fairly easy to go, “These people love it,” and then when a bad one comes out, you’re like, “I should never work again.”’

Corrin’s Lizzy fizzes with intelligence; it takes a wit to play one. Nor is that the only trait they have in common: ‘Lizzy’s not afraid to face the world and to laugh at herself – I think I share that with her. I’m very interested in people, and I’m very ready to laugh at stuff.’

That laugh, combined with the gales of giggles of the other Bennet sisters, becomes the soundtrack to the first episodes, and imbues the show with a lively sense of fun. It is one of Corrin’s favourite elements of Alderton’s fresh interpretation of the book, which follows such titans as Andrew Davies, whose famous 1995 series starred Colin Firth’s wet shirt, and Joe Wright, who delivered his delightfully muddy film in 2005. Corrin’s face fills with warmth when talking about Alderton: ‘She has a direct line into the human condition.’

And though it holds on to the delicious Regency styling that viewers will love, this series does have a poppy, modern sensibility. The dialogue is snappy, Austen’s notorious long sentences snipped to pithy witticisms. Longbourn (the Bennets’ house) has none of the muted colours of traditional adaptations; there are flashes of turquoise and plenty of evidence that teenage tearaways run amok there. Even the locations of familiar conversations have been thoughtfully reimagined: Lizzy and Jane often escape to the roof for a bit of privacy, much to their mother’s annoyance.

Learning that I’m knee-deep in Austen myself (I’m currently adapting another of her novels for the screen), Corrin takes delight in talking to me about our research into the period. ‘The dresses!’ they enthuse. ‘Your top half was all corseted up, but from the waist down you were completely free. You could run!’ Indeed, the series opens with Lizzy careering down a hill with abandon, and that passion for nature was, for Corrin, the key to understanding why the character falls for Darcy. Visiting Pemberley, Lizzy ‘observes him in his natural environment and understands where he comes from’. Could it also be, I suggest, because it’s the first time she sees his eye-wateringly massive house? ‘That’s one of my favourite bits – when she gets to his house and she’s like... “It’s enormous!”’

Corrin found working with Jack Lowden (whose Mr Darcy has a certain brooding charm and unorthodox blond locks) a hoot, and is full of praise for his impeccable comic timing and, conversely, his vulnerability. ‘I think you see that there is an ocean in there beneath the stillness.’ An even more radical departure comes in the form of Mrs Bennet, played by Olivia Colman – with whom Corrin was delighted to reunite in a far more joyful capacity than their previous frosty on-screen relationship in *The Crown*. Colman paints her character less as a self-involved worrier and more as a passionate mother who will sacrifice everything to ensure her daughters find husbands. ‘If you don’t marry, you lose everything. It’s a question of life or death,’ Corrin remarks. In one understated scene, Mrs Bennet quietly moves through the house kissing each of her daughters goodnight. ‘I think Mrs Bennet is the real heroine of the series, because she fights against the restrictions of the time that she is living in,’ says Corrin. ‘That’s incredibly noble and brave.’

Both Lizzy and Corrin are known for defying the expectations of their sex. For Lizzy, it’s meeting Mr Darcy, who shifts her preconceptions, that propels her on a journey of self-realisation and, ultimately, love. It’s a romantic idea – that someone on a path of self-discovery might find a partner who redirects them. Is that what love means for Corrin too? ‘I think when you have someone who comes and interrupts you, sticks their foot out, makes you think differently, that’s amazing.’

Corrin is understandably coy about discussing such personal matters. ‘If you talk about it, people have a right to ask questions. Though I’m the biggest consumer of what’s going on!’ Almost immediately, Corrin begins describing what their top traits are in a partner: ‘Their mind. Someone you belly-laugh with, who is constantly curious and evolving with you.’ And just as Lizzy falls for the man who challenges her, so Corrin can’t resist drawing a parallel

Linen dress, £1,930, MIU MIU. Gold and diamond earrings, from a selection, CARTIER

Poplin skirt, £1,180; leather heels, £870, both MIU MIU. White gold, platinum, sapphire and diamond necklace, from a selection, CARTIER. Top; lace petticoat, both stylist's own

SZILVESZTER MAKÓ

‘LIZZY’S NOT AFRAID TO FACE THE WORLD AND LAUGH AT HERSELF... I THINK I SHARE THAT WITH HER. I’M VERY READY TO LAUGH AT STUFF’

in their own relationship with Hart. ‘He challenges me all the time.’

Thrilling though the drama of Lizzy and Mr Darcy’s meet-cute may be, Corrin demurs when asked if they believe in love at first sight: ‘No, I don’t think I do.’ An impish grin flashes over their face. ‘But when you know, you know.’

Certainly, there’s a sense of Corrin having found contentment. And when the pressure gets too much, there are coping mechanisms available: ‘Old friends, watering plants, driving, looking at art...’ They have just bought their first ever painting by the artist Sara Berman. ‘She’s amazing,’ says Corrin, face lighting up. ‘She paints herself in different characters. Quite gender-fluid. I completely fell in love with [the painting].’

On *Pride and Prejudice*, Corrin not only acted but also took a producing role for the first time, participating in casting – ‘mad, crazy fun!’ – and script changes. ‘It’s nice to have some creative input in the broader sense. Looking after everyone’s story is a really nice feeling.’ Supporting other actors when they had questions or worries, Corrin was, it seems, playing the hero in more ways than one.

They are also, I think, a hero for a generation of young people wrestling with their identity today. Had Austen met Corrin, I suspect she’d have been proud to see her most famous character played by an actor who is quietly reshaping our understanding of gender. After all, the novelist’s superpower lay in subtly subverting expectations; sneaking in big questions and sharp social commentary in the guise of a romance. ‘I hear so much politics in what she writes... but it’s smoke and mirrors,’ observes Corrin. ‘Sometimes you have to be quiet to be the loudest.’

Stealthy radicals, Austen and Corrin, 200 years apart.

‘Pride and Prejudice’ is out on Netflix on 3 December. □

SZILVESZTER MAKÓ

Leather jacket, £6,300, MIU MIU. Hair by Pablo Küemin at R3-MGMT. Make-up by Gina Kane at Caren. Manicure by Chisato Yamamoto at Caren. Set design by Elle Mikkola. Ducks courtesy of 1stchoice animals.com. Stylist's assistant: Hadya Tuofiq

All prices throughout from a selection, except where stated. Shearling coat; silk shirt, £1,430, both BOTTEGA VENETA

Photographs by
ANYA HOLDSTOCK
Styled by
MARZIA FOSSATI

PLAYING TO THE GALLERY

Make an exhibition of yourself in an artful blend of tactile textures, structural shapes and monochrome colours

Crepe jersey dress,
£6,750, BALENCIAGA

ANYA HOLDSTOCK

Crinoline coat, £2,350; cotton dress, £2,550; matching socks, £860; satin slingbacks, £1,400, all PRADA

Silk-satin shirt; matching skirt; velvet boots, all SCHIAPARELLI

ANYA HOLDSTOCK

Beaded dress, LOEWE. Leather and glass heels, BOUTASHKOVA

Viscose dress, £2,720,
CALVIN KLEIN

ANYA HOLDSTOCK

Mohair jacket, £4,350;
matching trousers, £1,670;
wool bonnet; leather
heels, all LOUIS VUITTON

STEEL AND STRAW CHAIR, £600, TOM BOGLE

Wool and silk jacket; satin and feather skirt; satin heels, £1,700, all DIOR

Wool coat, £2,290; matching dress, £790, both ISSEY MIYAKE. Leather gloves, SERMONETA

ANYA HOLDSTOCK

Viscose and sequin dress;
calf-skin heels, £1,700,
both CHANEL

ANYA HOLDSTOCK

matthews

Silk top; crinoline mesh top; matching skirt, all VICTORIA BECKHAM.
Polyamide tights, PIERRE MANTOUX. Leather heels, £790, KHAITE

Wool top, £4,196; brass earrings, £677; leather bag, £1,499; matching heels, £1,285, all GIVENCHY BY SARAH BURTON. Polyamide tights, PIERRE MANTOUX

ANYA HOLDSTOCK

Denim shirt, £1,800; matching jeans, £1,290, both FENDI

ANYA HOLDSTOCK

Lamb-skin jodhpurs; cashmere scarf; calf-skin boots, all HERMÈS

Tulle dress, VIVIENNE WESTWOOD. Suede boots, GIUSEPPE ZANOTTI

Viscose dress, £1,300; acetate bracelet, both EMPORIO ARMANI. Sunglasses, £405, ALAÏA. Polyamide tights, EMILIO CAVALLINI. Leather heels, MUGLER

ANYA HOLDSTOCK

Lace and organza dress, £2,900, McQUEEN

Cotton bodysuit, £590; satin skirt; leather heels, all COURRÈGES. Sterling silver rings, from about £165, CAMILLE SURAULT. Polyamide tights, EMILIO CAVALLINI

ANYA HOLDSTOCK

Wool dress, £2,490, ALAÏA. Sunglasses, £419, GIVENCHY BY SARAH BURTON. Resin earrings, £165, CAMILLE SURAULT. Leather heels, £605, LE SILLA

Embellished cotton dress, £9,200; fringed bag, £6,125, both STELLA McCARTNEY. Leather heels, £695, AQUAZZURA. Silver earrings, £465, COMPLETEDWORKS. Hair by Amidat Giwa. Make-up by Athena Paginton, using Rare Beauty. Manicure by Emma Welsh. Set design by Nicola Bell. Stylist's assistant: Olivia Sandford-Wilson. Model: Lisa Hageman at Premier Model Management

Ian Griffiths with the model Ania Kisiel

Paillette-embellished silk dress, from a selection; leather gloves, £545, both MAX MARA

STAYING POWER

On a tour of the Max Mara headquarters in northern Italy, *Lydia Slater* meets the brand's creative director Ian Griffiths, whose four-decade career is built on a deep connection with the history of the house, and whose governing principle is that his clothes should never outshine the woman wearing them

Photographs by
PHILIP SINDEN
Styled by
GRACE CLARKE

Inside the Max Mara archive, Ian Griffiths is showing me a dog-eared piece of fashion history. Across a sheet of A3, date-stamped December 1985, a series of Amazons parade wearing cropped monochrome jackets, khaki wrap skirts and supercilious expressions. Griffiths produced these sketches for a Max Mara design project as a first-year fashion student at the Royal College of Art.

'Other people in my year found the concept quite conservative,' he recalls. 'I applied myself to it thinking about my mother. She was a feminist, the first in her family to go to university, and she took her job as a schoolteacher seriously. She was always very well turned-out – she aspired to the Max Mara look.

'Through my understanding of what my mum was about, I knew that these were classic clothes, but they're for a woman who is in her own way quite radical. She's out to achieve what she can.'

Nevertheless, despite Griffiths' innate understanding of the assignment, he almost missed his chance. 'The night before my submission was due, I was working on it at 3am, and my black felt pen ran out. I thought, OK, I'll just go to bed. But at that moment my flatmate came home from clubbing. I said, "Do you happen to have a black marker pen in your bag?" And weirdly, she did.

'I took the submission to college the next day, cheaply, hurriedly done, stuck together with Pritt and very badly presented. I didn't think I had a chance – but I ended up winning.' So impressed was Max Mara's founder Achille Maramotti with Griffiths' rough sketches that he offered him a job.

Griffiths has been there ever since – four decades – rising to his current position as creative director of the luxury brand. That's an impressively long stint in any job, and extraordinary in fashion, where designer churn is rife. But ever since it was founded in 1951 as Italy's first ready-to-wear fashion brand, Max Mara has operated according to its own lights. This has proved a winning formula. The Max Mara Fashion Group currently encompasses 11 brands, including Marina Rinaldi and Sportmax alongside the flagship. It has an annual turnover nudging €2 billion (£1.7 billion) and more than 2,300 boutiques in some 100 countries around the world. Impressively, the luxury behemoth remains independent, owned and run by Maramotti's descendants.

Arranging this interview has required a full immersion into the brand's ecosystem. Having negotiated with Max Mara's urbane communications supremo Giorgio Guidotti (a style icon in his own right), I am flown to Reggio Emilia in northern Italy, the brand's heartland, for dinner with him and Maria Giulia Prezioso Maramotti, global brand ambassador and granddaughter of the founder. The following morning, I have a guided tour of the extraordinary Collezione Maramotti, the family's world-class contemporary-art collection. It's housed in the original factory building, and you can still see the marks on the floor where the sewing-machines stood. Then, I'm chauffeured to the company's current site, a low-slung campus on the city's outskirts, surrounded by green lawns and decorative water features.

Griffiths is sitting in his airy office, a pile of pencil sketches on his desk. ('To me, the sketch is fundamental,' he says. 'Maybe I'm more old-fashioned than other people.') Affable and erudite, with a trace of a soft Northern accent, he is dressed in Timothy Everest tailoring, a Brooks Brothers shirt and chinos and Tod's trainers, all in tonal shades of white, cream and beige. 'I've turned into an Italian person's idea of what Britishness is,' he jokes. 'I'm almost like a caricature of myself, with my Savile Row suits and my dapperness...'

The wall beside his desk is papered with photographs of his Max Mara muses: 'Women of substance, remarkable women who have made some contribution.' These range from Greta Garbo to Greta Thunberg. His mother Barbara is up there. She has just celebrated her 90th birthday and remains a potent source of

PHOTOGRAPHS: COURTESY OF MAX MARA, GETTY IMAGES

Right: a model walks the runway at the Max Mara autumn/winter 2013 show during Milan Fashion Week. Above: Giulia Maramotti's sewing school. Top left: Ian Griffiths. Top right and below: details from the Max Mara archive. Bottom right: Griffiths' office

Wool trench-coat, £3,750; leather belt, £725; matching gloves, £545, all MAX MARA

> ‘We’ve been feminist since we launched in the 1950s. Our woman has always wanted to effect change and improvement in her world’

inspiration. ‘The puzzle was, how could she be a feminist if she looked so immaculate? The idea of pragmatic feminism occurred to us 10 years or so ago, and then it became our buzzword.’

Indeed, female empowerment runs like a thread through the history of Max Mara. Its roots in Reggio Emilia stretch as far back as the 1850s, when Marina Rinaldi started her tailoring business. Giulia Fontanesi Maramotti, Rinaldi’s granddaughter, took up the shears in the 1920s, writing a series of tailoring manuals and founding an institution to teach dressmaking skills – one of the only further-educational opportunities then open to local women. When Giulia’s son Achille Maramotti launched his pioneering brand, he relied on these seamstresses to bring his designs to life.

Fashion at the time was dominated by the French couture houses designing for the world’s wealthiest women. Maramotti instead targeted the middle classes, the wives of doctors and lawyers, adopting American industrial processes to produce clothes that were elegant yet affordable, and anticipating the influx of such women into the professions themselves. ‘We’ve been feminist since the 1950s. Our woman has always wanted to effect change and improvement in her world,’ says Griffiths.

The camel coat – Max Mara’s signature piece – is the sartorial embodiment of this philosophy: male power dressing reclaimed for women. Griffiths shows me a strikingly modern-looking magazine shoot from the Sixties featuring three models in Max Mara camel outerwear. Then in 1981, Anne-Marie Beretta created a double-breasted coat featuring stitching derived from masculine tailoring. Instantly an icon, the 101801 design remains a bestseller, reissued every year, each version preserved in the archive to make sure that, as fabrics are updated, the coat doesn’t visibly deviate from the original.

Griffiths sees it as a full-circle moment that earlier this year in Shanghai he sent womenswear looks down the catwalk on male models. ‘Whenever I go to any big city around the world, I see men wearing Max Mara,’ he explains. ‘The aura of Max Mara as an empowering brand appeals to men, too. That’s unprecedented – with unisex clothing, it’s never been men borrowing women’s clothing, it’s always been the other way round.’

Over a lunch of cured meats, tortelloni pasta and watermelon from the company canteen, Griffiths talks me through his (short) CV. Brought up near Chesterfield, he developed an interest in fashion through shopping for fabrics and dress patterns with his mother, while his brother went to football matches with his father, a senior executive at a computer company. After a failed stab at an architecture degree, Griffiths dropped out and spent years on the Manchester club scene. ‘I’d make myself clubbing outfits out of lining material or repurpose old curtains,’ he says. ‘When I finally went to college to do fashion, I realised I knew more about the process of making clothes than I thought.’ At Manchester Poly (now Manchester Metropolitan University), his tutor Ossie Clark advised him to apply to the Royal College of Art; this led to Griffiths’ ‘*Sliding Doors* moment’ with the Max Mara project.

After winning the competition, Griffiths worked for Max Mara in the holidays, joining the design team straight after he graduated. On the face of it, he was an unlikely appointment. ‘I was a shock-haired punk from Manchester,’ he says. ‘I had spiky white hair, a long black coat I made myself, and I used to carry my Filofax around in my hand. When I arrived in Reggio Emilia, I couldn’t work out why people were calling me “Father” – they thought I was a priest!’ For the first year he worked there, he was ‘waiting for them to say, sorry, we’ve got the wrong guy. But I think that was Achille’s idea. He wanted this underlying sense of something that wasn’t conservative at all, some club cool.’

At the time, power dressing was at its peak. ‘But it tended to be a bit uniform and prescriptive – skirt suit, jacket with shoulder

‘The Max Mara woman trusts us to make her look and feel her best. She wants dressing to be as simple as possible. She wants to feel powerful, and she wants to get on with her life’

pads, coat with shoulder pads, all that layering... My first task was to lighten it up and provide more possibilities for dressing different ways, to allow women to express themselves and feel empowered. I’ve viewed that as being my job ever since.’

The question of what clothes can do for their wearer still preoccupies him. ‘What so much of fashion does is tantalise people and make them feel worse about themselves. It’s that dress that you see on the runway, you spend three months’ salary on it, and then every moment you’re wearing it, you feel you’re not young enough, or you’re not the right size or the right shape.’ For Griffiths, by contrast, a successful design is something his customer puts on and forgets about. ‘Nobody looks good if they put too much effort into what they’re wearing,’ he says. ‘I always think about this bond of trust between us and the customer. This woman trusts us to give her what’s going to make her look and feel her best. She wants dressing to be as simple as possible. She wants to feel powerful, and she wants to get on with her life.’

After lunch, we drive to the Biblioteca e Archivio d’Impresa, the group’s private archive, containing tens of thousands of fashion books and magazines; floor-to-ceiling shelves of original sketches and fabric samples; and a vast treasure-trove of vintage pieces, many sourced by Griffiths. He gives me a tour of the highlights: a Chanel suit worn by Coco herself (which had a string of her pearls in the pocket), Audrey Hepburn’s jacket from Saint Laurent’s Russian collection, a Le Smoking tuxedo owned by Catherine Deneuve. There are chests of costume jewellery, tiered rows of shoes and handbags, and entire wardrobes belonging to style-setters such as *Bazaar*’s former global fashion director Carine Roitfeld, one of Griffiths’ long-term collaborators.

Another area is devoted to rails of Max Mara pieces, showing the brand’s evolution over the decades under designers including Jean-Charles de Castelbajac, Karl Lagerfeld and Domenico Dolce and Stefano Gabbana, alongside Beretta and Laura Lusuardi, the house’s fashion director, who has worked here since the 1960s.

Griffiths truffles for inspiration amid these rails. His most famous creation, the shaggy Teddy coat, was inspired by a 1980s piece he unearthed in the archive. Debuted on the catwalk in 2013, it was a sensation, copied everywhere and laying to rest any idea that Max Mara was only about restrained good taste.

‘I wanted to make something that gave a sense of comfort in this scary world, that cuddles you and protects you – but at the same time, there’s a big element of bling to it,’ Griffiths explains, pulling out the original. ‘At the time, everything was tiny and skinny, but this coat is enormous.’ Perennially popular, it is reissued annually alongside the 101801. This year, in celebration of Max Mara’s 75th anniversary, three more of Griffiths’ coats have been brought out of the archive – the Meridian, Millenia and Metric styles – and released in a limited edition of 200 pieces each, an eloquent testament to the timeless quality of his designs.

Yet he is not the household name his talent merits (one profile piece I read is headlined ‘The most famous designer you’ve never heard of’). ‘Yesterday I Googled myself, and it said, “Ian Griffiths is remarkably humble”,’ he jokes dryly. But that, he believes, may be the secret to longevity. ‘When I look at some of the other brands now, I see the designer, not the brand – and you can get tired of a person very easily. Max Mara will always be around, and there will be another designer after me. The important thing is to be a custodian, and to leave the heritage of the brand stronger than it was, to enrich it every season. It was never about my ego.

‘People ask me if I think I’m a good designer,’ he concludes. ‘I’ve no idea. The only thing I can say is that I’m a good designer for Max Mara. Where else could I have had the challenge or the involvement that I’ve had here, this fantastic story of constant growth? It’s a one-in-a million fit.’ □

HAIR AND MAKE-UP BY ANDREA FORMENTINI AT ETOILE MANAGEMENT. GROOMING BY ELEONORA TOMASINI. MODEL: ANIA KISIEL AT FASHION MODEL MANAGEMENT

Wool and silk blazer, £1,405; matching trousers, £650; sunglasses, £199; leather belt, £725; matching heels, £725, all MAX MARA

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EDITED BY
KATY YOUNG

PHOTOGRAPH: IMAXTREE

Fresh start

How the beauty entrepreneur Sarah Creal is rewriting the rules of make-up for women over 40. Plus: why caring for your fascia could transform your wellbeing; high-impact mascaras for fuller lashes; and classic fragrances revisited

Coming in hot

The beauty industry has been telling women over 40 to fix themselves. The entrepreneur Sarah Creal is fixing the products instead

BY KATY YOUNG

PICTURE THE SCENE: A FORTYSOMETHING WOMAN – WITH flushed cheeks, glossy lips and glowing skin – struts into a hotel room, removes her trench, crawls across the bed and picks up the telephone, presumably about to enjoy a bit of phone sex. If you haven't seen it, this is the deliberately risqué ad for Sarah Creal's new make-up brand created exclusively for the over-forties – a brand that is changing the face of beauty. 'We're hot, we're calling the shots – and we would like to see what the right products look like on us,' Creal tells me in her New York drawl.

Creal has, of course, been calling the cosmetic shots for decades. Having developed products for some of beauty's biggest names, including Tom Ford and Victoria Beckham, she is one of the world's most renowned formulators, and chances are you have worn one of her creations at some point. 'I've been in the industry for 30 years,' she says, 'but I didn't realise I was part of the problem until I started this brand. I have simply always designed for women in their twenties, as doing otherwise wasn't even a question.' That meant she was constantly targeting youthful skin – the kind that is 'smooth, bouncy and uniform enough that almost anything looks good on it'. When it came to the older customer, the attitude bordered on dismissive. 'We'd be like, "Let's give her a foundation this year, shall we? OK, tick."'

At 56, Creal realises the industry has failed to keep pace with women like her. 'I woke up with this idea that no one was really talking to me,' she says of her lightbulb moment. 'I called up my sister, a lawyer in Pennsylvania who really loves beauty, and asked her, "Do you have a problem buying what you need?" She told me that her dressing table was a graveyard of products that didn't work for her.' Creal went on to survey another 2,000 women and asked them what make-up they really wanted to own.

Sarah Creal

She responded by developing the kind of collection I have wanted myself since I hit 40. A personal favourite is Face Flex Correct: in Creal's own words, a product for women 'who are tired of looking tired'. A tiny (seriously tiny, as a little goes a long way) dab of this under the eyes magically removes circles and shadows, ergo any signs of exhaustion, until you wash it off later that night. 'Our skin gets thinner as we get older – this gives a boost

of brightness that makes us all look more wide awake,' says Creal. The lightweight balm that is Just Like Paradise bronzer is also flawless on my 49-year-old complexion, adding warmth without streaks or stripes. And if, like me, you have shunned highlighters for fear of grease, shine and mess, try Today's Highlights, a brightening, multi-peptide balm that goes on like a silky serum and adds sheen, shape and glow for the remainder of the day.

There is also the excellent Back of the Cab tubing mascara – now the only kind I can wear. 'My survey showed that women were quietly quitting mascara because it wasn't working for them,' says Creal. 'In our thirties, our favourite mascaras are made from little spheres of pigment that coat a full fringe of lashes, but as our lashes get thinner, it doesn't look so great, and those tiny balls of ink start to dissolve against the oil-based products we now have to use around the eyes.' Designed to be removed with warm water, her product stays put through long and busy days (one A&E nurse reportedly wrote to Creal to say it was the first to last her entire 12-hour shift). The same goes for Creal's signature Eyes Up liner, which won't smudge even if used over a layer of eye cream, and which is suited to more delicate or sensitive skin.

'The way I build my formulas is that everything is thin, because I don't want to add a lot of mass to skin – that'd be like putting heavy things on tissue paper,' says Creal. 'I want formulas that feel effortless rather than fussy to use, for a natural but hard-wearing look.' Crucially, the products are 'not a consolation prize. This brand is a reward for everything it has taken for this woman to get where she is. I'm raising the bar, and she deserves it.'

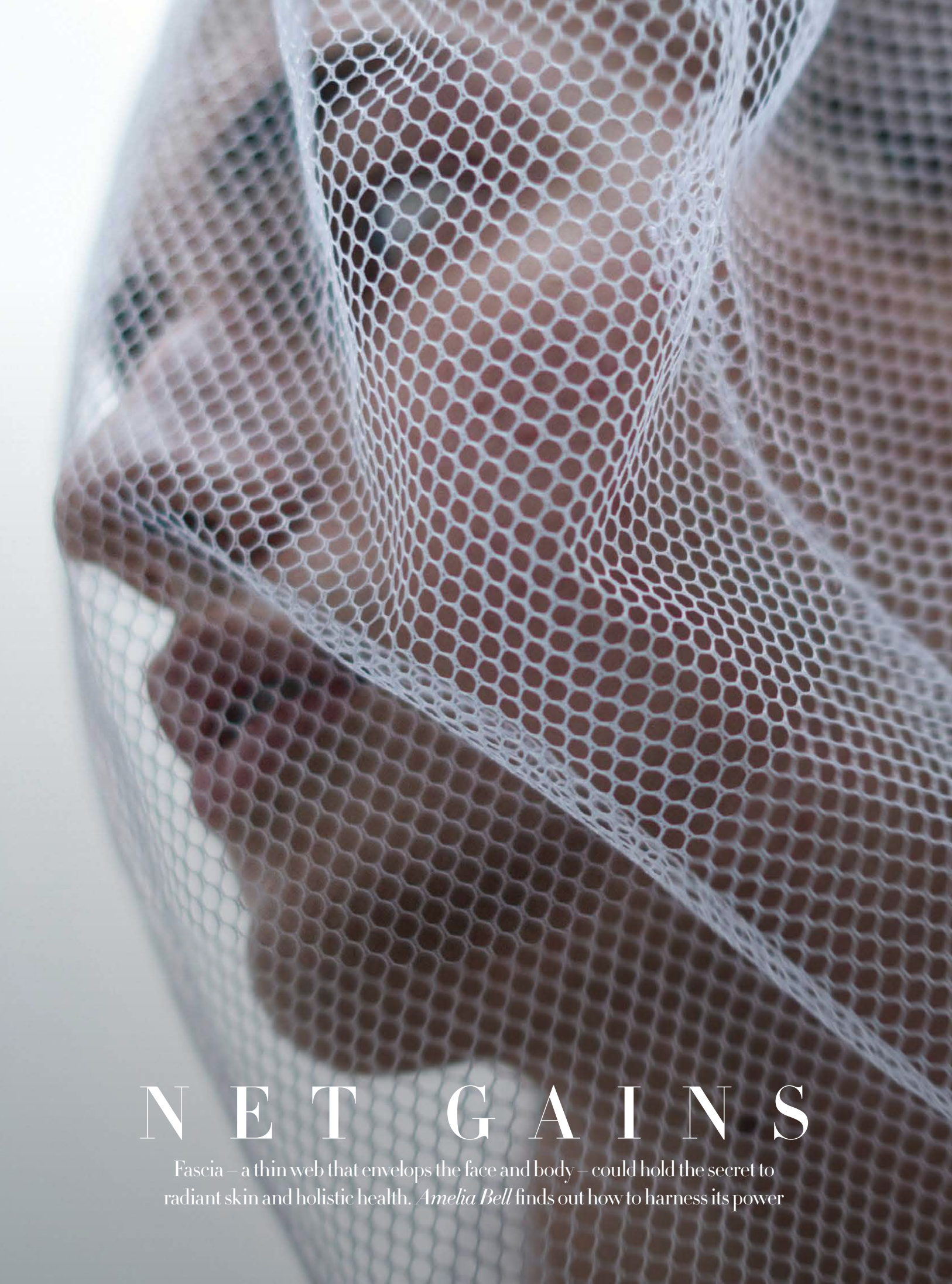
In a youth-obsessed industry, it hasn't been easy reaching this point. 'It has been a knife-fight. I did not get here by being a mouse or conservative,' says Creal. Fortunately for us, she has had enough tenacity and imagination to win. 'And we will win. The brands that speak to us, inspire us, understand and value us will win. And I'm here for the competition too.'

Sarah Creal Beauty is available at Space NK (spacenk.com). □

PHOTOGRAPHS: AGATA POSPIESZYNSKA, GETTY IMAGES

Tried and TESTED

Our favourite Sarah Creal Beauty buys, from brightening balms to a smudge-proof mascara



NET GAINS

Fascia – a thin web that envelops the face and body – could hold the secret to radiant skin and holistic health. *Amelia Bell* finds out how to harness its power

I'm curled up on a treatment bed in the Corinthia spa, feeling a knot of tension dissipate slowly from my neck and shoulders. Within minutes, tears prick my eyes. I'm familiar with the sudden catharsis that can come with bodywork, but this is something different. Known as 'myofascial release' – a targeted therapy designed to work with fascia, the continuous matrix of connective tissue that wraps every muscle, nerve and organ – it is designed to reduce tightness and release restricted tissue, restoring its natural glide.

'Fascia is deeply connected to the entire sensory network,' explains the osteopath Nadia Alibhai, unfazed by my heightened emotions. 'When you move or hold stress, forces are transmitted through this interconnected system. It senses everything and dictates how the whole body responds. This treatment directly influences how we perceive and react to tension.'

Once dismissed as mere biological wrapping paper, fascia – made up of water, collagen, elastin and hyaluronic acid – is now understood as a living, three-dimensional web. 'It's part of a complex system involving movement, circulation, lymphatics, posture and tissue health,' explains Alibhai. When it works well, it keeps everything in motion and prevents systems from becoming sluggish, but if it becomes restricted – due to scrolling, sedentary habits or chronic stress – the fluid between the layers can thicken. This affects physical mobility and emotional wellbeing, leading to issues ranging from pain and stiffness to a dysregulated nervous system.

Indeed, fascia and neurology are intrinsically linked, explains the skin-health expert Annee de Mamiel. 'Fascia changes according to how we move, breathe and repeatedly load the body,' she says. 'Cortisol and adrenalin change our physiology; the nervous system alters breathing, muscular tone and stress response. Over time, these repeated patterns affect the tissues.' It's a catch-22: greater stress can tighten fascia, which in turn can send your body into fight-or-flight mode, prolonging the anxiety that caused the damage in the first place.

This mind-body connection explains why fascia has piqued the wellness industry's interest. Google searches for 'fascia release' have soared in the past year, while facials targeting the system are becoming more popular. Robert Schleip, the director of the Fascia Research Group at Ulm University, attributes this to its holistic possibilities: 'Fascia is now studied in relation to the autonomic nervous system, and therefore emotional regulation, as well as the immune system and ageing.' The latest findings reveal that supporting your fascia extends far beyond easing a tight neck; it has been linked to decreased arterial stiffness and enhanced cardiovascular health.

Fascia release has also entered the skin-health conversation. Tight fascia can be the overlooked culprit for loss of luminosity, puffiness and premature ageing, says De Mamiel, as it's heavily involved in draining fluid and lymphatic pathways. 'The diaphragm plays a role in pressure changes and fluid movement through the body, and the fascial system connects these areas,' she explains. 'When I work on movement and tension through the neck, chest and ribcage, I often see a change in how congested or puffy the face appears.' Yet effective release does not require aggressive force. 'If I use so much pressure that your body braces, I've produced the opposite response – it's about creating conditions where the nervous system and tissue can both settle.'

The facialist Nichola Joss achieves similarly impressive results with her signature Inner Facial, which fuses lymphatic drainage, fascia release, buccal massage and sculpting techniques. 'Fascia surrounds and supports our muscles; when restricted, it affects how freely muscles move,' Joss tells me. This affects lymphatic flow and your skin's natural glow. 'By releasing muscular and fascial tension, you lift, tone and sculpt contours while boosting circulation and softening fine lines.'

> 'By releasing muscular and fascial tension, you lift, tone and sculpt the skin'

Aside from professional treatments, supporting fascial health relies on consistent daily habits. First, fascia thrives on variety of movement: try walking, twisting your body, reaching overhead, squatting and getting on the floor to maintain overall health. Unfortunately, there aren't quick fixes: spending the day bound to an office chair and then going straight into an intense HIIT session can actually be counterproductive. Instead, focus on pattern interruption throughout the day: try standing during phone calls instead of sitting down, swinging your arms gently during screen breaks and making sure you're not holding your breath during stressful periods at work. Counteract hours spent hunched over a device with a simple doorway stretch: place your forearms against the frame, step forward gently, and hold for 20 to 30 seconds while breathing deeply.

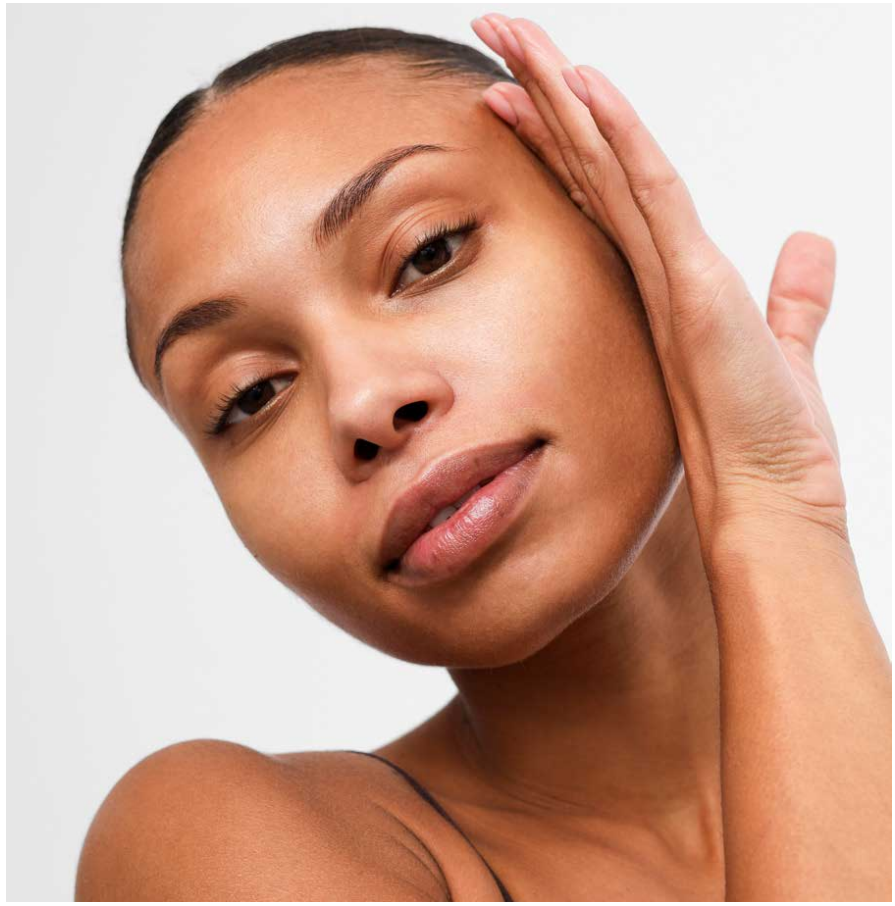
Schleip recommends aligning exercise with your circadian rhythm. 'Incorporate dynamic, elastic or bouncing movements in the morning, ideally outdoors, and slow stretches in the evening,' he suggests, adding that sustained yoga positions, such as a child's pose held for at least 30 seconds, can be particularly helpful. 'Regular stretching improves joint mobility and may benefit cardiovascular markers such as arterial stiffness.' Finally, make nutrition and hydration a priority: fascia is made up of 70 per cent water and needs hydration to glide freely.

As Alibhai reflects at the end of my session: 'The goal isn't to constantly release fascia; it's to keep your body moving, adaptable and well nourished.' I leave feeling lighter and more grounded – and I instinctively skip the Tube and walk home. □

PHOTOGRAPH: ANDREA BOSCHIN/UNSPLASH

The long game

Boots has all you need to feel better for good



AS THE COLDER MONTHS INTRODUCE a slower rhythm, the conversation around longevity is starting to shift away from swift health overhauls and biohacking extremes towards building consistent wellness habits for long-term gain.

The fact is, true longevity doesn't require high-pressure self-optimisation or yet another to-do list. Instead, it lies in small micro-habits that help you to cultivate better sleep, steady energy and sustained skin health. Here are three ways to feel your best, from the inside out.

Wearable tech has never been smarter or more innovative, helping you better understand your sleep, recovery and overall wellbeing without getting in the way. An Oura Ring or Whoop watch can offer useful insights into areas such as rest, resilience and recovery, helping you spot patterns in how you're feeling over time. This can make it easier to recognise when you might need extra support and adapt your routine accordingly. Listening to your body makes it easier to build those personalised rituals.

It can feel tricky to navigate the supplement shelves, but Boots stocks a curated range of wellness brands and has in-store experts to help you take the guesswork out of the products on offer. Discover Symprove as part of your gut wellness routine, Zooki for a daily vitamin C ritual to support your immunity*, and Absolute Collagen as part of a healthy-looking skin routine, while Habi Hey Sunshine gummies help boost vitamin D levels – something recommended for everyone in the UK during autumn and winter.

Reframe skincare from a chore to a moment of calm. Build a mindful regime that prioritises your skin-mind connection, taking time to massage in formulas and create a sense of peace. Facial massage can support lymphatic drainage, while mindful moments of self-care may help ease everyday stress.

Boots stocks brands with wellness in their DNA. Find K-beauty favourites such as Anua and expert-approved staples like La Roche-Posay. Longevity, after all, is not about perfection; it's often the smallest acts of self-care that yield the best results. *Elevate your everyday rituals with Boots.*

Wellthy Daily Hydration, £7

La Roche-Posay Effaclar Supra-molecular, Oil & Pores Correct, £16**

Wellthy Energy & Vitality Tablets, £8

Whoop watch, £349

Symprove Gut Solution, £22.99***

*VITAMIN C CONTRIBUTES TO THE NORMAL FUNCTION OF THE IMMUNE SYSTEM; FOOD SUPPLEMENTS ARE NOT INTENDED TO REPLACE A VARIED DIET AND HEALTHY LIFESTYLE. **£300 PER LITRE. ***£45.98 PER LITRE

THE BEAUTY EDIT

MASCARAS

BAZAAR EDITOR'S CHOICE 2026

The best formulas for flattering, full-impact lashes

BEST FOR DEFINITION

YSL Beauty Lash Latex Mascara, £32

This high-density brush with 496 micro-bristles captures every lash, from root to tip, for intense separation and length.

BEST TUBING

Maybelline Lash Sensational Sky Tubes Mascara, £13.99

Flexible tubing technology makes for striking mascara that can be removed easily with warm water.

BEST FOR LENGTH

Outside In Precision Lift & Lengthening Tubing Mascara, £35

A slim brush targets the base of lashes to create instant length, lift and definition that lasts.

BEST WATERPROOF

Dior Diorshow Overvolume Waterproof Mascara, £38

Water and sweat are no match for this transfer-proof formula, which yields a rich black pigment.

BEST FOR A NATURAL LOOK

Merit Clean Volume Volumizing Tubing Mascara, £24

Prefer a subtle effect? This delicate tint gently curls and provides colour according to your desired intensity.

BEST FOR DRAMA

Charlotte Tilbury Exagger-Eyes Volume Mascara, £28

Accent your smoky eye with one layer of this jet-black pigment, for guaranteed thickness and volume.

BEST FOR VOLUME

Rabanne Eyephoria XXXL Mascara, £29

Our best-in-show for party make-up, this extra-large fan brush makes eyes look wider and more defined.

BEST FOR LONGEVITY

Nars Notorious Mascara, £29

Humidity-resistant, film-forming polymers defy flaking and smudging by moving with your lashes throughout the day.

BEST FOR STRAIGHT LASHES

Lancôme Lash Idôle Curl Goddess Mascara, £28

A 40-degree twisted brush offers an ideal lightweight coating for short lashes, giving a fanned-out look.

BEST GLOSSY

Fara Homidi Pool Slick Lash Lacquer Mascara, £45

This nourishing formula lends a unique, glistening finish, as if you've just emerged from the pool.

WORDS BY KATIE WITHINGTON

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ETERNALLY PINK® RevitaLash® Cosmetics honors the courage and strength of our Co-Founder, Gayle Brinkenhoff, and that of women everywhere by supporting breast cancer awareness, research and education initiatives year-round, not just in October. This is our Eternally Pink pledge.
Model is actual RevitaLash® Cosmetics user. *Aggregate total of all 5-star reviews globally for RevitaLash® Advanced as of 30/9/25.
†Survey results from an independent 12-week consumer study including 160 participants. ©2026 Athena Cosmetics, Ltd.

20 YEARS
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BEAUTY MOODBOARD

The perfumer Francis Kurkdjian is reinterpreting a host of Dior's most iconic fragrances

From the opulent, patchouli-laden scents of the 1980s to the fresh, aquatic creations popular during the minimalist movement of the 1990s, perfume bottles the spirit of an era. To resurrect a fragrance, then, is to decide what to preserve, and which modern ingredients and innovations to embrace. This was the challenge facing Francis Kurkdjian, the creative director at Parfums Christian Dior, who is reviving 13 of the division's most beloved blends in honour of the house's 80th anniversary. 'When restoring an old painting, should you change it to fit the taste of current times or keep it as is because it is iconic?' he muses. His reissued Dioriginals collection has two parts: Dior in Grasse (including Diorama, Eau Fraîche, Diorissimo, Diorling and Diorella) and Dior in Paris (featuring more recent creations: Dioressence, Jules, Dune, Dune Pour Homme, Dolce Vita, Forever and Ever, Higher and Higher Energy). Focusing on craftsmanship, ingredients and technology, these interpretations have been concocted with the utmost respect for the original iterations. 'If the perfumers were alive, I sent them the restored version to make sure that they would endorse it,' says Kurkdjian. 'In the case of Edmond Roudnitska [one of the first noses to create for Dior], I sent it to his son Michel and sought his advice. For Dolce Vita, Pierre Bourdon showed me the formula for reference.' Our favourites are the spicy, sophisticated jasmine Diorama and the warm floral Dioressence – two modern classics to enjoy now and forever.

Dior Dioriginals eau de parfum, from £110 for 100ml

MEDINA AZALDIN

PHOTOGRAPHS: COURTESY OF DIOR; GETTY IMAGES

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WHAT KATY DOES

Our beauty director *Katy Young* reveals the secrets of her routine

La Bonne Brosse No 1 Shine & Care Brush, £146

OIL YOU NEED

Clarins is renowned for its excellent facial oils, which nourish, hydrate and smooth without being heavy or greasy. Its latest foray into hair is designed to offer similarly sleek, swishy locks. For extra gloss, pair with a La Bonne Brosse flyaway-taming brush.

Clarins Luminous Hair Oil, £43

Raise the bar

As the nights draw in, I'll be elevating my evening baths with Marc-Antoine Barrois's exquisite range of soaps. Each of the five bars is made from natural oils and fills a room with mesmerising scents created by the master perfumer Quentin Bisch.

Marc-Antoine Barrois scented soaps, from £45

Double duty

For days when a full face of make-up doesn't appeal, a little under-eye brightening can go a long way. New skincare-concealer hybrids from Jones Road and Beauty Pie work twice as hard, adding luminosity while disguising blemishes and signs of fatigue.

BeautyPie Superluminous Under-Eye Genius, £25

Jones Road Wide Awake Brightening Concealer & Neutralizer, £24

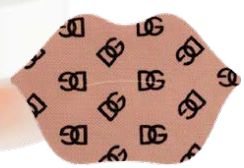
Byfrow Hue Glazing Balm SPF50, £36

Repair service

If your lips are feeling parched, rehydrate them with a nourishing mask from Hermès or soothing gel patches from Dolce & Gabbana. For a plumping effect, try Victoria Beckham's Lip Definer, and for a gentle tint, try Byfrow's Hue Glazing Balm, which has the added bonus of built-in sun protection.

Victoria Beckham Lip Definer, £37

Hermès the Lip Care Mask, £75



Dolce & Gabbana Nouri-Kiss Petal Lip Patches, £33

PAGE TURNER

Trust Louis Vuitton to produce the ultimate luxury finishing touch for your beauty regime: its new book of blotting papers, all subtly decorated with the maison's signature motif, is almost too beautiful to use.

Louis Vuitton La Beauté Mattifying Paper Case Monogram Infrarouge, £470

PHOTOGRAPHS: IMAXTREE, GETTY IMAGES

Why cruise when you can Cunard

There are cruise ships. And then there are the Cunard Queens. For 185 years, Cunard has been setting the standard for luxury ocean travel, creating journeys that have become part of travel's collective imagination. Four ships now carry that legacy forward, each with its own character, yet united by the same unmistakable feeling; whether crossing the Atlantic, exploring the fjords, or sailing around the world, you're stepping into something iconic.

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BAZAAR
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EDITED BY
HELENA LEE

Seeing the light

On an illuminating visit to her hometown, Rejina Pyo uncovers Seoul's artistic legacy. Plus: where to stay in Japan, from city boltholes to tranquil retreats; why creatives are flocking to Abu Dhabi; and Es Devlin's cultural guide to Venice

Seoul viewed from Inwangsan mountain

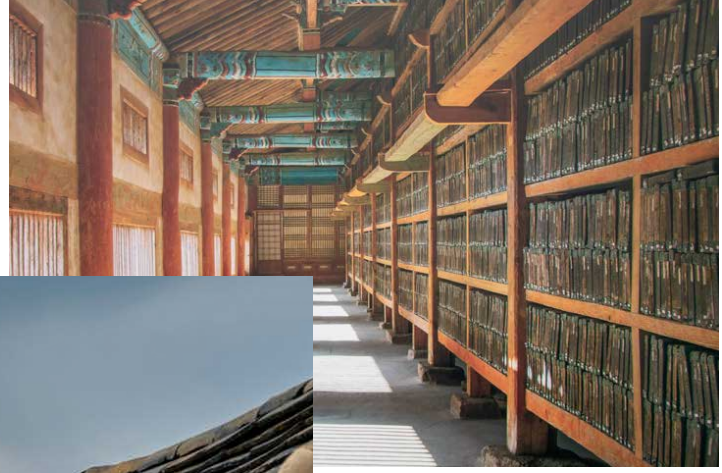
PHOTOGRAPH: GETTY IMAGES

Beyond the horizon

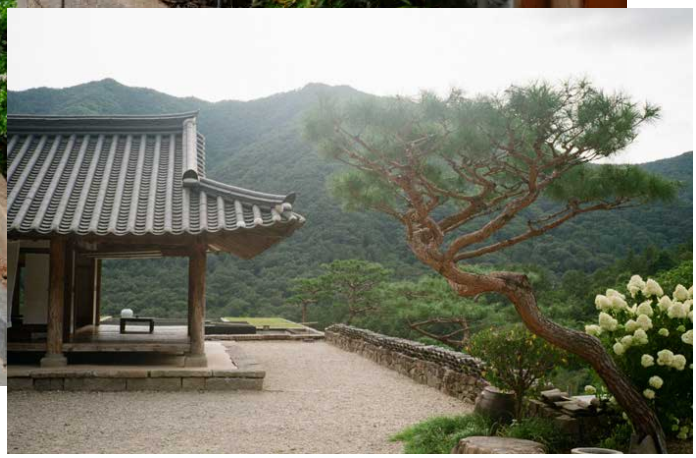
Returning to South Korea, the fashion designer *Rejina Pyo* pays homage to her homeland's galleries, heritage crafts and sites of natural beauty ahead of a major exhibition at the British Museum

From top: Gyeongbokgung Palace. A pedestal (400-500 AD) at the British Museum. Rejina Pyo (centre) with Mijae Kim and Kyeungun Lee in Seoul. Namsan Tower

PHOTOGRAPHS: JET DELA CRUZ/UNSPLASH, ELLIOT GOUY/UNSPLASH, MATTHEW KEITH HUTT, ROBSON HATSUKAMI MORGAN/UNSPLASH, COURTESY OF REJINA PYO, © NATIONAL MUSEUM OF KOREA, COURTESY OF THE BRITISH MUSEUM



Right: Haeinsa Tripitaka woodblocks depository. Below: Anguk, Seoul. Bottom: Awon Gotaek in Wanju



I STEPPED GINGERLY THROUGH THE BRICKS AND ASH scattered on the floor of the 'climbing kiln' at Icheon, just south of Seoul, edging my way up a series of vaulted chambers that were still warm and heady with wood smoke. Built into the gentle slope of a hill, each one was barely tall enough to stand up in and linked to the next by a narrow inner tunnel. I followed my uncle, ducking my head through each low doorway. He has spent years collecting Goryeo celadon, the grey-green stoneware ubiquitous in Korea since the 12th century; it was he who first took me to Icheon as a child and who brought me back here on this trip.

Outside the kiln, a master ceramicist inspected a fresh batch of vases, turning each piece over in his hands, checking the line of the rim, the weight, the glaze. Then, one by one, he set aside those that had come out warped or slumped, and began, without any particular ceremony, to smash them with a hammer. I had no idea it was coming. The sound of the hammer meeting porcelain was so sudden and violent that it took my breath away. I found it unbearable to watch. These misshapen vessels were, to my eye, incredibly beautiful, with a genuinely unique and unrepeatable shape, thrown off-centre by heat and gravity and the unpredictability of a wood fire. I would gladly have taken any one of them home. To the master ceramicist, however, they were flawed, and would damage his reputation and the value of everything else bearing his name. Perhaps it was my nearly two decades living in London that drew me to the pieces. Or perhaps it was the opposite: an earlier, unconscious resistance to a somewhat uniform way of doing things in Korea that led me to the UK in the first place.

Since 1964, the South Korean government has formally designated master craftspeople – ceramicists, weavers, lacquer artists and musicians, among others – as holders of Important Intangible Cultural Property, informally known as Living National Treasures. Each receives state support on one condition: that they train a successor, so the technique does not end with them. As a designer and artist who works so often with vintage references, I find it heartening that my home country goes to such lengths to preserve its craft traditions.

Growing up in Seoul, I took the beauty and craftsmanship around me for granted and never imagined that, decades later, some of these very objects would travel to London, as part of the most significant exhibition of Korean art and craft ever held in the UK, opening at the British Museum this October. I have watched Korean film, music and fashion reach further and faster than I could have predicted; what that newer culture draws on, though, are centuries of older Korean traditions, and this exhibition gives them the recognition they deserve.

Returning to Seoul with my uncle, I found it much changed since I lived there. It has evolved from a city the international art

Clockwise from above: Pace Gallery, Seoul. An installation by Do Ho Suh at the National Museum of Modern and Contemporary Art. Haeinsa Temple

world rarely visited into one of its capitals – a shift most visible every September, when Frieze Seoul comes to town. One place remains unchanged, however: Dapsimni antiques market. Walking through the countless antiques stores clustered together on the ground floor of a series of neighbouring dilapidated buildings, it seemed exactly as it was in the Eighties when I first visited with my mother. An avid collector and interior designer at the time, she would have me trawl with her through floor-to-ceiling displays of furniture, brassware, scroll paintings and porcelain. On this visit, I spied a set of traditional Korean bronze *yugi* spoons that I've been on the lookout for. This is a craft that dates to the Silla dynasty, and the utensils were light enough to pack into my suitcase to bring back to London.

Not far away in Hannam-dong, I visited Leeum Museum – three buildings of traditional Korean art presented alongside international contemporary work – founded by the family of Lee Kun-Hee, the late chairman of Samsung Electronics. In 2021, his family donated more than 23,000 Korean artworks and antiques from his personal collection to the National Museum of Korea and the National Museum of Modern and Contemporary Art, one of the largest cultural gifts in the country's history. It is this same collection that comprises the majority of the exhibits at the British Museum.

Down the road at Pace Gallery, I relished the work of the ceramicist Park Young Sook, who has been running her own kiln since 1979, and is best known for her contemporary moon jars, those swollen, imperfect spheres of milky-white Joseon porcelain, prone to slumping unevenly in the kiln and not dissimilar to the pieces I saw at Icheon. Their beauty is inseparable from the risk of their failure, and it is something I think about often in my own work. Contemporary Korean design still carries this same instinct: restraint as a form of confidence.

In need of perspective, I headed for the hills. Mount Inwang rises up over the Jongno district, not far from where I studied fine art at Hongik University. It was an easy climb and afforded spectacular 360-degree views of the city. It is also the subject of one of the most celebrated works in the British Museum exhibition: *Clearing After Rain on Mount Inwang*. Jeong Seon painted it in 1751, breaking from the Chinese landscape tradition that had shaped Korean painting for centuries, choosing instead to paint

Clockwise from left: the National Museum of Korea. A Goryeo dynasty celadon ewer, now on show at the British Museum. Part of the Lee Kun-Hee collection at the National Museum of Modern and Contemporary Art

PHOTOGRAPHS: NATIONAL MUSEUM OF KOREA, MATTHEW KEITH HUTT, ©NATIONAL MUSEUM OF KOREA/COURTESY OF THE BRITISH MUSEUM, COURTESY OF MMCA, SANGTAE KIM, COURTESY OF PACE GALLERY

a real, specific place rather than an idealised or imagined scene. It's an early and quietly significant assertion that the Korean landscape was worth painting on its own terms.

I left the frenetic pace of the city and travelled two hours south of Seoul towards the serene slopes of Jeollabuk-do. Awon Gotaek is a 250-year-old collection of traditional Korean *hanok* buildings, relocated beam by beam from Jinju, and rebuilt on a fold of Jongnamsan Mountain with uninterrupted views of the valley below. Not far from here, the kilns of Gangjin and Buan once produced celadon wares – the same ceramics my uncle has spent his life collecting – that made Goryeo-dynasty Korea famous as far away as Song-dynasty China. Awon houses a small contemporary-art gallery within the network of *hanoks*, and its courtyards are as carefully composed, in their own way, as any moon jar.

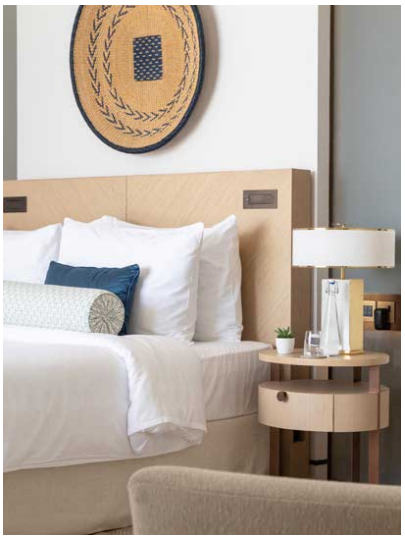
What runs through the British Museum exhibition, across dynasties spanning more than 2,000 years, is a consistency of intention. Korean art, through long periods of upheaval as much as prosperity, has rarely been made for decoration alone, often created in the service of religion, ritual or a very specific kind of hope. Curious to trace that thread further, I made my way to Haeinsa, in Hapcheon, which I had not seen since a school trip in my teens. It's one of Korea's Three Jewel Temples, so named because it holds the 'dharma jewel' – the Tripitaka Koreana, a set of more than 80,000 wooden printing blocks containing the Buddha's teachings. It was carved between 1236 and 1251, during a sustained Mongol invasion, an act of devotion to protect the country. The scale of the task, and the discipline required to see it through, says something enduring about how Korea has related to its own culture: as an asset to be protected collectively.

Back in Seoul at the National Museum of Modern and Contemporary Art, I wound my way through the exhilarating retrospective of the Korean sculptor and installation artist Do Ho Suh, on view until February 2027. His work *Self-portrait* (2019) was recently acquired by the British Museum and will form part of the Korea exhibition. It is a powerful reminder, within a show spanning two millennia, that Korean identity has not stood still, and that artists working from outside the country, as Suh does, remain part of its ongoing story. I recognise something of my own position in that, as a designer and artist who has spent almost two decades working in London while continuing to draw on my formative years growing up in Seoul.

Travelling through my home country, I was struck by how consistently Korean artists, from past to present, have practised craft with such sustained discipline and, rather encouragingly, how that discipline has been judged worthy of state support and private patronage – the fruits of which you will now be able to linger over at the British Museum. Or, better still, venture a little further to my homeland – to the wood-fired kilns of Icheon, the galleries of Seoul and the temples and *hanoks* of the Korean countryside.

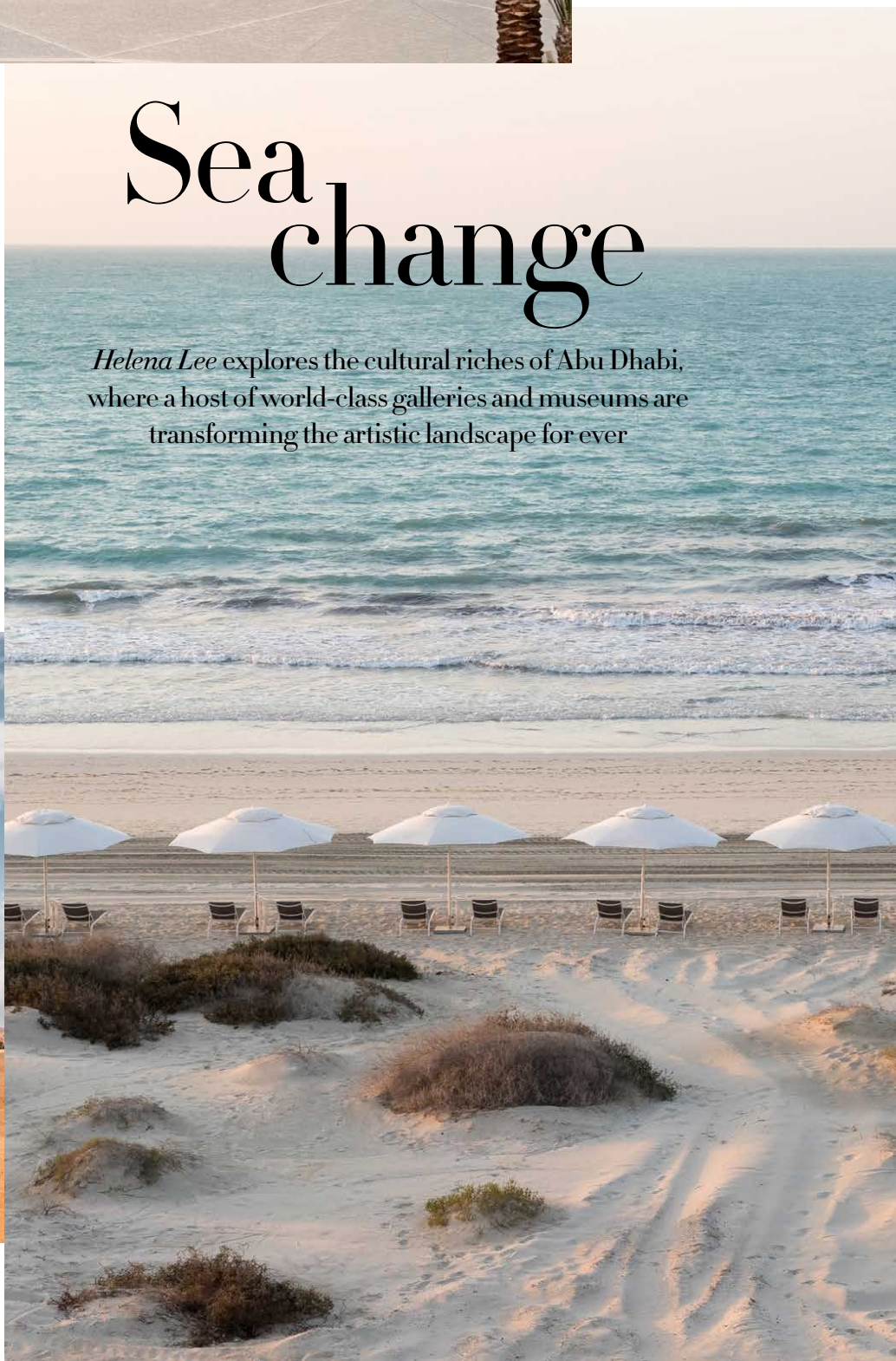
'Korea' is at the British Museum until 31 January 2027. Rejina Pyo is on the honorary committee for the 2026 British Museum Ball. □

Clockwise from below: Jumeirah Saadiyat Island Beach . 'Sandscapes' (2023) by Neda Salmanpour. A suite at Jumeirah at Saadiyat Island . The Zayed National Museum. Kirsten Berg's 'Compound Eye' (2012) at Manar Abu Dhabi in 2025. The Louvre Abu Dhabi. The lobby at Jumeirah at Saadiyat Island



Sea change

Helena Lee explores the cultural riches of Abu Dhabi, where a host of world-class galleries and museums are transforming the artistic landscape for ever



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STANDING IN THE GARDEN OF THE ABRAHAMIC FAMILY HOUSE in Abu Dhabi, where three houses of worship – a church, a synagogue and a mosque – sit in close proximity, I could see the entire city unfolding across the fast-changing skyline. Before me were the fluid white lines of new structures from a cultural district in the making: the Natural History Museum, the Zayed National Museum – a place of almost impossible scale – the Louvre Abu Dhabi and the yet-to-be-opened Guggenheim. This November, the eyes of the art world will turn its attention here as the inaugural Frieze Abu Dhabi launches, bringing together 80 galleries from 63 cities and 36 countries. With it comes a cultural optimism that throws recent conflicts into sharp relief.

I visited last November in anticipation of Frieze art fair's first foray in the region. My home for the week was Jumeirah Saadiyat Island, conveniently located a 10-minute drive from this cluster of titanic museums, and an official partner to this year's edition of Frieze. Walking into the wide, gleaming lobby was a slightly dream-like experience: from the ceiling hung 1,000 delicate blue-glass sculptures, intricate and organic in form, through which I could see the wide horizon splitting sky and sea.

I encountered creative interventions throughout the hotel, bringing to life Jumeirah's partnership with the inaugural edition of the Nomad design, art and jewellery fair. Curated by Nomad's founder Nicolas Bellavance-Lecompte with Arnaud Morand, 'Shifting Terrains' is intended to reflect the country's evolving creative landscape; particularly striking are the sculptural 'windswept' pillars of red sand from Sharjah, designed by the Iranian architect Neda Salmanpour. The fair itself is held in the old Zayed International Airport's Terminal 1, which has a famous mosaic ceiling at its centre; the lounges have been transformed into plush presentation booths for galleries.

Cultural spectacles of this kind can be found throughout the city. At the time of my visit, Manar Abu Dhabi, the public light-art exhibition, was running across four venues and featured immersive work that ranged from interactive floral blooms using biometric data to a 'sea' of dancing lights made with optical fibres. I attended the display's opening night on Jubail Island with the two curators Alia Zaal Lootah and Munira Al Sayegh, who took us on a scenic walk that culminated in an extraordinary light show of 3,000 drones.

The museum offering is particularly rich, and extends beyond the visual arts. During a tour of the Natural History Museum before its official opening, we encountered a dynamic display of five earth-shaking sauropods in the entrance hall. One astonishing exhibit was a piece of the pre-solar Murchison meteorite that fell in Australia in 1969, which contains seven-billion-year-old grains that existed before the Sun and the Earth came to be. We also popped into the Zayed National Museum – an example of architectural mastery from Foster + Partners, designed to take us through the history of the country and named after its founding father.

Between museum visits, I carved out time for a daily dip off Jumeirah's private beach– a haven for turtles– and indulged in an intense 90-minute massage at Talise, the hotel's spa. The restaurants were delightful, too: we had fantastic spaghetti alle vongole and burrata salads at Mare Mare, and sipped sundowners alongside tuna tartare canapés at the beach bar Sal.

For many years, Abu Dhabi has been in the shadow of its glitzier neighbour Dubai – but as I found out for myself, this ambitious, culturally engaged city has a lot to give, emerging as a destination – and an artistic hub – in its own right.

Jumeirah Saadiyat Island (jumeirah.com), from about £645 a room a night. Frieze Abu Dhabi (frieze.com) runs from 19 to 22 November, and Nomad Abu Dhabi (nomad-circle.com) from 18 to 22 November. □

Boost your healthspan

Taking a proactive approach to your health can help protect your energy, strength and confidence for later life

THE CONVERSATION AROUND LONGEVITY is ever-expanding. While it has mostly focused on improving lifespan – adding years to your life – the real metric lies in extending the number of years you spend in good health. 'The goal is not anti-ageing, it's healthspan – preserving the energy, strength, mobility, cognition and confidence that allow a woman to continue living fully,' explains Dr Iranthi Meththananda, consultant gynaecologist at premium healthcare provider Welbeck. Here, alongside leading health experts at Welbeck, Dr Meththananda explains how to improve your healthspan at any age.

'Gynaecological care is preventative medicine,' says Dr Meththananda. 'It's a lifelong story, beginning at puberty and influencing pain, mood, sleep, skin, metabolism, fertility and bone health.'

Key markers such as very painful, heavy or irregular periods may be an early indication of endometriosis, adenomyosis, a bleeding disorder, thyroid dysfunction or polycystic ovary syndrome, explains Dr Meththananda, who advises keeping a symptom diary. By tracking bleeding, pain, mood, sleep, headaches, bowel and bladder symptoms, 'a group of apparently unrelated complaints' might show 'a recognisable hormonal or cyclical pattern'.

'The skin provides visible clues to what is happening elsewhere in the body,' explains Dr Ellie Rashid, consultant dermatologist at Welbeck. 'Conditions such as psoriasis or severe acne can share associations with cardiovascular, joint and gut health, alongside nutritional deficiencies and hormonal shifts.'

She adds: 'Healthy ageing is about preserving the function of an organ over decades.' Dr Rashid recommends simple habits, including protecting against UV rays, supporting the skin barrier and having regular mole checks. 'Skin is an organ we can see; paying attention to changes forms a vital part of a broader strategy for long-term health.'

Cardiovascular risk remains one of the most overlooked aspects of women's health. 'Coronary artery disease kills twice as many women as breast cancer,' says Dr Aaisha Opel, Welbeck's consultant cardiologist and electro-physiologist. Symptoms experienced by a woman with underlying coronary artery disease that can lead to a heart attack can feel innocuous, such as neck, jaw or back pain and breathlessness. 'Due to lack of understanding, 50 per cent of women receive the wrong diagnosis.' Dr Opel recommends testing from your thirties onwards, such as evaluating your blood pressure, cholesterol and family history.

As women go through perimenopause and menopause, drops in oestrogen levels impact bone density, metabolic function and heart health. 'Menopause is not one experience and HRT is not one prescription,' says Dr Meththananda. Treatment should be judged by individual symptoms and function.

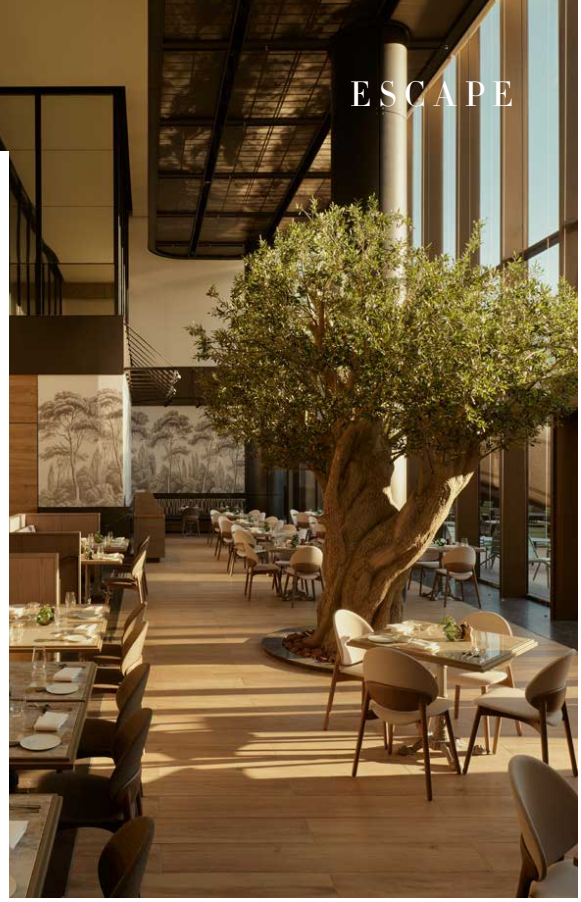
'When women have the language and confidence to recognise change, they are more likely to seek help before symptoms become disabling.'

Discover more about Welbeck and book your appointment at welbeck.com.

JANU TOKYO

Situated in the Azabudai Hills development in Tokyo's business district, Janu (the sister brand to Aman) has a contemporary, understated elegance, paired with thoughtful hospitality that puts you instantly at ease. Its Japanese restaurant Iigura is worth a visit – try Edomae sushi, a take on traditional 'Edo' fast food created during the 1820s. The real sanctuary, however, is the wellness centre, home to an onsen where you can relax and restore your strength after a busy day spent exploring Tokyo, or book a massage for a total reset.

Janu Tokyo (janu.com), from £914 a room a night, including breakfast.



LAND OF DISCOVERY

Nazanin Zaghari-Ratcliffe shares her favourite places to stay in Japan, from city hideaways to rural retreats

FAIRFIELD BY MARRIOTT IN TOCHIGI

Each of the two Fairfield by Marriott properties in the inland region of Tochigi offers a glimpse into a quieter side of Japan. Surrounded by forests and mountains, Tochigi Nikko lies within easy reach of Lake Chuzenji and provides a base from which to experience the area's natural beauty and the Unesco World Heritage site of Nikko, which has more than 100 shrines and temples. Further south, Tochigi Motegi is spacious and far from the bustle of the city, set amid acres of greenery. Both hotels are modern and beautifully maintained, allowing the landscape to take centre-stage.

Fairfield by Marriott Tochigi Nikko and Fairfield by Marriott Tochigi Motegi (marriott.com), each from about £90 a room a night.

SOHO HOUSE TOKYO

Tucked away in the design-conscious district of Aoyama, Soho House Tokyo feels cool while still being comfortable. Its interiors are warm and playful, mixing retro touches, rich textures and Japanese design details, including sakiori weaving. There's a superb collection of contemporary Japanese art, featuring pieces by 40 artists, among them Ryoji Ikeda and Hiroya Kurata. With its sweeping city views, the rooftop pool is a highlight.

Soho House Tokyo (sohohouse.com), from £295 a room a night (members' rate). Soho Friends rate, from £359 a room a night.

PHOTOGRAPHS: ROBERT RIEGER, MIYUKI KANEKO, EDVINAS BRUZAS

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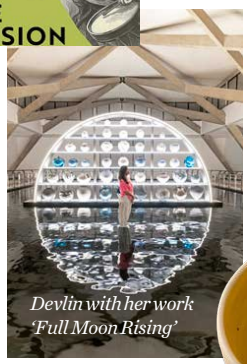
INSIDER'S GUIDE

ES DEVLIN ON VENICE

The artist and stage designer on the hidden treasures in her adopted city

Es Devlin

The Grand Canal in Venice


Devlin with her work 'Full Moon Rising'

A Ristorante Local dish

Above: Devlin's 'A Rainbow of Forms'. Left: glasses from Nason Moretti

I first visited Venice when I was 15, in the final week of a month-long Interrail trip. I had £4 to get me through the day before taking the night train to Paris, and I spent it all on gelato while walking through the streets, taking in the views.

I've been working in Venice for two years as artistic director of the Homo Faber Biennale [a global artisan exhibition]. I now see the city through the lens of those who carve wood, throw clay, blow glass, bind books and craft ceramics. It's a place of great beauty, originally born from brutal necessity, founded on inhospitable marshy islands by refugees escaping the mainland.

While working with the Michelangelo Foundation on the exhibition, I've been a guest at Hotel Gabrielli. Once frequented by Franz Kafka and Sigmund Freud, it has breathtaking 360-degree views over the lagoon and the city from its sixth-floor rooftop – perfect for aperitivi – and a historic central garden. I also love Ca' di Dio, with its shaded courtyard and luminous interiors by Patricia Urquiola.

For an ideal day here, arrive by train, and then walk or take a vaporetto to discover the maze-like architecture of the city. There are usually more than 150 exhibitions happening at any one time – I only just discovered Dries Van Noten's exquisitely curated foundation at Palazzo Pisani Moretta, and the Anish Kapoor exhibition at Palazzo Manfrin.

I never forget to bring a broad-brimmed Borsalino hat in summer, and a Rains mac in autumn. And I'd recommend wearing Crocs – if you are comfortable, you look more beautiful.

Take a trip to the island of Murano to learn the craft yourself at Wave Murano Glass. If you can, visit the workshops of glass artisans such as Nason Moretti, Alessandro Boscolo and Alessia Fuga.

Venice is fantastic for finding unique pieces to buy. I still have the marbled-paper-covered notebook that I bought at Legatoria Polliero during my second trip to Venice in my early twenties.

Visit the Vatican Chapels on the island of San Giorgio Maggiore. There are 10 chapels in the pine and cypress forest, commissioned for the 2018 Venice Architecture Biennale and designed by 10 different architects from 10 countries. While on the island, make sure to climb up the bell tower to enjoy the amazing views across the city.

When dining out in Venice, I order the vegetarian tasting menu at Ristorante Local in the Castello district. The skilled and imaginative chef Salvatore works with local producers to grow ingredients for his dishes. There's a theatrical flourish in the form of a 'pre-dessert' that waiters deliver straight into the guest's mouth on a spoon.

A great book to read while in the city is *The Passion* by Jeanette Winterson, written in 1987. It's set in a Venice that is conjured entirely from Winterson's own imagination, as she had yet to visit.

'Es Devlin: Other Worlds' is at the Design Museum, London (designmuseum.org), until 4 April 2027. □

PHOTOGRAPHS: GARAGERAW; KENSINGTON LEVERNE; SOPHIA BENNETT © MICHELANGELO FOUNDATION; ES DEVLIN ARTISTIC DIRECTOR © ES DEVLIN; ALANA HARRIS/UNSPLASH

BAZAAR FASHION

THE TREASURE OF ALL TREASURES

In a world of minimal luxury, muted tones and 'wardrobe staples', Ode to Comfort celebrates jewellery as a way to reclaim individuality and express yourself. Sourcing high-quality vintage gold and silver pieces, the brand also creates bold, upcycled designs using brightly coloured stones and statement silhouettes. Inspired by founder Aisha's Nigerian heritage and intertwined with British culture, each piece celebrates jewellery as one of history's most enduring forms of self-expression. Jewellery holds stories. Ode to Comfort honours what came before while creating new treasures to become part of your own.

Discover more: **@OdeToComfort**

www.odetocomfort.com

Image credit: Rochelle Baptiste and Jason Baptiste

CURATED TREASURES TO CHERISH

Discover a passionately curated selection of vintage and antique jewellery at **The Old Soul Antique Store**. Each piece is carefully sourced and selected for its quality, character, and story. Offering a delightful range of rings, pendants, and more, exclusively crafted in sterling silver and solid gold. Each treasure is ready to be worn again and cherished for many years to come.

Based in Northumberland, owner Fay regularly attends local events where you can explore the collection in person and find that truly special piece.

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Fuller Finery celebrates the beauty, confidence and individuality of the fuller-handed woman through thoughtfully designed contemporary jewellery.

Each piece is handcrafted in gold or platinum and finished with beautiful diamonds and gemstones, designed to complement natural curves and add a little extra sparkle to every occasion.

At the heart of Fuller Finery is the belief that luxury should feel inclusive. Generous amounts of precious materials, timeless design and craftsmanship come together to create fine jewellery that feels both special and wonderfully wearable. Every curve, clasp and detail is carefully considered to feel as good as it looks, because glamour should never come at the expense of comfort.

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105 YEARS IN THE MAKING: AN ART AND JEWELLERY DIALOGUE

Allison Quaid continues a century-old family legacy shaped by an enduring commitment to the arts.

This October, **Allison Quaid** invites you to experience **Echoes Across Time**, an exclusive salon bringing together the maison's contemporary artist collaborations, high jewellery collections and archival pieces presented alongside artworks spanning more than four centuries.

Allison Quaid's longstanding connection to the fine arts finds natural resonance in Echoes Across Time. This year, the house has collaborated with internationally acclaimed artists to translate their distinctive visual languages into wearable works of art. These unique pieces reveal how beauty can transcend the moment and find new expression across time.

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In collaboration with Kocerova Fine Art

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JEWELLERY TO TREASURE FROM POTTER & MOOCH

Give something special this Christmas with Potter & Mooch's beautifully crafted stacking jewellery. Designed to be layered and mixed together, each piece can be styled to create a look that's completely your own. Waterproof and hypoallergenic, the collection is available in 14ct yellow gold-filled or 925 sterling silver, with prices from £26. Discover the matching Ear Wings too - clever climber earrings made for a single piercing. **Shop the collection at www.potterandmooch.co.uk or call 01903 331744**

WHITE THORN PIERCING

Beautifully crafted solid gold pieces designed and made to be worn always. From my love of jewellery and piercing, White Thorn was born. A small Derby studio, specialising in ear curation — pieces from Buddha Jewelry, Junipurr, BVLA, small makers, my handmade charms and more, all chosen with intention.
To mark the seasonal change as we move into autumn, I've put together a considered jewellery edit for the season ahead. Curation appointments are also available in-studio, for anyone who'd like their ear planned, piece by piece. Quote BAZAAR15 for 15% off your first order. Discover the piece that feels like you at **whitethornpiercing.co.uk**

BAZAAR FASHION

DREAM PAIRS FOLD-OVER KNEE-HIGH FASHION BOOTS

The DREAM PAIRS Fold-Over Knee-High Boots bring a little attitude to the classic knee-high silhouette. Three metal buckles add a moto-inspired edge, while the fold-over shaft creates a relaxed, fashion-forward finish. The 1.77-inch chunky heel offers a touch of height without sacrificing everyday wearability, and the square toe keeps the look modern. Finished with a durable TPR outsole for reliable traction, these boots are made to style with everything from denim and dresses to oversized layers. Consider them an easy way to give everyday fall outfits a little more edge.

ROSA FAIZZAD: WHERE FASHION BECOMES EMPOWERMENT

More than a luxury fashion label, ROSA FAIZZAD is a movement celebrating confidence, individuality and timeless elegance. Founded in Denmark, the contemporary couture house creates limited-edition ready-to-wear and bespoke designs for women who appreciate exceptional craftsmanship and enduring style.

Each collection blends sophisticated tailoring with a deeper purpose, using fashion as a tool to empower women and inspire self-expression. From statement business wear to exquisite cocktail dresses and couture gowns, every piece is designed to make its wearer feel as remarkable as she looks. Discover a new perspective on modern luxury and experience fashion with meaning.

Discover the collection and book your private shopping experience at www.rosafaizzad.com.

Photographer: Thomas Pagel | PAGE7

DISCOVER YOUR TIMELESS GLOW

Beautiful, healthy skin isn't about looking younger – it's about feeling confident in your own skin at every stage of life.

With over 20 years of beauty and wellness expertise, Daniela Nikolova has created the **Timeless Glow Method**; a personalised approach that combines science-backed skincare, advanced non-invasive technology and holistic care to help women aged 45+ achieve naturally radiant, healthy-looking skin.

Rather than following a one-size-fits-all formula, Daniela takes the time to understand your skin, lifestyle and goals, creating tailored treatments and at-home routines that enhance your natural beauty rather than mask it.

If you're ready to invest in your skin and rediscover your confidence, book your consultation today and begin your own Timeless Glow journey.

Visit **beautyin.co.uk** to find out more.

PORTRAITS MADE TO BE REMEMBERED

It begins with atmosphere — a considered detail, a beautiful silhouette, the quiet confidence of a woman allowing herself to be seen. For Olga Titel, portraiture is deeply personal. Working with women, mothers, children and families, she creates thoughtful, beautifully styled sessions where every detail is considered.

From her private Wimbledon studio to clients' homes across London and Surrey, Olga brings together a curated wardrobe, professional hair and make-up, and imaginative styling to create portraits that feel distinctly personal.

Because one day, these photographs will become more than photographs. They will become the way a family remembers how it once felt.

TITEL-PHOTO.COM

SAGE BY MALA

Some clothes are worn for a season.
The best ones become part of a woman's story.
The linen shirt that travels everywhere with her.
The dress she reaches for on mornings when she wants to feel most herself.
The pieces she returns to, time and again, because they fit beautifully, feel effortless and simply belong.
Designed in India and shipping worldwide, Sage by Mala creates contemporary womenswear with an appreciation for modern simplicity. Clean silhouettes, considered tailoring and versatile design come together in collections that feel current today — and just as relevant tomorrow.
Fabric is chosen with the same care. Soft against the skin, breathable by nature and selected as much for the way it moves as the way it looks, every piece is made to bring ease to everyday dressing.
Every style is offered from XS to 5XL — the full collection, in exactly the same way — so each design can be experienced as it was intended, whatever the size.
There is a quiet confidence in clothing that asks nothing of the woman wearing it.
Only that she feels like herself.

Discover our collections at **sagebymala.com** and enjoy 15% off your first order with code **BAZAAR.**

EVERYDAY LUXURY, REFINED

Beautiful fabrics. Clean lines. Effortless silhouettes. Róisín Linnane designs for the modern woman who appreciates quiet luxury.
Committed to slow fashion, every piece is carefully considered from first sketch to final stitch. The collections offer timeless, versatile garments that transition effortlessly from day to evening.
Made with ethically sourced fabrics and a dedication to longevity, every piece tells a story.
Discover the collection at roisinlinnane.com / @roisinlinnane

THE WYDR STANDARD

Classic, considered and unmistakably modern, Wydr Studios' latest collection draws on preppy influences and heritage styling to redefine inclusive footwear. Every silhouette is crafted with the proportions of a true wide-width fit (2E/WW), designed for women seeking a wider fit without compromising on style. Following success in the US, Wydr brings its signature blend of fashion-led design and exceptional fit to the UK, proving that women no longer have to choose between beautiful shoes and a beautiful fit.
Featured: Marlowe Slingbacks (Silver).
Discover the collection at **wydrstudios.com**
Enjoy 10% off your first order with code NEW10.

BAZAAR BEAUTY

THE SPECIALIST SERUM

This exquisite serum is formulated to soften the appearance of fine lines, wrinkles, pigmentation, blemishes and the visible effects of sun exposure, while supporting a radiant complexion. Endorsed by Skin Specialists and Plastic Surgeons, its unique formula of Retinyl Palmitate, Aloe Vera and Vitamin E is gentle enough for daily use over the face, neck and eye area. Available in 4 sizes from £36.

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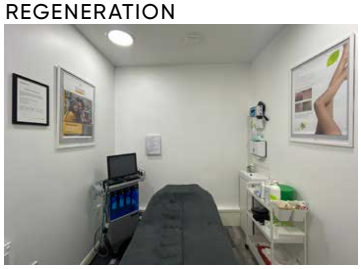
To order, for advice or to discover the full range see **regentiv.com** or call **01923 212555.**

THE FUTURE OF SKIN & HAIR REGENERATION



Skinlogix London is leading the new frontier of regenerative aesthetics, where exosomes, advanced-grade chemical peels and collagen-focused technologies work together to support healthier-looking skin from within.

Its regenerative protocols are designed to support cellular renewal and leave skin looking sculpted, luminous and refined. Exosome treatments offer a next-generation approach to rejuvenation, addressing skin laxity, ageing, texture and overall vitality, as well as hair-loss concerns.

For clients seeking results that feel modern, scientific and unmistakably premium, Skinlogix London offers a considered approach to regenerative skin health.

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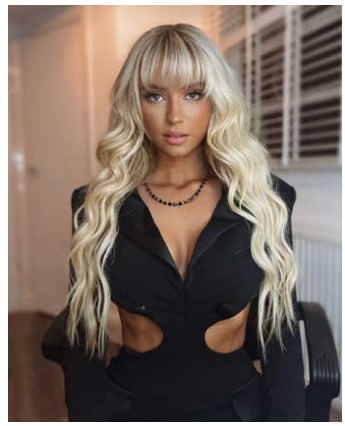
ELEVATING BEAUTY WITH CHARLOTTE WADLEY

Award-winning British makeup artist Charlotte Wadley has over 15 years' experience creating luxury beauty for fashion, editorial and commercial clients. Her work has been featured in leading publications including British Vogue and Tatler.



Renowned for creating polished, camera-ready beauty that translates seamlessly from editorial campaigns to red carpets, Charlotte is trusted for her professionalism, calm presence and meticulous attention to detail, establishing herself as one of the UKs leading artists.

charlottewadleymakeup.co.uk | @charlottewadleymakeup

HUĒ SALONS

HUĒ redefines the modern salon experience in the heart of Crouch End. Founded by Gabby, this contemporary colour and cutting studio blends exceptional craftsmanship with understated luxury, creating a calm, elegant sanctuary away from the pace of London life.

Renowned for bespoke balayage, seamless colour, precision cutting and effortlessly polished blowdries, the expert team takes a personalised approach to every appointment. Whether it's a subtle refresh or a transformative new look, each service is thoughtfully tailored to enhance your individual style while preserving the health and integrity of your hair.

Beyond beautiful results, HUĒ is rooted in wellbeing. Luxurious treatments, premium professional haircare and carefully curated refreshments elevate every visit, while inclusive expertise ensures every guest feels welcomed and understood. Every detail, from the minimalist interiors to the unhurried consultations, has been designed to make the experience as restorative as it is transformative. For those seeking elevated colour, impeccable cutting and a salon experience that feels effortlessly refined, HUĒ has become one of Crouch End's most coveted beauty destinations.

Exclusive to Harper's Bazaar readers: Quote "HARPERS" when booking to enjoy a special introductory discount.

THE PRODUCTS DIANA COULDN'T FIND FOR HER CLIENTS

After 15 years as an esthetician, Diana Vo transformed the skin concerns she treated every day into skincare inspired by real clients.

After 15 years of treating acne, dehydration, sensitivity and aging skin, esthetician and formulator Diana Vo noticed many clients were still struggling to find products that truly worked for them. She created VO Beauty to give her clients the skincare she wished she could recommend every day. Today, VO Beauty has grown into a trusted Canadian skincare brand for sensitive skin, with every formula inspired by the real people and concerns Diana continues to see in her treatment room.

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SKIN LOGIC AESTHETICS & LASER CLINIC

Located on prestigious Wimpole Street in London's medical district, Skin Logic Aesthetics & Laser Clinic combines clinical expertise with advanced technology to deliver personalised, evidence-based treatments and natural-looking results.

Founded by Advanced Aesthetic Practitioner Elena Bodean, who has a nursing background, the clinic specialises in skin rejuvenation, medical laser treatments, regenerative injectables, facial harmonisation and body contouring.

Advanced technologies include XLasePlus Medical laser, Lipofirm Pro, 9D HIFU and PelviRevive for women's intimate wellness. Treatments also include polynucleotides, collagen biostimulators, skin boosters, dermal fillers and anti-wrinkle treatments, all delivered with a focus on safety, precision and personalised patient care.

https://skinlogicaesthetics.co.uk/?utm_source=publishers&utm_id=Publishing

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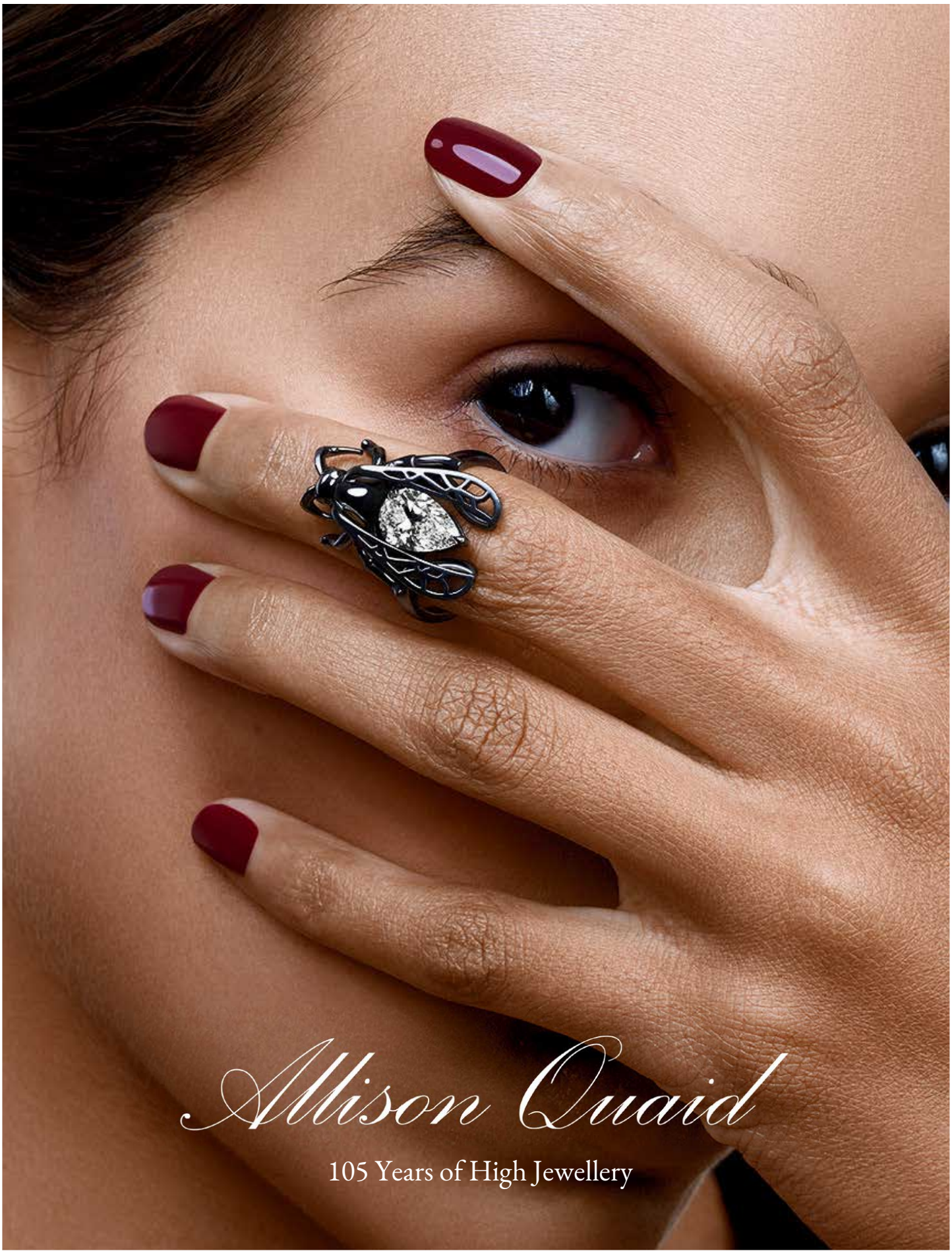

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